

**The Thirty-Fourth  
Annual Meeting of the  
General Service Conference of  
Alcoholics Anonymous**

**1984**

**Final Report**

**Roosevelt Hotel  
New York City  
April 15–21**

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Mail address: Box 459, Grand Central Station, New York, NY 10163



## Regional Map Of U.S. and Canada

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*A.A. Regional Forums:* See trustee committee and staff reports, pages 39-40.

*Regional trustees:* See talk by retiring trustee, pages 6-7, 9; report of trustees' Nominating Committee, page 42; new trustees, page 49; brief biographies, page 58-59.

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# 34th Conference Is United in Gratitude

Opening day

"Gratitude—The Language of the Heart," the Conference theme, was an ever-present unifying force throughout the 34th General Service Conference, held at the Roosevelt Hotel, New York City, April 15–21, 1984. Conference members—consisting of delegates from the Conference areas of the United States and Canada (Panels 33 and 34), trustees, A. A. W. S. and Grapevine directors, G. S. O. and Grapevine staffs—and many dedicated behind-the-scenes workers came together for a week of sharing and decision making, united in the spirit of love and service, and in gratitude for being trusted servants of A. A.

An "icebreaker" sharing session for new and old Conference members was held on Sunday afternoon. Opened by Lois Fisher (G. S. O. staff), the session was chaired by Dorothy Garvin (Panel 33, Eastern Pennsylvania), alternate delegate chairperson. Ralph Rosenberg Jr. (Grapevine director) began with a humorous statistical account of his past Conference experiences; Phyllis Masback (G. S. O. staff) reaffirmed that the Conference process is the Third Legacy and that it works; Ray Lavergne (Panel 33, Northwestern Ontario) thanked God for the opportunity to serve; Dale Skelton (Panel 34, Southwestern Ohio/Northern Kentucky) looked forward to a week filled with love and serenity; and Mike Alexander (Class A trustee) explained the duties of a trustee, with love and esteem for A. A.

Dr. John Norris ("Dr. Jack") described A. A. Conferences as "an island of sanity in a world gone mad" and expressed deep and abiding faith in the principle of substantial unanimity, which guides the Conference decision-making process. In the time remaining, names were drawn from the hat, and the following Panel 34 delegates shared briefly: Willard Machen (Northwestern Texas), Lee Forsythe (New Brunswick/Prince Edward Island), and Lawrence Shuler (South Carolina).

Following the sharing session, Conference members viewed an archives film, "1960—25th Anniversary," filmed in Long Beach, California, on the occasion of A. A.'s 25th anniversary (not available for distribution). As we approach A. A.'s 50th anniversary, this portrait of "the way we were" proved very moving for all. After the film, regional trustees held orientation sessions for Panels 33 and 34 delegates.

On Sunday evening, Conference members and guests gathered in the Grand Ballroom to share food, fellowship, and an A. A. meeting. After a delicious meal, Phil Dennis (Panel 33, Eastern Missouri) introduced the following speakers: Bryce Peacock (Panel 33, Utah), Retha Gresham (Grapevine staff), Pete Ellis (Panel 33, West Virginia), Eileen Gatza (G. S. O. staff), and Garrett Taylor (Northeast U.S. regional trustee).

The 34th General Service Conference began officially on Monday morning as Conference members assembled in the Terrace Room. Gordon Patrick, chairperson of the General Service Board, offered words of welcome and expressed high regard for the A. A. Fellowship. Bob Pearson (G. S. O. general manager) conducted roll call and then introduced Mike Cushman (Panel 33, Southern Florida/Bahamas), delegate chairperson, who de-

## Two-wink week!

During the 4-6-8 Meeting of A. A. at G. S. O. on Friday, April 13, Frank Mauser (archivist) commented on the general anticipation of the Conference week ahead: "One wink, and it will be Wednesday—another, and we'll all be crying in our cups at the closing brunch!"



scribed the Conference process as a learning experience which results in a spiritual awakening. Al Hergott (Western Canada regional trustee) delivered the keynote address with heartfelt sincerity. (Condensed versions of the welcome and keynote addresses are given on p. 6.) After Gordon Patrick's General Service Board report, Conference members began to apply themselves to the demands of a week of rigorous schedules, long hours, countless meetings, reports, presentation/discussions, workshops, and an Ask-It Basket session.

On Thursday and Friday, committee reports were given, and each committee recommendation was discussed and voted upon by the full Conference. Throughout the discussion and voting, the will of the Higher Power was clearly expressed in the group conscience of the Conference. The principle of substantial unanimity again guided the Conference decision-making process; and when it was all over, Conference members were united in a spiritual experience, indeed an awakening.

The final presentation/discussion on Friday afternoon addressed the Conference theme, "Gratitude—The Language of the Heart," and provided Conference members with an opportunity to share the gratitude they felt for having participated in the Conference. Because committee reports, discussion, and voting extended into the Friday-afternoon agenda, the "What's on Your Mind?" sharing session had to be cut short; however, participation was lively and informative. The 34th General Service Conference closed late on Friday afternoon with the reading of the promises, followed by the recitation of the Serenity Prayer in three languages (French, Spanish, and English), and then the Lord's Prayer.

At the closing brunch on Saturday morning, Conference members shared mixed emotions of sadness and joy. The week of hard work had indeed been tiring, but the rewards of having served were beyond measure. With renewed faith in the Conference process and in the unity of A. A., Conference members returned home, committed to carrying the "Conference message" to their areas and to helping the still-suffering alcoholic.

## Welcome

### The Conference process—a spiritual awakening

When I think about gratitude, somehow the thoughts and feelings are tied back to the awareness of God working in my life; and when I'm grateful or aware of God working in my life, I express that by loving, caring, and sharing. I'd like to share some of my experience with the realization of God working in my life as a result of the 1983 Conference.

Last year, I was a little tense and fearful. When I walked into the lobby of the Roosevelt and saw people I had already met, I became more comfortable. The learning experience began in the first workshop. The topic was "Anonymity—When and Why," and we went around the table sharing about anonymity in our areas. I said, "Well, in our area, the only people that use both their first and last names are usually loudmouths or somebody looking for attention." The man sitting next to me gave me an angry look and said, "I always use my first and last name, and I'm neither a loudmouth nor an attention-getter!" I certainly had put my foot in my mouth, and opening up my mind was a little easier after that. I guess that I didn't think I could learn very much from the Conference. But from that point on, my heart and mind began to open to you all.

The feelings of joy and happiness I had at the closing brunch were because the Conference was over and the pressure was off. I was secure in the knowledge that A.A. was working just fine in each of our areas. We were leaving with a new understanding and love. But it wasn't until I was on the way home on Saturday night that the intense awareness of God working in our lives came to me again. There was no way, on our own resources, we could have brought about the unity and love that God had given to us through that Conference process. God had done for us what we could not do for ourselves.

I ask each one of you today to experience and participate to your fullest this week. If you do so, I guarantee each of you a spiritual awakening as a result of the Conference process. Each of us must take this experience back to our areas and share it. For me, "Gratitude—The Language of the Heart" is trying to give away to my area what God, through you all, has so freely given to me.

*Michael Cushman (Southern Florida/Bahamas),  
delegate chairperson*

### A time of rebirth and renewal

Expressions of love and gratitude filled the fifth-floor conference room on Friday, April 13, as delegates, G.S.O. staff members, trustees, and A.A. "regulars" shared in a pitch-style A.A. meeting. In this special pre-Conference 4-6-8 Meeting of A.A., many talked of gratitude as being an action, beginning with the first A.A. handshake. The General Service Conference was perceived as a time of rebirth and renewal—of hope and awakening. It was agreed that no matter how tirelessly A.A.'s trusted servants may plan its course or anticipate outcomes, the Conference has a life of its own, a process entirely in the hands of the Higher Power.

### Cold awakening

Conference day began on Sunday morning with an unwellcome wakeup—cold showers for all. (The hotel didn't have hot water until later in the day.)



## Keynote

### Service—a means of carrying the message'

One of the people who was responsible for my being involved in service used to say that money is not the major contribution of the members of our Fellowship. He said that the real contribution made by the groups is the people who serve the Fellowship that saved our lives. I would like to think that each of the people in this room represents a major contribution to our Fellowship, and that our function this week will be to work together in tolerance and understanding to serve A.A. as a whole.

It was not that long ago that words such as tolerance, understanding, and gratitude meant nothing to me. I am a four-time loser in A.A. I first came to this Fellowship when I was 19 years old and then decided that if I ever got as bad as you were, I would come back. In the next ten years, I returned to drinking on four separate occasions, with relatively short intervals of sobriety in between. I arrived in A.A. for the fifth (and I hope final) time, dead drunk. I tried to phone the man who was to become my sponsor and was unable to do so for the simple reason that I was too drunk to get the seven numbers in the proper order. I asked my wife to make the call, and she did—I suspect more to avoid an argument than out of any sense of hope. I am ever grateful to Cal as he broke what I now understand are some of the "Twelfth Step rules" in A.A. today. You see, not only was I drunk, but I did not make the call for help myself. Cal came anyway and began to help me back on the road to recovery.

Because my sponsor believed that everyone who comes to the doors of A.A. has a right to all of the program, I was introduced to service early in my sobriety. My contribution in those days was limited to working around the meeting rooms and driving the car to service meetings so those wiser than I could plot their "strategy." I must confess that I marveled in those early days how we could argue and fight, and yell and scream, and still arrive at a consensus at the end of the day. And I marveled even more that these things could happen and, more incredibly, that those who had been on violently opposing sides of an issue could again walk out in friendship and fellowship.

While I was a casual observer in my early days in A.A., my sponsor, of course, introduced me to the Twelve Steps of our program, and I began that long road to spiritual recovery. As I

grew personally through the application of the Steps. I continued to be involved in service. Much to my surprise, I began to notice that I, too, was beginning to listen to opinions and ideas that I disagreed with, with a degree of tolerance and understanding. As I grew in recovery, I came to understand that what earlier I had thought were fights were not fights at all—they were simply expressions of gratitude and care for the Fellowship of A. A. Out of that understanding came a deep and abiding love and respect for those A. A. 's who have served this Fellowship in the past, who serve it today in this room, and who will serve it in the future. Perhaps, even more than respect, I have acquired gratitude for those who kept the Fellowship alive and vital so it would be there one more time for a drunk like me. And I have become aware of a growing sense of my responsibility to preserve this Fellowship intact for those who will need it in the future.

Service is often described as the Third Legacy. A "legacy" to me is something that is handed on from those who came before to those who will come after. My responsibility is to preserve the Legacy of Recovery for all those still-suffering drunks who will surely need us. To preserve the Legacy of Recovery I must clearly understand and practice in my personal life our Second Legacy of Unity as embodied in the Twelve Traditions. I believe that is why we are here this week—to do the work that must be done to preserve our Three Legacies for the still-suffering drunk. That is all service is to me—a means of carrying the message to the still-suffering drunk.

As I seek through prayer and meditation to improve my conscious contact with God as I understand Him during this Conference week, it is my prayer that God allow me to provide whatever service I can to this Fellowship, and that He provide me with the patience, love, and understanding to listen with respect to my fellow Conference members. It is my prayer that I thank God, once again, for allowing me the privilege to express my heartfelt gratitude to this Fellowship by serving at this Conference, and that I allow others the same expression of love and gratitude.

I don't believe that when old Cal saw me stretched out on my couch that morning, he said, "I'd better treat this one carefully because he is going to be a trustee and appear at five General Service Conferences." He saw a poor drunk who was dying and offered, without reservation, the recovery program of A. A. I don't see a whole lot of difference between what Cal did for me that morning and what we will be doing this week.

*Albert J. Hergott, Western Canada regional trustee*

On Tuesday, Carol King (Panel 33, Western Pennsylvania) was astonished to find that an A. A. member from a group in her area had arrived at the Roosevelt ready to participate in the Conference. It seems the local A. A. group had paid all expenses for this "delegate" to represent them. Carol admitted she had her work cut out for her when she returned home.

### **Another place, another time?**

Retha Gresham (Grapevine staff), a country girl from West Virginia, walked barefooted in the rain on the way to the traditional "after-hours" ice-cream stop for Conference members. A famous admiral (John Paul Jones, Panel 33, Southern Illinois) refused to carry Retha or even secure a boat.

## **Delegates Meeting**

Panels 33 and 34 delegates dined together on Tuesday evening, April 17, and then met informally. The agenda included presentations, discussion, a sharing session, and election of officers. Dale Skelton (Southwestern Ohio/Northern Kentucky) was elected the new delegate chairperson; Mary Ann Bagi (New Mexico), the alternate chairperson. Because the presentations were so outstanding, the delegates voted to have them distributed with other Conference presentations and excerpted here.

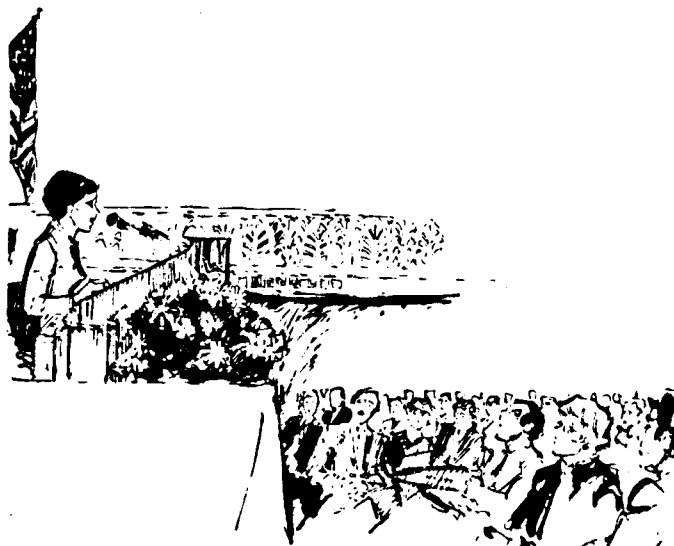
### **The importance of trust— among ourselves, G.S.O., and trustees**

Defining the word "trust" as faith, or a firm belief in the honesty, truthfulness, justice, or power of a person or thing, we can look at the overall scope of the importance of trust at all levels and in all areas of our Fellowship. Bill W. writes, "Dr. Bob and myself added up the score of over two years' work. For the first time, we saw that wholesale recovery for alcoholics was possible. We then had two small but solid groups at Akron and New York, plus a sprinkling of members elsewhere. How could these few recovered ones tell millions of alcoholics throughout the world the great news? That was the question."

I assume that as our co-founders planned, discussed, and made decisions about the Fellowship, the deep-down feeling of trust in each other was implanted. I believe that without this trust and the trust of newcomers to accept the responsibility of extending the hand to help the still-suffering alcoholic, our great Fellowship just might have spurted, fizzled, and died.

Most of us came to A. A. with disappointments and broken promises. We had lost our faith in people and God, and we trusted no one, including ourselves. We had to learn to trust again. Trust takes time because it has to be earned through continuous sobriety—earning by example. For many of us, coming to A. A. allowed us, for the first time in a long while, to let ourselves trust other people.

The First Tradition states that our experience has taught us that each member of A. A. is but a small part of a great whole. A. A.



must continue to live or most of us will surely die; hence, our common welfare comes first. But individual welfare follows close afterward. If a group is to have good meetings, we all have to give a bit more of ourselves to make the group work. Working together means helping each other; that takes a lot of trust and understanding. The First Tradition opens the door.

The G.S.R. carries the voice of the group conscience to the D.C.M. and delegate, who passes it on to the General Service Conference. Central committees can be organized to maintain the flow of the Fellowship. The General Service Office provides services to maintain continuity and aid the demands and requests of the Fellowship. Also, Regional Forums have been a great tool in gaining the confidence and trust of A.A. members.

Trustees have been able to serve their areas and be available due to technological advancement which has provided extensive travel, flexibility, and communications. A trustee is concerned with everything that happens inside and outside A.A. that may affect our health and growth. It is extremely important that trustees have the confidence and trust of A.A. members to ensure that their decision making will be for the good of all.

Being a trusted servant can be rewarding—frustrating at times, but enjoyable. Carrying the message, the basic service work of A.A., "... is our principal aim and the main reason for our existence. Therefore, A.A. is more than a set of principles; it is a society of alcoholics in action. We must carry the message, else we ourselves can wither and those who haven't been given the truth may die."

*Robert Baetz (Southern Wisconsin)*



### Conference sidelights

While Conference delegates were hard at work fulfilling their obligations, their spouses were enjoying a week of entertaining activities planned by a committee of New York A.A.'s and Al-Anons. Monday, April 16: a visit to G.S.O. and Al-Anon offices. Tuesday: a tour of Lincoln Center; a visit to the Metropolitan Museum of Art. Wednesday: a tour of the South Street Seaport. Thursday: a visit to the Brooklyn Botanic Gardens; a stroll through Brooklyn Heights, including the house on Clinton Street, where Lois and Bill once lived. Friday: a Circle Line boat trip around Manhattan. . . . The following statistics (in years) give a composite sketch of the 1984 Conference delegate: age, from 34 to 78, averaging 51.8; length of sobriety, from 5 to 37, averaging 12.4; length of A.A. service activity, from 4 to 27, averaging 9.9.

One of my sponsors reminded me of an incident that occurred in a group we both belong to. Because of the growth of the group, it became necessary to find a larger meeting place. At a business meeting, the group selected a committee of five members, of varying ages and sobriety, to seek new quarters. The committee investigated several places and reported back to the group at the next business meeting, giving a detailed report and recommendation. After much discussion, one group member said that until he saw the places, he could not make a determination. It was suggested that: (1) a cross section of the group represented the group in the investigation; (2) each member of the committee had the same purpose—to do and act in the best interest of the group; (3) having had the benefit of the committee input and extensive group discussion, adequate information was available to make an informed decision—to either accept or reject the proposed new location; and (4) the decision would be unnecessarily delayed by individual inspection of the proposed site. The members of the group voted to move the meeting to the recommended new location.

The four points made to the group member who objected are also valid for this Conference. Let's look at the similarities. Each Conference committee is made up of a cross section of the delegates as to age, length of sobriety, and geographic background. Each delegate here has the same purpose—to do and act in the best interest of the Fellowship of A.A. Upon hearing a committee recommendation and the ensuing discussion, we have, in fact, sufficient information to make a decision to accept or reject the recommendation. It is totally impractical for each of us to be as well informed as each committee member is on each committee recommendation. Why would some delegates take the same position as the man at my group? We must place principles before personalities prior to our decision-making process, requiring that we reexamine who and what we are.

Trust does not mean that we must approve every recommendation of every committee; nor does it mean that we must be unanimous or suffer in silence. If that were so, or if we acted that way, we would be violating the charge our areas gave to us as trusted servants. The Third Concept gives us the Right of Decision; the Fourth Concept, the Right of Participation; and the Fifth Concept, the Right of Appeal. It is our obligation to decide (based on what we hear), participate in the discussion, and make our feelings known—not suffer in silence. It is the committee's obligation to provide in its recommendation all pertinent information so that the deciders can decide.

It is for us, then, to trust that the committee has, in fact, provided us with all pertinent information to make an informed decision. No A.A. group can survive if members fail to trust each other, whether it is a small group back home or this Conference. We must trust each other, or A.A. will fail.

*Michael Shelly (Chicago)*

### Role of the alternate delegate— how to better (best?) utilize the alternate

With the ever-growing number of groups and members in the Fellowship, some area committees have found (and others may be finding) a need to address the role of the alternate delegate. Although the basic job responsibilities and duties of the delegate have not changed over the years, the workload involved in

the successful accomplishment of these duties has changed. The realization comes that we can't be all things to our area committees, representatives, groups, and A.A. members, and that we can do just so much in our effort to be the liaison for our area to the Conference. We reach a point at which, with aggressive humility, we realize that to best serve our area we need a back-up person who can share some of the workload. This should be the role of the alternate delegate.

By being available and sharing these responsibilities, two positive experiences can be achieved. First, the area has another link for communication of information, problems, sharing, etc. Second, the alternate gains experience and understanding. As we have experienced in my area in many different ways, the role of the alternate delegate can and does affect the area's ability to function and fulfill its primary purpose.

*Cathie Jeltsch (Southeastern New York)*

I don't believe that alternate delegates are second best because, without a doubt, my alternate is sharper in all phases of A.A. than I am; but it happens that I am here and she isn't, so I need her support. I think we should keep each other up to date, sharing and discussing everything that comes from G.S.O., so that she would be better prepared to take over my duties if necessary. I believe some districts in our area are neglected because of the travel time and expense involved. By quartering the area (geographically) and using our talent in each section, we could cut down on travel time and expense.

In our area we don't do enough for the ongoing education of our G.S.R.'s. We have good attendance at district meetings, and then a new slate is elected. They are confused and unaware of

## Estimates of Groups and Members— January 1984

|                         | Groups              | Members              |
|-------------------------|---------------------|----------------------|
| United States           | 29,827              | 585,823              |
| Canada                  | 4,197               | 69,931               |
| Overseas                | 22,156 <sup>1</sup> | 466,897 <sup>1</sup> |
| Treatment facilities    | 1,052 <sup>2</sup>  | 25,899 <sup>2</sup>  |
| Correctional facilities | 1,344 <sup>2</sup>  | 42,336 <sup>2</sup>  |
| Lone Members            |                     | 508                  |
| Internationalists       |                     | 522                  |
|                         | <u>58,576</u>       | <u>1,191,946</u>     |

1 At the end of 1983, we had reported members from 58 of the 107 overseas countries with A.A. groups. (A.A. activity was reported in 112 overseas countries.) These totaled 18,089 groups and 387,081 members. To establish an estimate for the 49 countries not yet responding, we excluded the eight largest responding and obtained an average of the balance. This average was applied to the 49, and the overall estimate emerged.

2 U.S. and Canada only.

The estimated group counts in the U.S. and Canada include only those that ask to be listed at G.S.O.; thousands do not.

Among listed groups in the U.S. and Canada, many do not report membership figures. For each nonreporting group, an estimate of membership is arrived at by taking an average among reporting groups within the Conference area concerned. Even among reporting groups, membership figures include only those now active and attending meetings; there is no way to count sober members who no longer have a home group.

their duties and responsibilities, and attendance goes down. Perhaps, if they were offered more help and information through sharing at service workshops, they would be encouraged to keep coming and to learn just what their duties and responsibilities are and how to better serve their groups. A.A.'s in our area could certainly better utilize our alternate delegate plus our other officers (past and present) by having them chair G.S.R. sessions and service workshops, thus using their valuable experience and knowledge at the local level.

*John McKenna (Iowa)*

## Closing brunch

### Farewells, with gratitude

Members of the 34th General Service Conference gathered in the Grand Ballroom of the Roosevelt on Saturday morning, April 21, to share a hearty brunch and say their goodbyes. Gordon Patrick introduced Mike Cushman (Southern Florida), outgoing delegate chairperson, who expressed deep gratitude for having had the opportunity to serve. The new delegate chairperson, Dale Skelton (Southwestern Ohio/Northern Kentucky), then read "How It Works."

Bob Pearson reflected on the Conference process as being a time of renewal for A.A. each year. He noted especially the harmony of the 1984 Conference, where the unity of A.A. overrode all decisions, and then gave thanks to all who helped make the 34th Conference such a unified one.

Trustees leaving the board were introduced by Gordon Patrick. All four speakers related their drinking stories and then highlighted their service histories, which are summarized here.

John Bragg, general service trustee, expressed gratitude for sobriety and A.A. He talked of the many changes and new beginnings of his sobriety—most currently his forthcoming position with G.S.O. (John resigns his positions as trustee and director of A.A.W.S., effective May 1, 1984, to join G.S.O.; he will become general manager of G.S.O. as of August 1, 1984.)

Don Daly, general service trustee, highlighted his recovery in A.A. and emphasized his continuous service involvement as being the mainstay of his sobriety. Don expressed gratitude for having had the privilege of serving as trustee.

Al Hergott, Western Canada regional trustee, talked about being sponsored into service early in sobriety and expressed gratitude to his sponsor for all his "tough love." Al expressed gratitude for having served as trustee and having participated in many Conferences. He was impressed with the maturity of the 1984 Conference members—their wisdom and spirituality—and with the clarity with which the will of God was expressed in the group conscience.

Joan Ullom Sheridan, West Central U.S. regional trustee, reviewed her service history in A.A. as a process from which she is still learning. Joan expressed gratitude to A.A. for the "family of brothers and sisters she never had" and thanked the General Service Board and G.S.O. staff members for all their love and support.

# Presentations Address Key Fellowship Issues and Responsibilities

## **The informed group conscience—my obligation**

*The first 1984 Conference presentation/discussion took place on Monday morning. The topic was timely and engrossing to all Conference members, who took part in a stimulating discussion moderated by Buck Bruner, East Central U.S. regional trustee.*

### **To understand the Steps**

As I ponder my obligation to understand the Steps, I think of how I would have served the Fellowship of A.A. had I just been dry and kept the same attitudes acquired in the years of drinking—self-righteous, demanding, and very phony. I would not have served in A.A. to enhance or keep my sobriety, but to be recognized as the “good person.”

Mac Cheater, a past trustee, once said to me, “We should be of maximum service to God and our fellows; and when we forget that it is A.A. that gave us what we have today and become unwilling to give back, we shall be in trouble.” Mac was instrumental in my wanting to be a part of A.A. I became aware, via sponsorship and the example of others, that the Twelve Steps were tools that would release me from the bondage of self.

The foreword of the “Twelve and Twelve” states, “A.A.’s Twelve Steps are a group of principles, spiritual in their nature, which, if practiced as a way of life, can expel the obsession to drink and enable the sufferer to become happily and usefully whole.” To be a useful person in my home, community, and A.A., I needed to discover me; and I did that by working the Steps. Recovery, Unity, and Service today form the link that keeps me whole. Serving as delegate has allowed me to apply the principles I discovered in the Twelve Steps. I am the link, not the key, that keeps our area in tune with the rest of A.A.

The joy of living is the theme of the Twelve Steps; action is the key word—giving that has no reward; love that has no price tag; practicing these principles in all our affairs. Pain and calamity turn to good by using these Steps as I become aware that spiritual growth must come first and that my only dependence is on God as I understand Him. As a result of the Steps, my life today is very full and enriched with the joy of living. I do not believe I would be here today if I had not applied the Steps to my life.

*Kim Patrick (British Columbia/Yukon)*

### **To understand the Traditions**

Early in my sobriety, I completed a questionnaire on the program of a proposed halfway house for women at an A.A. meeting. Later, a past delegate asked me what I had thought about doing that at a meeting, and I replied that I guessed it was okay. He asked if I didn’t see anything wrong with expressing an opinion on an outside issue as an A.A. member. Again, I replied that it didn’t seem to be of much importance, even if it was wrong, whereupon I was taken to a now-famous “woodshed” and later told that if we were not the guardians of our Traditions, who would be? When my slow burn cooled down, I came to know, understand, and love our Traditions.

I was backed into a Traditions corner the first time I came to A.A.—when I failed to become sober. Some of us wanted to keep a collapsing club afloat by putting on spaghetti dinners and

announcing them at A.A. meetings. We flushed with anger at the unreasonableness of the sober A.A.’s who stopped our announcements and failed to come to our dinners. Soon after, I picked up a drink and spent five years proving, beyond a shadow of a doubt, that I belonged in A.A.

I backed into another corner and found the Second Tradition, my home-group conscience. I was flushed with my own importance and was chairperson of the Central New York Assembly. I wanted a fancy calling card to flash during my travels, with a pen-and-ink sketch of a candelabra, meeting times in Old English type, and appropriate pearls of wisdom. I was highly offended when the group promptly and almost unanimously voted down my suggestion. It wasn’t until I began to study the Second Legacy section of “A.A. Comes of Age” that I understood what had happened.

Probably no other Tradition in Central New York gets quite as much mauling as the Sixth. Literature from other groups and organizations is displayed on the same table with Conference-approved literature; and announcements are made of basketball and bowling activities, the “sober-people” dance, and the alumni meeting of the “Diaper Dan Rehab.” Traveling in other areas, I have heard subscriptions to *Alcoholism Magazine* pitched by a G.S.R. just after the Serenity Prayer. I have seen bumper stickers displayed and promoted during the discussion; I have heard reports of selling 50-50 raffle tickets in the local gin mills; and one secretary took orders for A.A. stationery and lapel pins at the end of each meeting.

We use, abuse, and overuse the word “tool” in this Fellowship; yet the Traditions are the hammers, wrenches, pliers, and may-be even the grease that keep the spirit and trust of A.A. ready for the “drunk still drinkin’” or the “dry still thinkin’.” As I know it today, so it was here and ready for me when I came. Only if the members of my home group know, understand, and follow the Traditions will the framework for sharing our experience, strength, and hope be ready for those who follow us.

*Ralph Van Keuren (Central New York)*

### **To understand the Concepts**

Learning from the past, rather than endlessly repeating mistakes, is *prudence*—maturity, judiciousness, the capacity to act reasonably. Bill Wilson suggests that all the Warranties in Concept XII “. . . are counsels of *prudence*—prudence in personal relatedness, prudence in money matters, and prudence in our relations with the world about us. For us, prudence is a workable middle ground, a channel of clear sailing between the obstacles of fear on the one side and of recklessness on the other. Prudence in practice creates a definite climate, the only climate in which harmony, effectiveness, and consistent spiritual progress can be achieved.”

Clear words, these, and the correlation drawn between prudence and the continued health and vitality of the Fellowship and between prudence and spiritual progress is thought-provoking. Our prudent obligation, then, is first to understand the Concepts and second to utilize them, as Bill suggests, “throughout our entire structure.” It is by using the accumulated wisdom of experience the Concepts embody that we can profit from the lessons of the past and make necessary changes when change is clearly good for the Fellowship. If mistaken departures are

made, the Concepts "... provide a ready means of safe return to an operating balance that might otherwise take years of floundering to rediscover." The Concepts, in addition to the Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions, were developed from the hard knocks of experience; to ignore or overlook them is to move against the vital principle of A.A. unity.

The Concepts indeed give evidence to Bill's statement that prudence in practice creates a climate where consistent spiritual progress can be achieved. The maintenance of the traditions of shared responsibility and individual freedom so clearly expressed in the Concepts is the guarantee that A.A. will always remain democratic in action and in spirit. As Bill concludes the discussion of the Warranties, "We of A.A. believe that our freedom to serve is truly the freedom by which we live—the freedom in which we have our being."

Jan Polek (Washington)

### The informed group conscience

*The morning presentation/discussion session was still fresh in their minds as Conference members participated in a Monday-evening workshop on the same topic. Small groups of about ten met in separate rooms; Panel 33 delegates and trustees were moderators and reporters. The following is a summary of the reports from all rooms, giving both the general consensus and, in some cases, reactions from various groups.*

#### **'Willingness to listen'**

**1** "What is the group conscience? How does the group conscience differ from a group opinion or a majority vote?"

The group conscience strives for unanimity through enlightenment, spirituality, and the practice of our principles in all our affairs. To be fully informed requires a willingness to listen to minority opinions through full discussion. On sensitive issues, the group works slowly, discouraging formal motions until the group has a clear sense of its views. Placing principles before personalities, the group is wary of dominant opinions. The group conscience is the aggregate experience a group develops after applying the Traditions and Concepts to a question.

The difference between a group conscience and a majority vote or group opinion is that one or more of the elements described above are missing.

**2** "How does 'a loving God' express Himself through the group conscience?"

Groups find their way past ignorance, prejudice and self-will on an individual basis by practicing the Steps, which enable us to practice humility, patience, tolerance, kindness, and love—emphasizing principles before personalities. Through the Steps, we learn to overcome self-will and open the way to group

During a Conference floor discussion on the use of computers, some delegates expressed feelings of being "awed" by computers. Lloyd Hosner (Panel 33, Central Michigan) delighted all when he stated emphatically, "I was awed when they took running boards off cars, too!"



Lois Wilson, widow of A.A.'s co-founder Bill, was a special guest at the Conference opening dinner on Sunday evening.

conscience. When tempers flare, an informed chairperson postpones discussion until tempers cool, allowing time for prayer and meditation (one workshop mentioned the Serenity Prayer). A knowledge of A.A. history and willingness to listen to experience were also cited as important factors.

We can listen for a quiet "minority" voice which may be the true expression of "a loving God" by allowing time for all to share and the minority to be heard. The importance of the minority view was stressed in most workshop sections.

#### **A.A.'s head for the bar**

While leaving the closing brunch on Saturday, Helen Harmon (trustee-at-large/Canada) asked someone, "Where's the bar?" It seems that members of the General Service Board were due to meet in the Colonial Room located "behind the bar" of the hotel.

**3** "How is discussion prior to a group conscience handled in your area?"

In most areas, members are informed in advance that a group conscience will be sought, and all agreed that advance notice should be given, with two weeks suggested, if possible, to acquire necessary information. Most agreed that members are encouraged to participate in discussion; but several suggested more encouragement is needed, and this could be the G.S.R.'s responsibility. It was mentioned that a know-it-all in the group can be annoying, but the group gains strength by tolerating him or her.

There was general agreement that, in most instances, not enough time is allowed for discussion in order to hear both sides of an issue.

Most workshops indicated that lack of unanimity does not mean a lack of group conscience. Lack of unanimity is also a group



conscience to do nothing. Sometimes the group conscience is that we do not agree. If a group cannot find the voice of conscience, a group inventory may be needed. If a group conscience cannot be developed, the group eventually dies.

**4** "In what ways can we stimulate a better understanding and application of the Steps, Traditions, and Concepts?"

By personally applying and relating the Steps, Traditions, and Concepts to our own sobriety, we can stimulate an interest by example. As trusted servants, we can include experience with the Steps, Traditions, and Concepts in sharing our stories. Sponsorship and a home group need emphasis, as a sponsor has the responsibility to encourage reading "Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions" and other Conference-approved literature.

Workshop and panel discussions on the Steps, Traditions, and Concepts stimulate discussion, and it was suggested that these be held at Regional Forums as well as area and district meetings.

Groups especially need stimulation in this effort, and it is helpful to cite examples of Traditions and Concepts pertinent to group experiences. It was also suggested that groups read the Steps at the beginning of their meetings to explain *how* it works, and also read the Traditions to share *why* it works. The Concepts can be used as a dictionary; find the one that fits the question.

**5** "How can we help groups understand that the Conference has the responsibility of acting as the collective group conscience for the Fellowship?"

One workshop suggested what takes place at the Conference does not become a group conscience until delegates take the experience back to the groups. Full reports relating what was accomplished to meet area needs are helpful. The membership feels part of the Conference through delegates' sharing the activities.

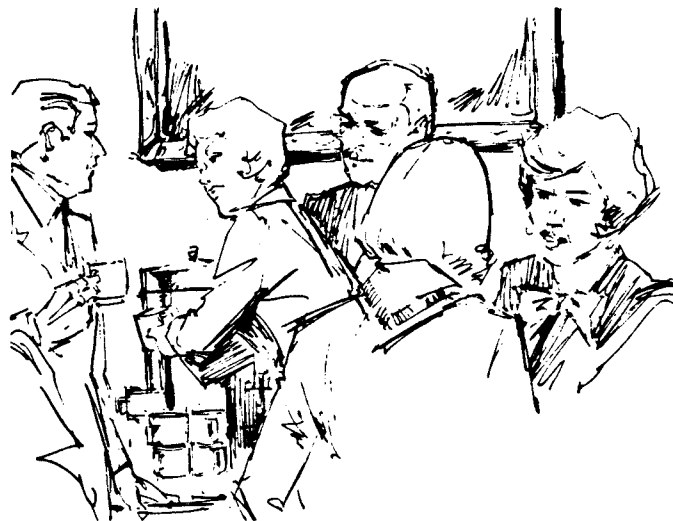
Charts are helpful, especially the Structure of the Fellowship chart, which shows the relationship between A.A. groups and the Conference. Questionnaires regarding matters coming before the Conference give each group a sense of participation in the Conference.

Regional Forums are helpful. Many areas now have service structure schools for G.S.R.'s, making it possible for G.S.R.'s to provide their groups with an understanding of the Conference.

Workshops, seminars, and delegates and past delegates carrying the message are also good tools. The Conference experience involves trust, individual responsibility, and reporting the recommendations and experiences with love.

### **Pipeline to H.P.?**

Georges Filion (Panel 34, Southwestern Quebec) was overheard promising that there would be no rain in Montreal on the occasion of the 1985 A.A. International Convention. (Olympic Park Stadium, where the Big Book Meeting and Spiritual Meeting will be held, is partially an open-air stadium.) Georges said he could absolutely guarantee good weather because he had "inside information" from the Higher Power. Agnes Krueger (Panel 34, North Dakota) told Georges that she would feel much better if the whole host committee would pray about it.



### **International Convention**

*On Tuesday morning, Ken Dunphy, Eastern Canada regional trustee, moderated this presentation/discussion, which included part of the report from the trustees' Committee on the International Convention.*

### **50th-anniversary plans are in full swing**

Prior to the First International Convention, the Cleveland Fellowship of A.A. hosted a Big Meeting in June 1945 to celebrate A.A.'s tenth anniversary. The speakers were Bill W. and Dr. Bob, and 2,500 attended (from 36 states, two Canadian provinces, and Mexico). So it wasn't surprising that the Cleveland Central Office wanted to sponsor the First International Convention in 1950, in observance of A.A.'s 15th anniversary.

To finance the Convention, the Cleveland/Akron groups underwrote half of the Convention, and the Alcoholic Foundation (now the General Service Board), the other half. The program for the weekend was a closed meeting, at which the proposed Traditions and other pertinent subjects were fully discussed, followed by an open mass meeting, addressed by Bill and Dr. Bob. Between 6,000 and 8,000 people attended, representing the United States and Canada as well as South Africa, the Marshall Islands, and Saudi Arabia. That weekend, the Twelve Traditions were adopted.

After the 1950 A.A. International Convention, the General Service Board of A.A. and its standing committee(s) assumed the entire responsibility for organizing and planning A.A. International Conventions. Our 20th A.A. Anniversary International Convention was held in St. Louis, Missouri, in 1955. Bill Wilson declared at this time that A.A. had come of age, and the leadership of A.A. was turned over to the General Service Conference. The registration was 3,800 (about 5,000 were actually there). The Convention incurred a net loss of \$16,000 (an enormous amount of money in those days).

But this financial loss did not discourage the Northern California group of representatives. In September 1955, they asked that the 1956 Conference approve a proposal that A.A. anniversary conventions be held every two years, shifting the location geo-



graphically to permit a maximum number of members to attend, and that the 1957 Convention be held "somewhere in California." On a voice vote, the proposal was defeated overwhelmingly, but later the same Conference unanimously recommended to the General Service Board that the next Convention be held in California. The 1960 A.A. International Convention was held in Long Beach, and resulted in a net income.

In 1965, we moved to Toronto, where about 10,500 attended our 30th A.A. Anniversary International Convention. At the Big Meeting on Saturday night, A.A.'s from around the world declared: "When anyone, anywhere, reaches out for help, I want the hand of A.A. always to be there. And for that: I am responsible." (This Convention was also self-supporting.)

At our 35th A.A. Anniversary International Convention in 1970 at Miami Beach, Florida, 10,700 were present, and the Convention was a success Fellowship-wise and financially. At the Spiritual Meeting on Sunday morning, our co-founder Bill Wilson made his last public appearance.

The size of our International Convention has continued to grow. In 1974, the trustees' International Convention Committee recommended that a convention consultant be hired to assist with convention bureaus, convention centers, decorators, bus companies, etc. Time has proved that this kind of expertise pays for itself by keeping expenses down.

The proliferation of alcoholism agencies and treatment centers could not be foreseen in the early 1970's, when we were planning for the 40th A.A. Anniversary Convention in Denver. We had anticipated 14,000, but as of July 4, 1975, 19,300 had registered. Fire alarms went off due to the smoking and overcrowding, calling out the entire Denver Fire Department. The surplus of funds from this weekend was \$83,000—an embarrassing amount of money when you're aiming to break even.

Our 45th A.A. Anniversary International Convention was held in New Orleans. This time, mostly due to inflation, we incurred a net loss of \$203,000 although the Convention was a success, with a record registration of 22,500. A 1981 Conference action recommended that all future events of this type be self-supporting.

Within the next month or two, plans for our 50th A.A. Anniversary International Convention in Montreal will be in full swing. We have booked 13,000 rooms, the Olympic Park Stadium, and the Convention Center. We have also hired a completely bilingual convention consultant, who has assisted us in working out contracts. The General Service Board of A.A., through its committees, is entirely responsible for running the International Conventions. A local host committee chairperson (Denis Longtin, Southwestern Quebec) will coordinate 1,000 volunteers who will assist us with on-site registration, languages, decorations, etc.

Although most people in Montreal are bilingual (English and French), the Convention is *international*. English will be the principal language spoken at the Big Meetings, with simultaneous translations in French, Spanish, and German; also workshops, panels, and alkathons will be held in these four languages. Registration forms will be sent to all A.A. groups around the world in late September and early October 1984. We hope everyone will celebrate A.A.'s golden anniversary in Montreal.

*Sarah Price (G.S.O. staff)*

## '50 years with gratitude'

After reviewing a list of 34 suggested themes, the trustees' committee recommended that the theme of our 50th A.A. Anniversary International Convention be "50 Years With Gratitude." It was noted that the word "gratitude" would lend itself very well to a convention subtheme, such as "We Are Grateful."

The committee discussed possible additions or changes in the list of topics for workshops, panels, and special meetings that were held at the 1980 A.A. International Convention. It was suggested that this time we might have meeting titles that would tie into our anniversary, such as calling the oldtimers meeting "Golden Oldies." Following is a list of some of the topics for the sessions:

### Workshops

Archives  
The Twelve Steps  
The Twelve Traditions  
The Twelve Concepts  
Anonymity  
The Grapevine  
Sponsorship  
Young People in A.A.  
Newsletters and Bulletins  
Loners and Internationalists  
Gays in A.A.  
Public Information  
Intergroup and Central Offices  
A.A. and Treatment Centers  
Answering Services  
A.A. and Prisons  
The Big Book  
Cooperation With the Professional Community

### Panels

A.A. and the Armed Forces  
A.A. and Industry  
A.A. and Hospitals  
A.A. and Court Programs  
A.A. and the Clergy  
A.A.'s Employed in the Field of Alcoholism  
A.A. and Prisons  
A.A. and the Media  
A.A. and Rehabilitation Programs  
A.A. and Alcoholism Agencies  
A.A. and the Medical Profession  
How Professionals Cooperate with A.A.

### Special Meetings

|                                  |                           |
|----------------------------------|---------------------------|
| Oldtimers in A.A.                | A.A. Around the World     |
| A.A., Al-Anon, Alateen           | A.A. in Africa            |
| International Doctors in A.A.    | A.A. in Asia              |
| International Lawyers in A.A.    | A.A. in Canada            |
| Meeting for Deaf Members in A.A. | A.A. Down Under           |
| Young People in A.A.             | A.A. in Europe            |
| Pioneers in A.A.                 | A.A. in the United States |
| Women in A.A.                    | Marathon Meeting          |

The committee recommended that in 1985 we also have a workshop on dual addiction.

The subject of the 1983 Conference recommendation about Al-Anon participation at the A.A. Sunday-morning Spiritual Meeting was reviewed. Betty Little reported that she had received a number of calls from delegates after the 1983 Conference belatedly expressing concerns regarding this action. Bob Pearson shared some similar reactions that had been conveyed to him. Because there is some unrest in the Fellowship and the speaker selections will not start until after registration opens next fall, the committee recommended that this action be referred to the 1984 Conference for further discussion.

After considering a suggestion made by a past delegate to have someone sing the Lord's Prayer after the Big Meeting, the committee recommended that we not invite anyone to sing the Lord's Prayer at the end of any meetings.

After reviewing the preliminary budget for the 1985 A.A. International Convention, the committee approved the recommendation that the registration fee be \$30 and that the Canadian dollar be accepted at par.

In response to a letter from Henry E. Griffith (chairperson, Al-Anon Board of Trustees) to our board, in regard to accepting the Canadian dollar at par for registration, the committee recommended that A.A. pick up that share of Al-Anon's net loss, if any, attributable to the expense related to their share of the registration.

The committee will continue to think about topics for the 1985 International Convention sessions, and any suggestions from the Fellowship would be most welcome.

*Kenneth Dunphy (chairperson)*

### **'The city with a difference'**

The city that will host our 50th A.A. Anniversary International Convention in July 1985 is Montreal—the city with a difference. Modern Montreal is a vibrant, cosmopolitan city—North America's largest and the world's second largest French-speaking city. Montreal combines green residential areas and a lively center of town with towering skyscrapers and smart shops. It is a city for shoppers, wanderers, and gourmets.

The professionalism of Montreal's convention, hotel, and tourism personnel is world-renowned, and facilities are second to none. Accommodations include college dormitories and super-luxurious hotel suites, as well as rooms in private homes. The A.A. host committee is already hard at work, and volunteers will greet visitors from around the world in their own languages—especially in the language of the heart.

*Georges Filion (Southwestern Quebec)*

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### **The district committee member—the essential link**

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*Following lunch and reports on area service highlights on Tuesday, Helen Harmon, trustee-at-large/Canada, introduced the presenters and moderated a lively and informative discussion.*

### **When the essential link is broken**

The area committee, perhaps more than any other group of people in A.A., is responsible for the health of the Conference structure and, by the same token, for the growth and harmony in our Fellowship. It occupies a unique middle position between the area delegate and General Service Conference, on the one hand, and the G.S.R.'s and local groups, on the other. Through its elected delegate, the committee learns firsthand what is happening in A.A. world service. Likewise, through the D.C.M.'s, the committee is close to the district and local groups.

The D.C.M. is the essential link in the chain of communication between the General Service Conference and the grass roots of A.A., the groups. An active, capable, and effective D.C.M. in every district of every area is an ideal situation, but it is not yet

a reality. With that thought in mind, I would like to ask, "What happens to a district that lacks representation on the area committee?" I am really asking, "What happens to a district without an active D.C.M.?"

Many things can happen to such a district—all are bad. First, the groups lose vital communication. Without a D.C.M. through whom the G.S.R.'s may communicate to the area committee, the groups' conscience cannot be heard at the area level. Likewise, the G.S.R.'s cannot inform the groups about area and Conference activities. The groups become separated from A.A. as a whole, and obviously general service work suffers.

What about new groups that form almost daily in some of our districts? Some will register with G.S.O., elect their G.S.R.'s, and become active participants in area matters; some will operate in accordance with our Seventh Tradition and become self-supporting at all levels of A.A. service. Some of them will do these things—most of them will not. Without a D.C.M., new groups start up and simply become islands unto themselves.

Perhaps we need to ask ourselves: "What can we do, as members of A.A. dedicated to service, to ensure that the link is not broken and every district has a D.C.M.?" "Is there some way that G.S.R.'s can be brought to realize the importance of the D.C.M.?" "How do we keep a good D.C.M. active and enthusiastic about his or her service commitment?" In our area, it is difficult to find people who accept their responsibilities and make a commitment of their time, talent, and energy to keep the service structure of our beloved Fellowship strong. This is painfully true when it comes to the D.C.M. Many start, but few are willing to continue; and so the essential link is broken and the area structure weakened.

Since the D.C.M. is such a vital link in the service structure, it is imperative that each of us continue to search for answers so that the link will remain strong and those who come after us will have the same opportunity for recovery that each of us found when we came to A.A.

*Bud Smith (Southeastern Texas)*



## **'Willingness is the essential ingredient'**

In my opinion, our co-founder Bill Wilson would have made a terrific D.C.M.—after he had served as a trusted G.S.R. and with the previous experience of group responsibility. He was willing to go to any lengths and to accept the group conscience. He understood the necessity of two-way communications. The service Bill performed in sharing his experience attracted Dr. Bob to seek recovery. Perhaps the order of our Legacies should be: Unity, first; Service, second; to attract Recovery.

I have seen G.S.R.'s appointed; some have been nominated and elected while out of state. D.C.M.'s have been elected without being present. Some members have campaigned strenuously for approval. In all these cases, our service structure suffered and we missed the group conscience in these inactive pockets. Is it possible to be into a lot of service activity, but not much action, and be effective? Does our service structure furnish a place to hide?

In the Suggestions for Leading Beginners Meetings we find the following statement: "By receiving and giving A.A. help, every one of us becomes a link in a chain around the world. All of us cling to the chain to save our lives, and yet each of us is part of it—depending on all the others to help keep the chain unbroken." Don't we need good D.C.M.'s to keep the links strong in this chain? I believe that willingness is the essential ingredient for future service leaders.

*Myron Gowans (Virginia)*

## **Cluster meetings—'a fresh approach'**

"A fresh approach" implies change and making the change after considering other options. This presentation is almost entirely one of looking back, and thus it has all of the advantages of hindsight. Therefore, I want to say that our "fresh approach" is the result of several years of trial and error, as well as sharing of the experience of our own districts and those in other areas. Wherever we are now is a moment in the process of growth and as such is our fresh approach to district structure.

The Eastern Massachusetts Area is geographically small, which enables us to hold monthly area committee meetings with a good attendance by D.C.M.'s from each of the 26 districts that are active; we have over 1,100 groups. For some time, the area committee members unknowingly behaved like the "director of operations" for the districts. We pondered at length over the ways and means of getting groups to elect G.S.R.'s. We searched for the proper persons to chair committees that had not yet really gotten off the ground. We fretted when the person found for the position did not accomplish the desired results.

While all of this was going on, most of the active districts were meeting regularly and implementing plans and activities to carry the message throughout their communities. For the most part, the activities were modest in scope; but the goals were achievable, and the interest was genuine, if limited in numbers of persons. The message was being carried. As the process continued, it became apparent to us that the action is at the district level. Having faith in our service structure as it is designed to flow from the group to the district, to the area, and to the Conference gave us the confidence that we were proceeding in the right direction.

A few years ago, we began to hold cluster meetings—four to seven districts meeting together in order to draw the G.S.R.'s from these districts together to share their experience. We scheduled four cluster meetings annually, replacing four monthly area committee meetings. It was the conscience of the area committee that the clusters were to be an adjunct of the area service structure but would in no way alter the customary structure. The area delegate and officers alternated their attendance at cluster meetings. On the Sunday following the cluster meeting, a breakfast meeting was held to share experience and results.

Cluster meetings have filled a need for convenient drawing together of service-oriented persons from adjacent communities. They also provide a forum for persons in an inactive district to learn ways of attracting others into service and find support while building their own district structures. However, this adventure has not been free of difficulties.

Within the past few months, we have made a searching inventory of the function of cluster meetings. The consensus is that they are a valuable adjunct to our structure and should be continued. The districts that make up one cluster have opted to forego cluster meetings for the immediate future. This inventory also expressed, with unanimity, a group conscience which tells us that clusters are and should continue to be a district function. Cluster meetings have become a significant factor in increasing knowledge of our Third Legacy, enhancing communications among the districts and providing a humble training ground for leadership by example for D.C.M.'s.

Part of the reason that the D.C.M. is the essential link is that he or she is the beginning of leadership in our service structure. What may we do to bring out in our D.C.M.'s this quality of leadership—to lead by example and love for our Fellowship?

*Frank Gay (Eastern Massachusetts)*

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## **A.A. World Services**

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*Just before lunch on Wednesday, following the second meeting of Conference committees, Bill Croke, A.A.W.S. director, moderated an enthusiastic discussion following these presentations.*

## **The G.S.O. mailbag**

G.S.O. receives an average of 600 to 1,900 pieces of mail in any given day. In March 1984 the Steno Department received about 650 letters per week (350 are answered by one staff member). When asked to do this presentation, I thought about my experience with mail at G.S.O. over the last 12 years. It occurred to me that the more things change in A.A., the more they stay the same. So I took some typical letters from our G.S.O. "mailbag" over the last few years, and then I found letters in the archives on the same subjects, answered by Bill Wilson from 1940 to 1960. Let me share these letters with you.

In January 1983, G.S.O. received a letter from Rabbi Robert C., Chambersburg, Pennsylvania. He wrote, in part: "I am a recovering alcoholic who attends A.A. meetings very often in many cities on the eastern seaboard. I have a theological problem

with the Lord's Prayer. I have also found a large number of A.A. members who share my concern."

In her reply, Lois Fisher (G.S.O. staff) wrote: "It is true that the Lord's Prayer is often said at the end of A.A. meetings . . . as a result of A.A.'s roots with the Oxford Group. Many groups do not include the Lord's Prayer in the meeting format. Whether or not to say the Lord's Prayer is a matter for the group conscience of each A.A. group to decide."

In April 1959, Bill Wilson received the following letter from Sydney, Australia, which reads, in part: "Why was it decided to end all A.A. meetings with the Lord's Prayer? It is very evident that it was not just stuck on like a bow on a box of chocolates. Bill, will you please take time out and answer me? Thank you. We are sincerely yours, Russ and Dorothy J."

Bill replied, in part: "This practice probably came from the Oxford Groups who were influential in the early days of A.A. . . . It is sometimes complained that the Lord's Prayer is a Christian document. . . . Nevertheless, this prayer is of such widespread use and recognition that the argument of its Christian origin seems to be a little farfetched. Most A.A.'s believe in some kind of God and that communication and strength are obtainable through His grace. It seems only right that least the Serenity Prayer and the Lord's Prayer be used in connection with our meetings. It does not seem necessary to defer to the feelings of our agnostic and atheist newcomers to the extent of completely hiding our light under a bushel."

In March 1983, G.S.O. received a letter from Scotland, which reads, in part: "We are thinking [of starting] a single people's group. Besides staying sober, 'one day at a time,' people without partners can share some of the problems we encounter."

Phyllis Masback (G.S.O. staff) replied, in part: "If you restrict [an A.A. group] to A.A. members who are single, then it would not be a regular A.A. group. It would be a special-purpose group. "The only requirement for A.A. membership is a desire to stop drinking."

In November 1957, Bill received a letter from San Francisco regarding special-purpose groups. Bill replied, in part: "Personally, I see no objection to the double-purpose groups, provided they forgo the use of the A.A. name. I think we have to distinguish between the A.A. group, pure and simple, and groups of A.A.'s who have dedicated themselves to other purposes, whether religious retreats, education, narcotic addiction, or what have you.—Devotedly yours, Bill."

In November 1983, G.S.O. received the following letter from Cincinnati, Ohio: "I would like to recommend a paperback edition of the Big Book. This would be used in addition to, not instead of, the Big Book. The paperback would include only the first 11 chapters, not the personal stories. On many occasions, I would like to have the Big Book with me; but because of its size, it would be impractical or awkward.—Sincerely, Allen E."

Vinnie McCarthy (G.S.O. staff) replied, in part: "Although there are many A.A. members who share your point of view, the General Service Conference turned down this request a few years ago. This does not mean that a future Conference may not decide to produce a paperback edition. For now, we must carry out the recommendations of the General Service Conference and continue to print the Big Book in its present format only."



*Some of the nonalcoholics who were dedicated behind-the-scenes workers during the Conference (left to right): Ed Gordon, Tony Osnato, Margie Janicek, Joan Smith, Elizabeth Garcia, and Lynda Ernst.*

In August 1962, the following letter, in part, was written to Bill by Charles K. of Detroit, Michigan: "I understand that the subject of a one-dollar paperback edition of the Big Book had previously been under discussion, but I can't for the life of me understand why it was decided to be an impractical idea. . . . I can think of many, many arguments in favor of such an edition and none against."

Bill replied, in part: "You are quite right that the project of bringing out a cheap A.A. book has often been considered. It is a praiseworthy idea, and perhaps someday we can. But, clearly enough, the time is not yet. The reasons are these: Though its operation is largely unseen, it is probable that the world office at New York is directly or indirectly responsible for about half of our growth in unity. Therefore, to preserve this operation at full strength is far more important than to reduce the price of A.A. books. Had it not been for income from literature, that operation would have long since been severely crippled. Over the years, in fact, the groups have fully paid the office expenses only about one-half of the time. These deficits have always been made up out of book earnings. So the question is a simple one: Should the office have the book profits? Or should we distribute them to the buyers?"

*Betty Liddle (G.S.O. staff)*

### **'Foreign aid'—literature carries the message**

During my first several months in A.A., I was graced with heightened susceptibility to the type of inspiration described in the Eleventh Step. I *knew* that I would experience the same magic if I attended an A.A. meeting in a foreign land that I was experiencing in my local A.A. group. My belief that the spiritual essence of our Fellowship was to be found worldwide was so strong that questions as to how it was accomplished were irrelevant. However, during this past year of service as A.A.W.S. director, I have participated in the various processes which carry our message of sobriety to foreign lands.

Experience in the United States has demonstrated the direct correlation between the publication and dissemination of our literature and the growth of our Fellowship. Thus, in undertaking to fulfill its responsibility of service to the whole world of A.A., in 1950, the Alcoholic Foundation, Inc., embarked on a modest program of "foreign aid" by making A.A. literature available to other countries.

The foundation's initial efforts were a gift of 1,500 Big Books to Great Britain in 1950 and a similar gift, together with 1,500 "Twelve and Twelve's," in 1954. Today, although our objective remains the same, the "foreign aid" mechanism is a bit more sophisticated but just as important; it is more consistent with our Seventh Tradition of self-support. Thus, when a general service office in another country requests financial assistance in publishing a translation of our literature, meetings are held first to share our vast experience in the publishing field. Particular pains are taken to ensure that pricing and other considerations are appropriately addressed, so that both repayment of the loan and the self-perpetuation of the foreign-publishing operation are achieved. (Each literature translation, whether a financial assistance agreement or not, is reviewed for accuracy and then approved for publication.) Then, once the amount of the financial aid, specific foreign printer, and other details of the agreement are concurred upon, A.A.W.S., Inc., assumes the obligation to pay the printer; and, as collateral for the loan thus created, we retain title to the resultant inventory. As each piece of foreign work is sold, an agreed-upon portion of the proceeds is earmarked and set aside for repayment of the loan.

Since our initial gift to Great Britain, the United States has provided aid to 13 foreign countries in the manner just described. If, for statistical accuracy, we select as a commencement date December 1969 (the date upon which the first direct financial aid was undertaken), and if we then from the total amount of such aid, namely, \$181,000, deduct sums already repaid or deemed current and therefore collectible, we find a net expense of \$20,500 over the past 24 years, or \$855 per year. In other words, it has cost the A.A. Fellowship in the United States the grand sum of \$2.34 per day to provide the kind of overseas support just outlined. Although hard statistical support is not possible, there is an abundance of evidence that once literature becomes available in a foreign country, the growth of A.A. in that country is enhanced dramatically. In the final analysis, of course, the revenue received from the purchase of A.A. literature in the United States makes this "foreign aid" possible.

*Thomas Jasper (A.A.W.S. director)*

## A.A. in the computer age

The boom in sales of personal computers that has occurred in the last two or three years leaves no doubt that we are in the computer age. At G.S.O., without our computer, we simply could



*Chris Bradley (nonalcoholic) is supervisor of the Data Control Department. He oversees all computer operations for G.S.O.*

not begin to handle the enormous volume of data required in our functions of maintaining group records, filling literature orders, keeping track of inventory at 11 different locations (millions of books and pamphlets), and accounting for group contributions.

Now, however, some Conference areas are also keeping records on personal computers. This is inevitable and laudable, especially if it results in better group records at the area level and more complete and up-to-date information provided to G.S.O. We have provided a personal computer at this Conference so those who are interested may attend demonstrations of the software program developed by Ralph Goers (Panel 33, Southern California). However, the use of personal computers for keeping group records in your areas introduces questions about A.A. policy, and we at G.S.O. do not make policy decisions—you do. We also have some questions relating to the services we should provide; again, we look to the Conference for direction. For example:

- At present, we request that *new* group information and *changes* in group information be provided to G.S.O. on the appropriate forms. (Of course, we also accept group information in letters or scribbled on the back of matchbooks, or in any other form it is sent in.) Once a year we send out a set of print-out sheets of all groups in the G.S.O. computer to all delegates to be verified, or updated, and returned to ensure the most accurate directories possible.

Now, suppose that, in the computer age, a few areas send us group information in the form of their own printouts. Should G.S.O. accept information in this format? I would think the answer is no if G.S.O. is asked to match your linear printouts against ours to discover painstakingly *what* is added or *what* is changed. The periodic sending in of additions or changes and asking G.S.O. to update its records has disclosed a high rate of duplication—up to 88 percent in some cases; that is, 88 percent of the data received was already on file. Where there have been differences, we have had to research to see which information is more current, based on date of change. Some areas have sent in lists of group names and cities and asked us to inform them of the assigned group service numbers. We simply do not have the time or the manpower to do this kind of detective work.

- A few areas have sent us their entire area printout and asked us to correct it by matching it against the G.S.O. records. It seems to me this is *not* a service we should provide. We are glad to run a printout of our group records for any area on request. But the flow of information should be from *you* to *us*, not vice versa.
- Sometimes, an area computer is in the hands of the area secretary or even a personal-computer buff who has no area committee responsibility. If G.S.O. accepts information from the area computer in these cases, has the delegate relinquished his or her responsibility? The Conference has assigned the delegate the responsibility for the accuracy of his or her area's records at G.S.O., and only the Conference can take this responsibility away.
- In one area, records are kept on an intergroup computer; that is, the intergroup "where and when" meeting list is integrated with the area group records. Isn't the area delegate in danger of losing all control? Isn't he or she abrogating responsibility and blurring the distinction between intergroup service and general service? And should G.S.O. accept group-record additions and changes directly from an intergroup or central office? The

idea is appealing because they list more groups than we do. But I believe the Conference would want to ponder hard all the implications of such a move before giving its okay.

- It is theoretically possible for the area computer to transmit data *directly* into G.S.O.'s computer. I personally have little doubt that this is the wave of the future, but until proper procedures have been established and adequate controls are in place both at G.S.O. and at the area end, I can foresee only chaos and confusion if 91 personal computers in the hands of 91 head-strong alcoholics all have access individually and collectively to our master computer at 468 Park Avenue South! Talk about "self-will run riot"!

*Bob Pearson (G.S.O. general manager)*

### New G.S.O. filmstrip

On Wednesday afternoon, Joan Ullom Sheridan, West Central U.S. regional trustee, reviewed, in general terms, the 1983 Conference recommendation that G.S.O. produce a new, updated version of the "P.O. Box 459" filmstrip. Conference members viewed the new filmstrip, which was shot at the new G.S.O. offices and includes new personnel. The Conference approved the new filmstrip, agreeing that it is precisely what Panel 33 Conference members had in mind.

### How are we in A.A. responding to a changing world?

*Late on Wednesday afternoon, Conference members listened attentively to the following powerful presentations. Wayne Parks, Southwest Central regional trustee, moderated the discussion on perhaps one of the most important topics to come before the Conference in a long time.*

#### **'Growing pains'**

One of the most obvious changes that the A.A. group faces today is the overwhelming numbers of men and women—and very young people—coming to A.A. from a wide variety of sources. With stringent new D.W.I. laws, many referrals come straight from the courtroom, sometimes with attendance statements to be stamped by the group secretary, and many times with only a desire to get the court off their backs. With the new employee assistance programs, men and women come to A.A. who are still employed. Most come to us through treatment programs where they have been given a brief introduction to A.A. and then turned out with A.A. meeting lists.

With increased public education and awareness, the stigma of alcoholism has lessened and there has been an increase in the number of people who recognize they have a problem and who

At the beginning of his talk at the closing brunch on Saturday morning, John Bragg (general service trustee) told of a fellow he knew in Albany who had said to him, mournfully, "I wish I were a social drinker so I could drink safely in the morning!"

seek help. These new members, all ages and at least 30% women, come from all ethnic and racial backgrounds. Some are handicapped or hearing-impaired, and some are addicted to more than just alcohol. They have varying life-styles and sometimes questionable motivation.

We can look at the increase in A.A. membership in our own groups and as reported by G.S.O.: 116% increase in regular A.A. groups in the United States and Canada from 1973 to 1982, and almost 4,500 new groups in 1983. This rapid growth and the attending problems are nothing new to A.A. The growing pains we are experiencing today are being met with renewed efforts to find lasting solutions with which the Fellowship can continue to carry the message. Area and district committees are becoming more informed, participating in workshops at the area level and at Regional Forums, and disseminating information back to the groups. As a result, A.A.'s meet with judges and court personnel to inform them as to what A.A. is and what we can and cannot do. Most treatment centers are eager to work with us and welcome A.A. meetings in their facilities.

A word of caution is in order here, however: There seems to be a trend among some A.A. members to delegate the basic, one-on-one Twelfth Step work to these treatment centers. At times, it's all too easy to respond to a call for help by picking up the phone and asking, "Which program can I get him in? Where's there an empty bed?" I remember with tremendous gratitude the tough love of the A.A.'s who carried the message to me and of the group sponsorship that followed. I pray we do not abdicate this vital function to the treatment center staff.

Today, we are more aware of special needs of individuals. We now have meetings for hearing-impaired and blind persons, and are establishing more. We are concerned with the involvement of Spanish-speaking A.A.'s and are more tolerant of special-purpose meetings. The dually addicted member is welcome as long as he or she has the desire to stop drinking. In the Deep South, the racial discrimination that existed 13 years ago when I first attended A.A. has given birth to new groups that welcome anyone who qualifies by the Third Tradition. My black friends tell me that today racial discrimination is virtually nonexistent in these A.A. meetings.

In the midst of this vastly changing society, it's clearer than ever that the A.A. Traditions are the bedrock of our survival. The A.A. group that regularly takes a searching and fearless inventory of its assets and liabilities—within the framework of the Twelve Traditions—will flourish, and A.A. will be there for our grandchildren and for all the generations that follow.

*Sally Roy (Alabama/Northwestern Florida)*

#### **Are we listening and responding?**

When I was drinking, six employers told me: "We're sorry but we are going to have to let you go," and my world changed. My response to them was, "Well, I didn't need this lousy job anyway." They always insisted I do things *their* way (i.e., like coming to work on Mondays and Fridays), and I always insisted on doing things *my* way. I didn't listen.

Are our area committees listening? Are we responding to what we are hearing? What are the changes, and how well are we responding to them? (Of course, I can only speak for the North-

eastern Texas Area.) It seems that a large percentage of our newcomers are coming from treatment facilities. Nearly all the facilities in our area recommend A.A. to their patients and bring them by the van or busload to our meetings. The problem is that they are bringing both alcoholics and nonalcoholics. They actually shop for groups that will allow these nonalcoholics in their closed meetings. (I am speaking, of course, about nonalcoholic drug addicts.) What more can an area or local treatment facilities committee do when our literature clearly points out what A.A. can and can't do? Certainly, closer cooperation with N.A. is one solution, suggesting that they form their own treatment facilities committees. If this is a problem in your area, how are you handling it at the area level?

With more stringent D.W.I. laws, people from court programs are flocking to meetings with papers to sign. Sometimes they come drunk, belligerent, or angry, and nearly all of them say they are not alcoholic—they "just got caught." Some groups will not let these people into a closed meeting unless they at least admit to having a problem with alcohol. Is this right, or are we condemning our own sick brothers and sisters? I believe that we are going to see more and more people coming from the courts. Is this a matter for area concern, a C.P.C. committee, or should we leave it to group autonomy?

We are experiencing an explosion of new groups in our areas, many of which have little understanding of or interest in the A.A. Traditions. What can we do, or what are we doing, to stress the importance of our primary purpose and the only requirement for A.A. membership?

Many more young people are coming into A.A. and service work. They are enthusiastic and interested, and they have new, fresh, and sometimes strange ideas. How can we hold their interest? Let's remember that these are our future leaders; let's give them our best, not only as areas, but also as individuals. What about inactive G.S.R.'s who are not attending assemblies and workshops? Should the area chairperson or delegate send them a friendly letter explaining that we need them and why? Has your area tried this? If you have, does it work?

Our A.A. groups need a better understanding of self-support at all levels, including the area. Our assembly approved the budget submitted by the finance committee, and then the groups responded by contributing only slightly over half of the budgeted amount. The world is changing—everything costs more. If your area has had this problem, how have you solved it?

We have problems in our areas—we always will. But I believe we are responding to a changing world, and I pray that with God's help, we always will.

*Brian Camp (Northeastern Texas)*

## **Let's not fear change**

Today, we look at the changes in the world around us—social, spiritual, and technological—and perhaps we are then forced to the conclusion that our A.A. world is indeed affected. The thought might occur that if only "they" would leave us alone, everything would be all right. (I believe I've heard that before.) In our Fellowship, the truth is that many changes have already occurred within A.A. They aren't going to go away, whether we want them to or not. This is not to say that our *principles* could

ever be modified—these are spiritual truths that are timeless. But perceptions, philosophies, and, most important, actions are altered by events over which most of us have little control. Therefore we must look at these changes and adapt to them in accordance with our A.A. group consciences.

My own relatively short span of sobriety represents a little over one-quarter of the history of Alcoholics Anonymous. During that time, two major events occurred: Bill Wilson left us, and we continued to experience a phenomenal growth in numbers. Other meanings can be attached to that word "growth," however. We are not in the numbers game. Growth can also mean organizational efficiency, or it can be spiritual. It can also be negative.

Today, over one-third of our newcomers come to us from treatment facilities. This change is affecting us spiritually, and at the group level we are not handling it well. These people are sober almost 30 days when they reach us. They have little opportunity to identify themselves as new, nor do they have temporary sponsors. We do not have a uniform approach to these people. Shouldn't we develop a more active program of Twelfth Step work *within* our groups for them? Do they not also deserve an example of what it means to be freely given the help that is, in turn, given others? Can we afford the luxury of judging and evaluating various modes of treatment when our sole concern should be to carry the message to the alcoholics in these facilities and especially after they come to us?

A large percentage of our alcoholic newcomers have also used other substances. Is it healthy to see some of our members antagonistic toward them? Would it not be more reasonable and loving to show patience instead—teach them the meaning of our Traditions, and make them aware that when we identify, we state the nature of our disease, not what we took? It is likely that in 10 or 12 years the majority of area delegates will be dually addicted. Can we afford to have these people feel it is "us against them"? Can we allow our own fear of change to be the very thing that turns these people, who suffer from alcoholism, to more receptive organizations? We must discourage the contradictory reactions wherein some A.A. members say they wish to hear nothing of other substances, but add if you use them you are not sober, while others say that all chemicals are the same and then identify as alcoholic addicts. On the other hand, shouldn't we stop referring to sobriety as freedom from alcohol only? Is this not a disservice to many of our members when they work with newcomers?

We are facing the increasing use of personal computers at the local level. It is good that we adopt policies now to avoid an overload on our G.S.O. personnel; but if it is difficult for paid personnel to do the checking necessary for consistency of records, imagine the task each volunteer has. Could we not develop forms to be sent both ways to and from the assembly areas using computers, so that no checking would be required? Even when an area sends in a new record, they do not know the I.D. number to be assigned. Could we not also develop the software necessary to allow at least the users of the more common personal computers to send in their information by modem? This is a great opportunity to update our methods in order to have more current directories. It is one thing to have someone listed who is no longer a G.S.R., but quite another to have information so old that the traveler can't reach anyone.

Our growth may make it somewhat easier to communicate in



rural areas, but it is much harder in large metropolitan locations where A.A. membership becomes further removed from the delegates, trustees, and, in some cases, G.S.O. The D.C.M. chairpersons can certainly help, but the large intergroup or central office structure in metropolitan areas makes the membership more independent and removed from general service. Should we consider partially merging these services to produce a more integrated whole?

There is only one cliché that I reject out of hand (perhaps it is the most dangerous of all): "If it works, don't fix it!" This may be good advice for the newcomer, but it is diametrically opposed to the motto of our co-founder: "Good is the enemy of the best." Many things could inhibit our growth or even destroy us, but let it not be a fear of change or a refusal to adjust to an ever-changing world.

Ralph W. Goers (Southern California)

### **Responding to everyday problems in A.A. in a changing world**

*Conference members "responded" to a thought-provoking presentation/discussion session on Wednesday afternoon by participating in a workshop on the same subject that evening. Small groups met in separate rooms; Panel 33 delegates, trustees, and directors were moderators and reporters. The following is a summary of the reports from all rooms, giving both the general consensus and, in some cases, reactions from various groups.*

### **Solutions—love, patience, and kindness**

#### **1 "What problems does A.A. face in a changing world?"**

It was pointed out that A.A. has challenges rather than problems. One workshop stated that A.A. doesn't have problems; we, as individual members, have problems of attitude. The challenges cover a wide range, with rapid growth and dealing with large numbers of referrals from treatment facilities and court programs at the top of the list. Many areas expressed concern about our common bond being fragmented by nonalcoholics coming to A.A. seeking help for drug problems. Dual addiction and an increase of specialized groups were discussed.

Lack of sponsorship or emphasis on a home group leads to large turnovers. People coming to A.A. often don't stay, and many oldtimers stay away from meetings.

Other challenges included: deteriorating language in meetings; conventions and roundups detracting from our primary purpose; A.A. members employed in the alcoholism field who can't separate their roles; how to carry the message to young alcoholics; how to keep past delegates involved in service; the rising cost of meeting facilities; lack of confidentiality; members who seek newcomers for romantic involvements; how to serve handicapped alcoholics; I.R.S. requirements re: tax-exempt status; the use of computers; language barriers; racial problems (in some areas); and straying from our Traditions.

#### **2 "What are some of the ways we might better face the problems of a changing world?"**



Love, patience, and kindness, with an emphasis on getting back to basics through sponsorship and a home group, were suggested solutions. Communication, within the Fellowship and with the professional community, to educate all about what A.A. can and cannot do, was stressed.

Staying with our primary purpose and learning more about the Traditions will help groups keep spiritually fit. We can handle the influx of new members by starting new groups, especially in treatment centers and hospitals. Several workshops mentioned Narcotics Anonymous as a solution regarding nonalcoholic drug addicts and dually addicted A.A.'s who need to talk about their drug problems.

If we face our problems with a flexible, nonjudgmental attitude and stay close to our Traditions, we will find ways to accommodate differences without compromising principles, leading to unity.

#### **3 "What are groups in your area doing to welcome the large influx of newcomers?"**

Interim, or temporary, sponsors are offered to newcomers. Many groups have sponsorship committees and announce the availability of sponsors at meetings. Some groups prepare "beginners packets" for newcomers, which include information about sponsorship and lists of members' phone numbers.

Greeters at meetings help new members feel welcome and can encourage them to become active in the group. Many groups regularly announce that beginners are welcome to become members of the group. Sponsors should emphasize the importance of a home group.

The importance of sponsorship in recovery and service is emphasized in pamphlets, by word of mouth, and in workshops. One workshop pointed out that sponsors are helped more than sponsees. Another suggested sponsoring A.A.'s into service by telling them they will learn what happens to their money. It was also mentioned that some oldtimers need to be rejuvenated and encouraged to sponsor new members.

#### **4 "What efforts are being made to inform court programs, treatment facilities, alcohol/drug abuse, and other agencies about what A.A. can and cannot do?"**

Cooperation with the professional community committees and also committees dealing with public information, treatment, and correctional facilities are meeting with court and treatment facility personnel to provide information about A.A. and try to prevent problems before they occur. In communities without



committees, well-informed local members arrange such meetings. Letters to the professional community, with appropriate pamphlets enclosed, are also helpful.

In many areas, groups are responding to referrals from court and other programs favorably; some groups are reluctant because large numbers of referrals may disrupt meetings. Providing professionals with meeting lists of groups which welcome referrals was suggested. Beginners meetings for referrals or special meetings in courthouses to serve as an introduction to the A.A. program are helpful.

The issue of verifying attendance, when required by the court or a referral agency, is a matter of group autonomy. Many members are willing to sign slips verifying attendance, using only initials or first name and last initial.

5 "How are groups in your area cooperating with other self-help fellowships which may be helpful to alcoholics with other problems or nonalcoholics who come to A.A. looking for help?"

In most areas, referrals to other fellowships are made through central/intergroup offices or on an individual basis rather than through A.A. groups. Individual A.A.'s cooperate by helping other fellowships start groups, sharing experience and information about structure. In some areas, A.A.'s meet with court and treatment facility staffs to clarify the purpose of A.A. and educate them about fellowships which address the needs of those with problems other than alcohol. Some groups give newcomers a list of other fellowships on an "as needed" basis.

6 "What problems, if any, is your area experiencing in terms of our Seventh Tradition?"

Some areas reported no financial problems. Many shared that groups are unaware of their financial responsibilities and accumulate excess funds. Some areas mentioned competition for funds between central/intergroup offices and the general service structure. In some areas, funds of groups meeting in clubs are intermingled with club funds. Many districts are in need of money for P.I., C.P.C., and committee efforts.

Groups meeting in facilities which refuse to accept rent maintain the Tradition of self-support by providing literature, donating money for special purchases, or providing some sort of service to the facility.



7 "Some churches and other facilities now ask groups to carry liability insurance. How is this handled by groups in your area?"

Although requiring insurance appears to be a coming trend, most groups have not been asked to do this. When it is required, groups carry liability policies paid from group funds. One workshop suggested that insurance be in the name of an individual member rather than the group. A rider to the facility's policy was also mentioned as a solution. Most reported that insurance policies are not a problem. If insurance is required, groups can get policies.

8 "Discuss how A.A. literature is or is not keeping up with our changing times."

Most workshops were satisfied that A.A. literature is keeping up-to-date. One workshop mentioned that "Letter to a Woman Alcoholic" and "Memo to an Inmate" are out-of-date.

It was suggested that the next edition of the Big Book include more stories about young people and senior citizens. Current A.A. experience is shared in the A.A. Grapevine.

9 "What role can Regional Forums play in responding to everyday problems in A.A. in a changing world?"

Through communication, education, and trust, Regional Forums are an important means of carrying the service message to all areas. Everyday problems surface in the scheduled workshops. One workshop suggested emphasis on "back to basics." More participation should be encouraged. Regional Forums are making the A.A. world smaller through communication.

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### Sobriety—What is it? Can it be defined?

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*The late-afternoon presentation/discussion on Thursday generated thoughtful sharing by Conference members on the nature of "sobriety." The moderator was Mary Phelps, general service trustee.*

### **The gift of sanity**

The dictionary tells me that sobriety is habitual temperance in the use of spirituous liquors; habitual moderation in thought and action; soundness and responsibility. This prompted me to look up sanity and insanity. Sanity is referred to as soundness or health of mind; insanity is unsoundness or disorder of mind, irrational and impractical. To me, sobriety sounds very much like sanity. We talk of being restored to sanity. For those of us who think we never knew sanity before coming to A.A., it is not a matter of being restored to—it is an outright gift.

When I came to you, you talked to me about finding a way to live where we can be happy, joyous, and free. You talked to me about being made usefully whole. You talked to me about ceasing to fight anything or anyone. You told me that alcoholism is a disease that is centered in the mind—an obsession of the mind—coupled with an allergy or compulsion of the body that compels me to drink even against my will.

I spent most of my life looking for and trying to find a way to

live comfortably with myself and the world around me. For many years, this involved the use of alcohol. If I could drink, I could become comfortable with you and with me, shedding my fears, inhibitions, anxiety, bashfulness, and awkwardness. Alcohol was an answer to my living problems, and then it quit working. I could no longer live in my fantasy world, and I couldn't live in the world of reality. Stopping drinking itself did not solve my problems. Sometime after detoxification, the physical craving was gone, but the mental obsession was still there. Physically I was sober, but mentally I was drowning in self-pity and discomfort and totally unable to cope with the world around me.

Today, I believe that sobriety is a way of life. It means being totally free of alcohol—total temperance, total abstinence. It means growing up emotionally—being able to recognize, face, and deal with my emotional problems as they arise. It means growing up mentally—being able to face life and cope with problems on a daily basis. It means growing up or maturing spiritually—not needing to be omnipotent, being able to accept and believe in a Higher Power, to follow directions, to accept situations, people, and things just as they are. Sobriety is a way of life that allows me to find all the things that you talked to me about when I first came to you. I can cease fighting anything and anyone. For me, sobriety is freedom from alcohol coupled with the gift of sanity.

Donald J. Bruner (Southern Minnesota)

### **‘Sobriety is only the first gift’**

Webster defines sobriety as: *the state of being sober and habitual temperance*. So much for Webster. Daily sobriety is the simple aim of A.A., but it is not enough to ensure real living. Sobriety in A.A. is like finding the right road—a road we can travel confidently, knowing we are going in the right direction.

Is sobriety all we are to expect? The Big Book says, “We feel a man is unthinking when he says that sobriety is enough.” According to Bill Wilson, “Sobriety is only a bare beginning; it is only the first gift of the first awakening.” The first promise tells us that “. . . we are going to know a new freedom and a new happiness.” I lost many of my freedoms when I was drinking. I was not free to see beyond myself; the universe revolved around me. I tried to be free of all responsibilities by escaping from life. Drinking built an unreal world for me, and I tried to live in it. I was never free from worry, guilt, lies, excuses, self-pity, anger, resentments, and hangovers. All I really wanted from drinking was the freedom to be myself. The bottom line, however, was oblivion—total freedom from myself.

Through the Twelve Steps, I have received many gifts. By applying these principles, I have gained my freedom—to be myself and like myself as I am, and to become whatever God has planned for me. Today I am free to do the things I ought to do because I want to do them. I am free from worry, guilt, fear, dishonesty, self-centeredness, and loneliness. I am free to acquire new ideas, ambitions, interests, attitudes, and capabilities. I am free to share my experience, strength, and hope with another alcoholic. Thank God for the A.A. Fellowship and the Steps that have allowed me to live in the world with increasing freedom.

Carol King (Western Pennsylvania)

## **No ‘musts’?**

Sobriety is supposed to be “happy, joyous, and free,” but is it? The Big Book promises this form of sobriety, but it also lists certain requirements that have to be met to achieve this. People tell me that there are no “musts” in A.A., but they are reading a different book than I am. There are some very definite musts in my book. Working with others is one that I have seen disregarded, leading to sad results.

Egotistic sobriety possibly may be the saddest of all, i.e., A.A.’s with long-time sobriety who suddenly feel that meetings and involvement of any kind are no longer necessary (unless they are asked to speak). Although I feel bad for these A.A.’s, I feel even worse for newcomers, who are deprived of these members’ experiences.

The dictionary defines sobriety as *the state or quality of being sober*. Too many times, we see A.A.’s half-Step themselves into a clinging sobriety—like the cat hanging on to the pole for dear life, but miserable! They believe the first three Steps will give them what we have worked so hard to get.

Sobriety is also defined as *temperance or moderation, especially in the use of alcoholic beverages*. So says the dictionary; however, it is plain that for alcoholics abstinence is the only answer.

The last definition of sobriety in my dictionary is *seriousness, gravity or solemnity*. How true and untrue this definition can be for different A.A. members! Hotel managers say they have never seen a happier group of people, especially during conventions. Ask a newcomer what he or she was most impressed with at a first meeting, and invariably the answer will be “the laughter.” Laughter is something we had to learn all over again.

Sobriety can be defined in as many ways as there are people sober. Each of us works the same program, but in many different ways. To think it can be defined by a single definition is as ridiculous as my feeling that just because I quit drinking, everyone would see that the sober way of life was the only way. My own sobriety is not perfect, but it’s as good as it can be today. The Power greater than myself that I found in A.A. will see that it remains that way as long as I stay willing and teachable.

Bill Factor (Colorado)

### **Gratitude—the language of the heart**

*The final presentation/discussion on Friday afternoon returned to the Conference theme. Dr. Joan Jackson, Class A trustee, moderated the heartfelt participation by grateful Conference members.*

### **‘Each one teach one’**

Language in all its many forms, is used to communicate. To overcome the problem of communication, scientists have increased the speed, precision, and amount of information to be communicated. With all these improvements in communication, information can be precisely wrong as well as precisely correct, and the deluge of information can sometimes hinder more than help.



*Class A (nonalcoholic) trustees share a Conference meal (left to right): John Norris, Milton Maxwell, Jim Estelle, and Joan Jackson.*

The A.A. members I met at my first meetings informed me that they believed alcoholism was a disease; they were alcoholic, and that meant they had an obsession of the mind to drink alcohol and an allergy of the body that ensured their destruction by drinking alcohol. These members didn't tell me this had already happened to me or that it would eventually occur; they told only their experience. This manner of explanation—communicating their story to me—allowed me to *see* and *hear* this knowledge at the same time so I could either identify or not identify with them. It was one drunk talking *with* another—in the language of the heart.

Dr. William Silkworth told our co-founder Bill Wilson the medical facts of alcoholism in the language of the heart. Some time later, Bill's longtime friend Ebby shared his recovery experience with Bill. Ebby's message was powerful because Bill knew how hopeless a drunk Ebby had been. The language-of-the-heart message given by Bill to Dr. Bob started the A.A. miracle rolling by the ancient method of "each one teach one."

About two years after experiencing moderate success in carrying the message via the spoken word, the co-founders decided to see if the message could be carried by the written word. The book "Alcoholics Anonymous" was published 45 years ago, and we know the success it has had in helping alcoholics and those who help alcoholics. A decade later, the question was: "Can the language of the heart be communicated overseas and in different languages?" We now know it works everywhere on earth.

Communication in A.A. consists of a speaker and a listener; it improves in direct ratio to their mutual needs. There will probably always be newcomers in A.A. (I don't think they'll stop fermenting the grapes). But oldtimers, too, will always need to speak from their hearts to new members in everlasting gratitude.

*Mel Ditty (Western Missouri)*

Overheard in the ladies' room of the Roosevelt after a sumptuous Conference dinner: "Were you able to eat everything?" "Good grief, no! I skipped the vegetables."

## Gratitude requires action

For me, talking about gratitude is a little like being nominated for an award for humility—when you stand to accept it, it is taken away. My sponsor told me, "I never want to hear you talk about gratitude. Gratitude is always expressed in action."

The first time I walked into an A.A. meeting, gratitude was in action. Meetings don't just happen—they are the results of grateful members, from the moment the door is unlocked at the beginning until the last ashtray is emptied and the lights turned off. Grateful A.A.'s regularly take meetings to members who are sick or infirm and to detoxes, rehabs, and prison.

There are three central offices in our area—two run exclusively by volunteers. The third office has paid staff but relies heavily on volunteers to answer phones. Dedicated nonalcoholics give their time, energy, and talents out of gratitude to A.A.

I have taken some inventory in preparing this presentation: At a meeting how many times do I express, "I'm grateful to be here," and then pass when I'm asked to share? When the basket comes around and I toss in my buck, do I think I have contributed? (It is much easier to put in that dollar than to make a commitment to chair a meeting, make coffee, or even stay and clean up.) How many times, when I am engaged in conversation with my friends and an unfamiliar person appears, do I keep talking instead of extending my hand to that person (who may or may not be new)? How often do I get to a meeting early just to stand at the door and greet arrivals? How well or how willingly do I fulfill my responsibility toward our primary purpose—carrying the message?

For me, the best remedy for combating depression is to make a list of all the things I think I'm grateful for: sobriety, faith, integrity, honesty, compassion, and trust. And there are times when I truly experience feelings of gratitude, and I humbly say, "Thank you." (Those times always deal with what I receive versus what I want.) Talking, thinking, and feeling require no action—true expression of gratitude does.

*Peg Smith (Southeastern Michigan)*

## A chance for recovery, for life

How is it possible to sum up the gratitude and love I have for the Fellowship of A.A. Do I tell you about the young woman I sat next to in a sponsorship workshop recently who turned to me and said, "Can you imagine the lives that would have been ruined if the women in this room had not sobered up?" Or do I mention one of the talks at the 33rd General Service Conference that made a real impact on me (the speaker shared from the heart, and her heart was full of gratitude for A.A.)?

Or do I relate how thankful I am for that providential day in 1935 when Bill Wilson paced the hotel lobby in Akron, Ohio, and instead of going into the bar, turned to the church directory and made a telephone call? As a result Bill met Dr. Bob, and they spoke the language of the heart.

From the outset of A.A., this "... strange new flock showed no interest whatever in getting everybody bone dry. They insisted they were concerned only with local imbibers who wanted A.A. Here it was definitely proved for the first time that A.A. could

never become a dry crusade." ("Alcoholics Anonymous Comes of Age," page 84.) My gratitude for the A.A. Fellowship knows no bounds. To know that for the first time in the long history of alcoholism a fellowship is available for all, without any rules, giving each individual a chance for recovery, is reason enough for me to continue to reach out to my fellow alcoholics. Gratitude, the language of the heart, will continue to be spoken by A.A.'s on their journey into the future.

*Elsie Murphy (Arkansas)*

## **New thinking, feelings, and behavior**

The language most often used to convey a message from one person to another is the spoken word. Message conveyance is also possible by nonverbal methods of communication. The method of communication within ourselves (other than talking to oneself) is by feelings. Thus, feelings are the true language of the heart, conveying a message in a very special way.

Gratitude is the state of being appreciative of benefits received. Thus, the starting point of gratitude is to know "what you have." In A.A. to develop true knowledge of "what we have," we start with short messages of good feelings, moments of sincerity, and a special form of honesty. As an alcoholic and a member of A.A., "what I have" and especially my knowledge of what I have continue to change. At first, when I had only a small amount of physical sobriety, my knowledge of what I have included only not hurting physically and, maybe, the fact that my family now talked to me.

A conflict between our values and behavior is the common denominator for all who come to A.A. Without this conflict, we would not have made that all-important decision to surrender. Since in all cases it is behavior that created the conflict, be-

havior must be changed. Professionals tell us that the path to new behavior is, first, to develop new thinking, which then can lead to new feelings; and new feelings lead to new behavior. Our A.A. program of recovery, the Fellowship, and the discovery of a Higher Power are all sources of new thinking. As our lives become filled with this new thinking, we develop new feelings that give us a real grasp of what we have and what this thing called "sobriety" is doing for us.

All these wonderful new feelings start to blossom within us, and our gratitude begins to sing out. With each new day, more gratitude can grow as we continue to develop more new thinking through the A.A. program of recovery. It is important that we remember that these new feelings of gratitude are the link from our new thinking to our desired new behavior. In other words, it's a rough, perhaps impossible, road to sobriety without gratitude.

A recent Grapevine article talked of making a daily list of gratitudes. Such a list, when reviewed regularly, will show a picture of our recovery growth curve. If our gratitude has matured, we will see positive growth. As we continue to grow in each phase, the benefits to ourselves and those around us compound; and our sobriety continues to bloom.

The development of gratitude is critical to recovery. It is also critical that we express our gratitude in the true spirit of sharing. When we try to express our gratitude in words, we fail. Gratitude is best expressed by actions, not words. Sharing, sponsorship, serving—all actions—make those special feelings of gratitude provide fulfillment beyond our wildest dreams. For A.A. members, gratitude begins with new thinking (provided by our A.A. program of recovery) and leads to new behavior (sobriety) through the action process of giving it away.

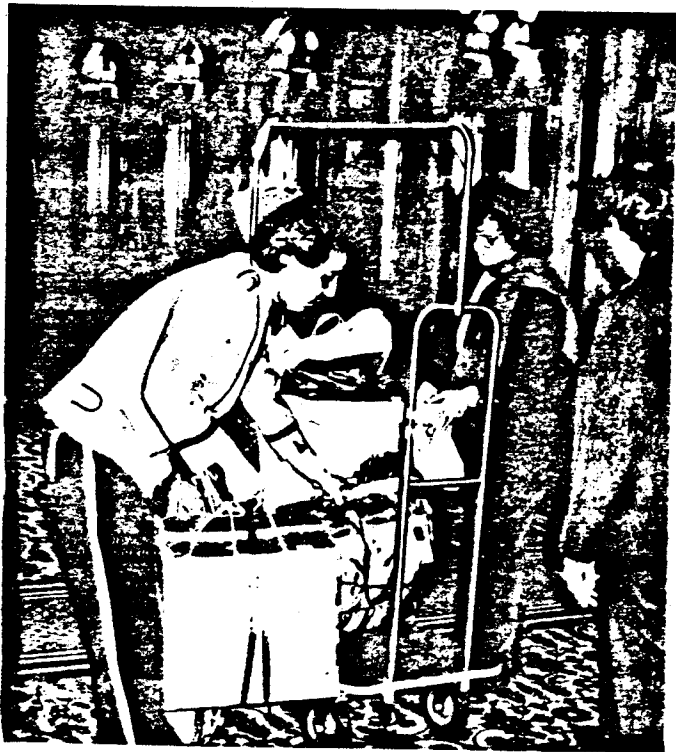
*Joseph E. Rhoads (Connecticut)*

## **History of a title**

When G.S.O. staff members were searching for a title for the new Bill Wilson biography, we received a note of appreciation from a visitor to the G.S.O. Open House. This long-sober A.A. member was impressed at the work done at G.S.O. because it exemplified something that Bill Wilson had said to him back in the 1960's (the only time he ever met Bill). Our visitor had poured out his appreciation to Bill for his sobriety in A.A.. Bill took his hand in his and said simply, "Pass it on." *Voilà!* The biography had a title!

When it was decided to print an excerpt of the visitor's note on the flyleaf of the book, the note was nowhere to be found. No one could remember the writer's name or even the approximate date it was sent, and so there was no way to trace it.

During Conference week, Bob Pearson sat down at lunch one day next to Tom Eser (Panel 34, Maryland). Tom expressed to Bob his enthusiasm at being at the Conference because the whole thing was devoted to implementing the three words that Bill Wilson had said to him the only time he ever met him. Before Tom could get the words out, Bob pounced on him with a whoop and called Vinnie McCarthy over from a nearby table to witness this extraordinary "coincidence" which had saved the day for Bill's biography.



**Alaska:** Districting is really starting to work in our area, and therefore communications have improved. We have 12 areas, 11 of which are very active. (One is being "pumped up" this year in Ketchikan by the past delegate.) The districts are showing signs of friendly competition, and activity is increasing. In December 1983 we voted on a budget to meet expenses. To date we are not doing so well, but we have cooperation throughout the area. We are encouraging service involvement, and one district has already had a successful service conference this year.—*Kathleen Carr*

**Alberta/Northwest Territories:** Our area includes the northern and southern districts of British Columbia. We have 63 districts; 40 cover the two large cities. We do not have a D.C.M. for each district. Our C.P.C. and Archives Committees have just started. Our large geographical size makes it difficult to contact members, and high travel costs prohibit G.S.R.'s from attending assemblies. Communication is our weakest link. We have asked "buddies" to write to groups listed in the A.A. Directory and to Loners in order to start workshops in local roundups. Cooperation with treatment centers is a problem in rural districts.—*Kathleen Tarrre*

**Arizona:** The steady increase in attendance of our G.S.R.'s and D.C.M.'s during 1983 and at the first assembly and sharing session of 1984 can be attributed to: (1) the addition of a panel or committee structure, which closely parallels the General Service Conference committee system; (2) visits by area committee officers and the delegate and alternate to outlying districts, resulting in new groups. The P.I. chairperson held four one-day workshops in different locales. Our C.P.C. and H.&I. chairpersons gave presentations to the annual meeting of Arizona judges and justices of the peace.—*Dave Hill*

**California (Mid-Southern):** During the past two years, some districts were restructured. We now have a district committee coordinator for each restructured district (some districts felt restructuring was unnecessary), which now has a D.C.M. for every 12 to 18 groups. D.C.M.'s may now contact their groups more often, producing more G.S.R.'s and more equality in voting representation. All district coordinators and D.C.M.'s may be nominated for area officers. Attendance at assemblies and committee meetings has increased.—*Frank Sauer*

**California (Northern Interior):** Our November election drew the largest vote turnout and slate available to serve. Our area committee and assembly meetings are well attended. We have redistricted and will do more if needed. We are growing, but may have tried to go in too many directions at once. We hope to improve group registration (about 50% are registered). The format of our area meetings and assemblies has been changed, producing more unity. A liaison between H.&I. and the area has been created. We are concerned about dual addiction and the increase of special-interest groups.—*Les Watson*

**California (San Diego):** Our area is geographically very large. To foster unity, we held our first annual area weekend in 1983—a great success, attracting A.A.'s from all over Southwestern U.S. The format was repeated in 1984. We still have problems: (1) a reluctance by area officers to fund attendance at Regional Forums and the Pacific Regional A.A. Service Assembly by persons other than the delegate although our treasury is full; (2) fostering and maintaining good relations with Spanish-speaking members of District 15, which encompasses all the Spanish meetings in our area.—*Tom McKay*

**Delaware:** We have experienced great progress in P.I. and C.P.C. in 1983 and 1984. Our area is divided into three counties, each with its own intergroup. For over a year, the central and southern intergroups have distributed canisters containing A.A. pamphlets to doctors' offices and clinics. Northern Delaware has two A.A. radio programs a week and a monthly newsletter. In all counties, radio stations air 30- or 60-second announcements; recently one station aired a week-long program on alcoholism. Schools request weekly visits by A.A.'s. Because our D.C.M.'s have not been very active, we are now holding bimonthly D.C.M. dinners.—*Elke B. Forbes*

Joe Rhoads (Panel 33, Connecticut) decided to return to the same local coffee shop for breakfast that he had frequented during the 1983 Conference. He was amazed to see the same waiter doing the same thing he had done a year ago—he pulled out a pint of liquor from a paper bag stashed behind the counter and took a swig. Joe returned to the Roosevelt fully awake and grateful to be sober.

**Georgia:** Our service structure includes a state office, located in Macon. We have 16 districts plus 13 zones, with a total of 29 D.C.M.'s. Our assembly meets three times a year in Macon, a centrally located place. We feel our state office gives us much more unity. In January, 28 D.C.M.'s attended the assembly. We feel that the D.C.M.'s are the essential link in service.—*Frank Rice*

**Idaho:** Our area is growing at an almost alarming rate, with increasing numbers of cross-addicted alcoholics attending meetings. We are open to change in structure and policy to solve these problems. We also encounter ongoing problems such as anonymity breaks and shortages of funds. We are making efforts to enlarge C.P.C., H.&I., and P.I. activity. Our state will host the Pacific Northwest Conference in Boise and the 1985 Pacific Regional A.A. Service Assembly in Pocatello. We hope to do our part at the 1985 International Convention.—*Jeff Hampton*

**Illinois (Northern):** Our area is 16th in new-group registration (second in the East Central Region). We have quarterly assemblies and area committee meetings. We sold 300 "A.A. Service Manuals" in the past two years. Funds are provided for expenses of committee members, including alternates. A free service publication, called "Concepts," is responsible for much of our area growth. We now have seven district newsletters and two intergroup letters. Two districts were split during 1983, and we expect more splits in 1984. A new intergroup was established in Galesburg.—*Jack Ostrem*

**Indiana (Southern):** Last year, after much discussion and many drafts, the State Committee approved a general service structure, forming three new committees: (1) finance and budget, (2) a state convention committee, and (3) a committee to investigate having the new structure printed in a pocket-calendar form. We celebrated our 31st State Convention in March 1984. Also, the young people are planning the Fourth State Young People's Convention in August 1984.—*Charles Asher*

**Kansas:** In 1983 past delegates conducted panel discussions in conjunction with the delegate's report. Our Area Assembly Service Structure Guidelines, adopted in June 1981, are proving very important, allowing present and incoming G.S.R.'s and

D.C.M.'s to find stability. Three Sunday quarterly area assemblies are preceded by workshops, which have helped our assemblies grow. Our bimonthly area newsletter carries group, district, and assembly information. One area objective is to improve communication among the assembly, districts, and A.A. members, especially ways of carrying the message by the assembly and districts.—*Bob O'Rourke*

**Kentucky:** Our area is growing rapidly. Two districts were split in 1983, giving us a total of 21. We hold quarterly assemblies, which rotate among the districts. We are beginning to use our alternate delegate, D.C.M.'s, and G.S.R.'s. We have three intergroup offices serving our state committee. An attendance of 1,600 to 1,800 is expected at our forthcoming state conference. We are currently looking at our state service structure to see if we can make it more flexible.—*Drexel P. Williams*

**Maine:** Things are going good as a result of our work, through trial and error. We are succeeding in P.I., C.P.C., and institutions work. We are busy starting a new central office in Eastern Maine. I believe we are carrying a beautiful message to our schools, jails, and hospitals. We have a lot of pros and cons in coming to an agreement in our area.—*Homer Wilkinson*

**Manitoba:** Our area is divided into 14 districts, each with a D.C.M. We have 130 active groups, from a few to over 100 members. Groups in the north are now using the conference-calling system to hold district meetings. We hold four assembly meetings and four area committee meetings annually. Our active special services committees hold special meetings every six weeks to deal with common problems, and our Winnipeg Intergroup chairperson may soon participate in these meetings. Attendance at area service meetings is good.—*Murray White*

**Maryland:** We have an active area committee, with three area committee meetings and three assemblies yearly. Our delegate has conducted a school for G.S.R.'s, which we hope will continue. Our 14th State Convention will be held in June 1984. Our main concern is the sudden influx of new members to A.A. meetings from the courts, D.M.V., and other state agencies. The controversy is: Are we within the Traditions when signing court-supplied slips and cards? Our C.P.C. and P.I. committees work hard to keep open communication between state agencies and A.A. groups. Open communication also exists with all our intergroups and their C.P.C./P.I. committees.—*Tom Eser*

**Massachusetts (Western):** We have five districts with 130 groups. Four districts are well structured and meet monthly; one district exists on paper only, a problem being worked on by the area committee. D.C.M.'s meet monthly with the area committee and chairpersons of the P.I., C.P.C., Grapevine, and Archives Committees. The area committee holds two assemblies and one roundup yearly as well as workshops, which are conducted by districts on a rotation basis. Our P.I. Committee has established a weekly radio program on A.A. We will have a Young People's Conference in June 1984. Our state convention will be shared with Eastern Massachusetts.—*John Schutt*

### Keeping the memory green

Ken Beckerich (Panel 34, Oregon) vividly remembers being run out of New York City many years ago on his last "running drunk." Returning to the big city for the first time sober and as a Conference delegate, Ken had quite a case of "then and nows."

### Gone and forgotten

On Wednesday morning, Buck Bruner (East Central regional trustee) had been sitting at the front of the Conference room with friends Bob Baetz (Panel 34, Southern Wisconsin) and John Paul Jones (Panel 33, Southern Illinois). He moved to the back of the room. Some time later, Buck received the following note: "Since you moved to the back of the room, the delegate from Alaska [attractive Kathleen Carr, Panel 34] is sitting with us. Thanks for moving! Please, please do not come back!"

**Michigan (Western):** After many years, we are a unified area again. This was achieved by having each district hold regularly scheduled meetings with G.S.R.'s and committee members and by rotating the site of the monthly intergroup meeting. We started a service library where smaller groups can buy Conference-approved A.A. literature. In March 1984 we hosted our second annual statewide service workshop. All institutions in our area were contacted, requesting information on their A.A. meetings; 75% have responded.—*Donald Weaver*

**Minnesota (Northern):** Our area has 19 districts with 420 groups. We have two assemblies and four committee meetings annually, as well as a three-day workshop each fall. Each district is expected to have P.I., Institutions, and Grapevine/Literature Committees whose chairpersons meet bimonthly with area chairpersons of their corresponding committees (this works better in theory than in fact). In 1983 we started an area newsletter. Many districts hold mini-workshops, and we have several annual roundups.—*Bob Picard*

**Mississippi:** Our area is in the process of converting to a committee system similar to the Conference. About four years ago, we started rotating the quarterly area meeting, which has increased interest in service work. We have only five districts, but all have subdivided into at least three subdistricts. We are now redistricting. (The five districts have worked well in holding our Annual Conference, but the size of each district has created problems.) We are showing a steady growth in the number of new groups.—*James Parker*

**Montana:** Our large area is sparsely populated, making communication difficult. We have two area meetings each year. Two annual roundups are well attended. Working with the administrative staff of our state prison has been difficult. Most of our members come to A.A. from treatment centers and do not get involved in Twelfth Step and service work. The few that come directly to A.A. do most of the work. A.A.'s with long periods of sobriety (over three years) will not get involved; those with short periods of sobriety are forced into service too early, usually finishing positions at the district level when they should be starting them.—*Faye Woodall*

**Nebraska:** We are starting a new workshop concept whereby our state workshop committee reaches into remote and less populated areas. All districts have been notified that we are willing to present a program at any time. We purchased a new recording machine in 1983; all state functions will be taped and presented to the Archives Committee. All past delegates were invited to our April 1984 meeting. Plans are under way for the June 1984 state reunion in Kearney. Our main concern is to keep A.A. within the framework of the Traditions.—*Max L. Wilson*



**New Brunswick/Prince Edward Island:** We have one new district on Prince Edward Island; two districts in New Brunswick have joined together for better unity. We now have 12 good working districts. We have two roundups each year along with two area assemblies. All D.C.M.'s and committee people meet twice yearly in Moncton, N.B. We have a new C.P.C. Committee.—*Lee Forsythe*

**New Hampshire:** In February 1983 we moved our area service office to larger quarters. We now have a records room, stockroom, mailing room, and meeting room for committees as well as a work area for our publication committee. By the end of 1983, we sold 3,229 hardcover books, 1,122 soft-cover books, 59 "A.A. Service Manuals," 20,193 pamphlets, 3,632 wallet cards, and 14,000 meeting booklets. We now have about 250 groups and are still growing.—*Tillie McNulty*

**New Jersey (Southern):** We have 256 groups, 19 districts, and four sections. About 25% of our G.S.R.'s are active. Our rapid growth has created a communication problem; therefore we are encouraging D.C.M.'s to plan district meetings. Assembly attendance has increased, and two workshops are planned. We work closely with our three intergroups to avoid duplication of the service committees for institutions, P.I., C.P.C., and treatment facilities. An intergroup workshop held in January 1984 was well attended. Our 20th Southern New Jersey Convention was held in March 1984.—*Ruth Nichol*

**New Mexico:** Group contributions have increased to over 73%. Our area newsletter is carrying more pertinent A.A. information. Workshops, called sharing sessions, are now part of our assemblies. Our popular theatrical group, called the Tradition Players, travels to districts presenting plays about the Traditions. We have a new central office in Farmington. Our assembly has approved the publication of guidelines that follow "The A.A. Service Manual" as well as our own past experience. These guidelines will help new servants learn procedures quickly and encourage greater use of "The A.A. Service Manual."—*Mary Ann Bagi*

**New York (Hudson/Mohawk/Berkshire):** Our area has 12 districts and is geographically the largest area in New York State. In 1983 we added 63 groups, and we now have 383 groups (28 in institutions). Our recordkeeper handles all group changes via computer, resulting in more up-to-date and accurate records. We hold two all-day assemblies a year and bimonthly D.C.M. meetings. Each January we sponsor a service-oriented workshop. In 1984 two major concerns are court referrals and communication to all groups.—*Suzanne Wieland*

**New York (Western):** We have a system whereby each group takes a month to do institution meetings. We have an A.A. meeting in a rehabilitation center, and a meeting was started in a Jewish temple. A lot of young A.A.'s visit our schools. The southern tier has revived the hospital meetings, and many new meetings are being added.—*Elizabeth Garnett*

**Sally Roy (Panel 33, Alabama/Northwestern Florida)** was deeply moved when she met Kathleen Carr (Panel 34, Alaska). When Sally's sister moved from Hawaii to Alaska and sobered up, she chose Kathleen as her sponsor. Lyla Bonney (G.S.O. staff) admits to feeling like the "grandmother"—Lyla, who hails from Alaska, sponsored Kathleen into service work some years back.

**North Dakota:** Our area has eight districts (mostly rural). We gain new groups constantly, and we may be redistricting soon. Most districts hold mini-conferences, but not much interaction exists among groups. Our assemblies are well attended. We have added D.C.M.'s and the chairpersons of the Archives and Grapevine-P.I. Committees to our area committee. There is growing opposition in our groups to people from treatment centers who introduce themselves as "drug-addicted alcoholics." We must come to terms with this problem soon. More dedicated people are getting involved in service work; we find that we have learned and grown a lot in a very short time.—*Agnes Krueger*

**Ohio (Northwestern)/Michigan (Southeastern):** Our area is growing very fast. As delegate, I hope to get to the districts where new groups are springing up through our trusted servants—our D.C.M.'s and G.S.R.'s. Possibly we may try sponsorship for service persons who have started new groups and for our area as a whole.—*Paul Black*

**Ohio (Southwestern)/Kentucky (Northern):** Our area has monthly meetings, alternating assemblies on even months and committee meetings on odd months. We have many concerns: How can we get all groups to be listed, much less to make contributions? Although we have a good turnout for area meetings, how can it be improved? How can we motivate our area to get involved in area functions? This year we will hold a mini-conference in Dayton, Ohio, with presentations, workshops, an Ask-It Basket, and filmstrips; Susan Daly (G.S.O. staff) will be guest speaker.—*Dale Skelton*

**Ontario (Western):** At our two-day assemblies, we hold many workshops. At many past assemblies, some expressed their feelings very aggressively. Most members left feeling worse than when they arrived, and the effect on newcomers was devastating. During the last two years, we opened each assembly with a prayer, asking those present for patience and understanding of everyone's opinion, and for guidance to express our feelings in a calm, positive way. It worked! Now members leave with positive attitudes and in the right state of mind to talk people into service and stay in service themselves.—*Mel Hanna*

**Oregon:** We are most concerned about leadership at the trustee level, especially regarding the future of A.A.—that our Fellowship does not weaken from within. Also, is our Twelfth Step work being diluted? The largest influx of newcomers is from outside agencies—rehab, care units, and the courts; they have the idea that A.A. can cure them of drug, family, and other nonalcoholic problems. Many meetings do not follow our A.A. meeting guidelines. We have seen tremendous growth in 1983, with 84 new groups. We have 27 districts, and we hold many monthly service workshops throughout the area.—*Ken Beckerich*

**Puerto Rico:** Our area has 107 groups divided into six districts. District committee meetings are held monthly, and the area committee meets bimonthly. Assemblies are held twice a year. Our annual convention is in February. We cooperate with government agencies in charge of alcoholism treatment centers, in which weekly A.A. meetings are held. P.I. and C.P.C. committees exist in every district, and we have many TV and radio announcements. We plan to start A.A. meetings in our prisons very soon.—*Jaime L. Rocafort*

**Quebec (Northwestern):** We have over 280 French groups split into nine districts and 24 subdistricts. Subdistricts are invited to the area meeting and represent the group conscience of about 12 groups. Several districts have monthly meetings with all G.S.R.'s. Assemblies are held twice a year, and the steering committee meets bimonthly. Each district holds an annual convention. In 1983 our Sharing Session Committee (school for G.S.R.'s) gave 13 sessions on the Traditions and service structure to our G.S.R.'s and members. We have eight institution committees and 24 weekly meetings in correctional facilities.—*Jean-Marie Alain*

**Quebec (Southwestern):** Our area has 29 districts (five new ones in 1983) and is very well structured. We have 350 French groups, 115 English groups, and five Spanish groups. These groups support an area office with a permanent employee because all information must be bilingual. We have seven permanent subcommittees. Our excitement right now is hosting the 50th A.A. Anniversary International Convention in Montreal, July 1985.—*Georges Filion*

**Rhode Island:** All our seven districts are now active, with monthly meetings attended by 10 to 18 G.S.R.'s and chaired by the D.C.M.'s or alternates. We have active district coordinators on the area P.I., C.P.C., Institutions, and Grapevine Committees, and activity is growing. The Institutions Committee sponsors ten meetings a week at local prisons, while C.P.C. coordinators sponsor-guide medical students to open A.A. meetings and speak at hospitals and mental health centers. Our P.I. Committee handles increasing numbers of speaker requests from schools and works with newspapers and TV. Our structure is strong due, in part, to regular "structure schools" (often chaired by past delegates) in each district.—*Richard Roughton*

**Saskatchewan:** A high level of participation and interest in service was demonstrated at our area elections in October 1983. At our weekend area workshop in January 1984 for table officers and D.C.M.'s, an alternate delegate was appointed as chairperson of C.P.C. and P.I. to improve district coordination. We provided financial assistance for D.C.M.'s attending the Regional Forum in March 1984. One area that needs discussion and planning is institutions and treatment centers, which has been supervised by one individual for a number of years. It is time the assembly took control of this area.—*Jim McNight*

**South Carolina:** We established a new committee—the Permanent Convention Committee, with rotating members of the area assembly—to add continuity and direction to the Annual State Convention Committee. An air of excitement runs through our area as we look forward to hosting the Southeast Regional Forum in December 1984. Members who are not active in service are encouraged to attend.—*Lawrence Shuler*

**South Dakota:** In January and July 1983, we held workshops in Pierre. In March 1983 our state shared the West Central Regional Conference with North Dakota, Minnesota, Iowa, Montana, Wyoming, and Nebraska; it was held in Sioux Falls,

A group of Conference members were riding on the elevator down to the main floor to attend the morning session. When a tourist standing at the rear of the elevator wished to get out, the trusty Conference members took a "sense of the elevator" as to whether to let the person disembark.

S.D. Every May and October we hold a state conference, which alternates between the eastern and western borders. Our area has 15 districts with about 150 groups. Districts 4 and 11 hold monthly G.S.R. and D.C.M. meetings. We also have monthly rotating A.A. and Al-Anon meetings. Our intergroup in Sioux Falls has a 24-hour answering service.—*John Landon*

**Tennessee:** We have 279 groups and 32 districts. We have just revised the service structure and increased the delegate's expenses. We are now forming convention committees. The alternate delegate is forming an Archives Committee. Also committees are being formed to revise officers' petty expenses. Treatment facilities are springing up all over the state, and we have to attract more A.A.'s to treatment work. We are holding D.C.M. meetings and quarterly assemblies. Our G.S.R.'s will soon be studying "The A.A. Service Manual."—*Bobby Melton*

**Texas (Northwestern):** Our area continues to grow, with more interest in service. We have an annual assembly, which is separate from any other A.A. conference. We finally have good group support, and financial pressures are easing, even though we need to improve group participation. Many people are being "sentenced" to A.A. by the courts; a lot of our members regard this as using A.A. as a tool for punishment rather than recovery. Also, some treatment centers are sending nonalcoholics to A.A. Our Institutions Committee works with a federal correctional facility's release program to bring A.A. meetings into five state halfway stations.—*Willard Machen*

**Texas (Southwestern):** Our area has 300 groups divided into 15 districts. In Austin, San Antonio, and Corpus Christi, these districts are subdivided, making a total of 24 districts. We hold two service workshops annually in addition to our Pre-General Service Conference Workshop, which gives our delegate feedback on the Conference agenda. Our first quarterly newsletter was published in February 1984. We have seven service committees, including a bilingual committee for our large Spanish-speaking population. Increasing the activity of these committees is one of our primary objectives.—*Jim Rogers*

**Vermont:** Our area is divided into eight districts, six of which have organized service structures with D.C.M.'s. We have established quarterly area assemblies, with increased attendance. All districts have answering services, and five publish their own meeting lists. To help structure the two unstructured districts, we formed a Service Structure Committee composed of past delegates, committee officers, and elder statesmen. Our Correctional Facilities Committee now has weekly A.A. meetings in our six state prisons.—*Jim Sarvak*

**Wisconsin (Northern)/Michigan (Upper Peninsula):** Our area has 20 districts, and most are active. Since we cover a large geographical area, our goal is to keep all districts updated and informed. Enthusiasm for service is high, and we hold many district workshops. Our Spring and Fall Conferences are successful, and we now have area workshops. Our monthly newsletter is growing. Cooperation with institutions and treatment facilities continues to be good.—*Chris Heindel*

**Wyoming:** Our area is divided into 11 districts, with 91 groups. We hold Spring and Fall Conferences as well as midsummer and midwinter area assemblies, which include workshops. Our monthly newsletter is printed at Rawlins State Penitentiary. We are a little behind most areas, but we are able to learn from experience.—*Robert F. Woods*



# Many Answers Lie in Group Autonomy

Ask-It Basket

## Archives

**Q** Why can't the story about the Washingtonian Movement be made more available?

**A** Since we do not own the copyright on this piece, we can get clearance to do only a limited distribution. It is also rather costly to reproduce, so, at the present time, it is being distributed to the delegates only every other year.

**Q** Is there a pamphlet about the Oxford Movement?

**A** The archives at G.S.O. does have a collection of reference material for those who want to do research on the subject, but the only Conference-approved material we have is what Bill Wilson put in "A.A. Comes of Age" and what appears in "Dr. Bob and the Good Oldtimers."

## Area Committees

**Q** Do most areas have only area committee members attend area committee meetings, or are G.S.R.'s attending these meetings also?

**A** By a show of hands, it was indicated that about one-fourth of the areas present have only area committee members in attendance, while three-fourths do permit G.S.R.'s to attend.

**Q** Do most areas have area officers' meetings? If so, how often?

**A** It was indicated by a show of hands that approximately one-half of the areas present have area officers' meetings. Of those responding in the affirmative, about five have monthly meetings; 15 have quarterly meetings; and 15 meet twice yearly.

**Q** Is there a cutoff date in some areas for G.S.R.'s to be registered with the area to be eligible to vote at the area officers' elections?

**A** While some areas do have cutoff dates, a show of hands unanimously indicated that there should be no limit on the time for G.S.R.'s to register in order to be eligible to vote at the area officers' elections.

**Q** Who stands for area offices in area elections?

**A** This question is dealt with in Chapter IV of "The A.A. Service Manual," entitled "The Area Committee" (pp. 50-51, 1983-84 edition).

**Q** Do most areas rent office space?

**A** A show of hands indicated that eight areas rent or lease office space; and the majority of those responding indicated their areas do not rent office space.

**Q** How do others feel about central offices that sell A.A. literature to treatment centers at A.A. group discount rates?

**A** We do not have any control over the selling or pricing practices of central offices—or anything else they do. There have been instances of central offices buying A.A. literature at the group price and then selling it to treatment centers at the group price plus a small profit. In other cases, they buy literature at the group price and resell it to treatment centers at the retail price, thus making a *large* profit! In such instances, G.S.O. has sent a letter to central offices explaining that this practice is not in the spirit of A.A. However, in reality, there is nothing that we can do about this. It is up to the group conscience of the groups to which the central office is responsible.



One morning, after breakfasting at a local coffee shop, Richard Roughton (Panel 34, Rhode Island) donned someone else's raincoat and left his own behind, with his checkbook in the pocket. He didn't realize the mistake until later that evening when the coffee shop was closed. Returning anxiously the next morning, Richard was stunned when the manager informed him that he had called his home in Rhode Island to let him know the raincoat and checkbook were safe. (This incident dispelled all those rumors Richard had heard about the "evils" of New York City.)

## Conferences and Conventions

**Q** Do any areas have young people's committees dedicated to trying to get the International Young People's Conference to come to their area? If so, are they a part of A.A.?

**A** In order for the young people in any area to bid on the site for the International Convention of Young People in A.A. (I.C.Y.P.A.A.), they must first show that the area service committee supports the idea. Several areas shared that, as a result of having their city as the site for this convention, many young people have been attracted to service and are now G.S.R.'s for their groups. Yes, they are a part of A.A.

**Q** Is it proper to allow pictures to be taken at conventions and open meetings?

**A** This matter would be up to the group conscience of those involved.

**Q** Have groups or state conference planning committees been given permission to use the official A.A. seal or to copy the seal on their flyers for A.A. activities?

**A** Any A.A. entity can use the seal of circle and triangle. The A.A.W.S. Board has given the G.S.O. staff permission to okay the use within A.A. by publishers of newsletters and other A.A. bulletins of excerpts from A.A. literature and the A.A. logo when such requests are made to do so.

**Q** Can we have some sharing on the practice of some members who sell merchandise such as T-shirts and religious music tapes and advertise films other than those distributed by G.S.O. at roundups and state conventions? Are these functions A.A.? Or, like treatment facilities, are they not bound by our Traditions?

**A** It was the sense of the meeting that this practice is against the Traditions and that we should not "peddle" anything but the A.A. message. However, it was also pointed out that we have no control over what an individual can do from his hotel room or outside of the meeting facility.

### Correctional Facilities

**Q** Would it be possible to have soft-cover books made for prisons, since some of these institutions will not permit hard-cover books, which could be used as weapons? It costs \$15 to get one rebound, and they do not last if the cover is just removed.

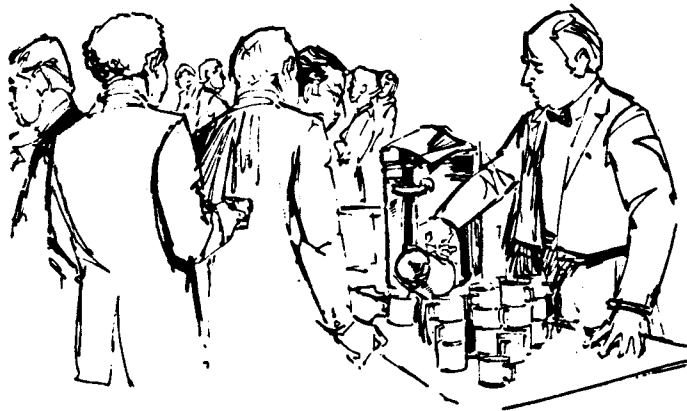
**A** The matter of a soft-cover edition of the Big Book was rejected most recently by the 1983 General Service Conference.

### Directories

**Q** How do other delegates handle requests for directories from treatment centers in their areas?

**A** There was a good deal of sharing on this subject, and it appears that all areas are very cautious about distributing the directories, due to their confidential nature. When most areas receive requests, phone calls are made to the non-A.A. sources of the requests, and the confidential nature of the directories is emphasized. It was noted that, in most instances, there is no reason to refuse such a request.

**Q** A 1972 "sense of the meeting" indicated that Al-Anon Family Groups should not be listed in local A.A. directories. Our small state recently eliminated Al-Anon meetings in our new directories and experienced quite a backlash, mainly from A.A.



members. Now, in 1984, is there a change of feeling on this 1972 decision?

**A** The Guidelines have not changed, and, as with most things in A.A., this would be a decision of local autonomy. It was also noted that some areas which do list Al-Anon in their local directories include a disclaimer on affiliation.

**Q** I would like some sharing on open discussion meetings. For example, when A.A. and Al-Anon members meet together to discuss A.A. material such as the Big Book, the "Twelve and Twelve," etc., can these meetings be listed in the A.A. directories?

**A** No.

### General Service Board

**Q** Might we ask the chairperson of the board to explain how the board came to select as general manager the man who chaired the committee charged with the search? Such procedures are questionable. It would be informative for the Conference to receive an explanation of the procedures and qualifications used. This question is meant to suggest a discussion, not of personalities, but of procedures.

**Q** Is it true that the chairperson of the committee charged with hiring a new general manager hired himself? If he wanted the job, shouldn't he have refused to be on the committee?

**Q** If A.A.W.S. is responsible for running G.S.O., why did the Nominating Committee conduct the search for a new general manager?

**A** Since the responses to the above three questions are inter-related, they are given below in one answer:

Through Concept XI, the trustees' Nominating Committee is charged with assisting in filling all vacancies. This committee established a set of criteria for filling the vacancy of the position of general manager, and one criterion was that persons eligible be either past or current trustees of the Fellowship. An exhaustive search was made to find potential candidates to fill the position. The search was cited in the *Quarterly Report*. Applications were invited from a list of eligible persons because the trustees' Nominating Committee made a considered decision that to place an open invitation would not serve the best interests of the Fellowship. The applications that were submitted were screened by the committee. During the screening process, the chairperson of the Nominating Committee was asked to submit his application, even though he did not want to do so. However, the members of the committee persisted, and the chairperson's name was submitted as a candidate, at which time he was voted out of office as chairperson of the trustees' Nominating Committee. It was pointed out that even though the Nominating Committee is required to submit only one name for approval, the former chairperson of the Nominating Committee insisted that two names be submitted; and it was the final decision of the board that John Bragg was the individual who would best fill the general manager's position.

### General Service Conference

**Q** I would like to suggest that in the future, in addition to names, panels, and area numbers, committee assignments be added to the name tags of delegates to the General Service

Conference. The most common question seems to be: "What committee are you on?"

**A** The suggestion has been noted.

**Q** Could no-smoking tables be provided in the dining room at the Conference?

**A** This could be arranged.

**Q** Is it typical of Conferences that the trustees eat and socialize separately and apart from delegates?

**A** No. It was shared by one delegate that he did have a trustee eating at his table in the dining room.

**Q** Was the Ad Hoc committee report available to delegates before the Conference?

**A** It was sent to all members of the Conference Committee on Trustees and available to other delegates on request.

### **General Service Office**

**Q** Is it proper to address an envelope to an alcoholic G.S.O. staff member using his or her full name?

**A** Since all correspondence to G.S.O. is addressed to a P.O. box number, it would be appropriate to address staff members by their full names.

**Q** Have you ever hired an employee at G.S.O. who did not fit in with this spiritual office?

**A** Yes, this has happened. However, if a new employee is not the kind of person who wants to be of service, he or she generally does not work out and just doesn't last very long.

**Q** What if an alcoholic G.S.O. employee gets drunk? Are they out of a job?

**A** If an A.A. staff member drinks, he or she is out of a job immediately. Drinking or using drugs on the job is cause for instant dismissal of anyone at G.S.O. If a nonalcoholic employee develops a drinking problem and it affects his or her work, we would try to follow the same policy that would apply in any organization—and that is to try to help the employee with the problem, if possible. However, if the problem became so severe that work was drastically affected, the employee would be terminated.

**Q** How holy is the blue letterhead on G.S.O. stationery? Xerox copies do not reproduce the blue color when copied, and the message is carried, but not the letterhead.

**A** There is nothing sacred about it, and it could certainly be changed. In one area a black copy of the letterhead is kept, and when they wish to xerox something on the letterhead, the blue letterhead is cut off and the black is used instead.

### **Group Matters**

**Q** Can a group own or lease a building for their meeting in the A.A. name?

**A** A group can lease a building, but to own a building in the A.A. name would be against our Traditions. It was pointed out, however, that some groups do incorporate and purchase a building as a separate incorporated entity.

**Q** What is the feeling of the Conference about A.A. members

who tape speakers' meetings and then sell the tapes for a profit?

**A** As each group is autonomous, this matter would be up to the group conscience of the group.

**Q** Would it be possible to bring the following definition of an A.A. group to the attention of the Conference this year? "Two or more gathered together for purposes of sobriety who conduct the business of their groups within the Traditions and Concepts of Alcoholics Anonymous."

**A** It has been brought before the Conference. A request to pursue this matter further should be brought to the attention of the Conference Literature Committee for next year's Conference. However, it was felt by some that the six-point definition of an A.A. group is still valid.

**Q** Can you please share a few numbers with us? How fast is A.A. growing? How many new groups are there per week or month? Can we handle (and survive) this flood?

**A** In 1983, there were 4,500 new A.A. groups in the U.S. and Canada. We're growing at better than 10% per year compounded in number of new groups (a 3,500 new-group net total in 1983). The number of members must be growing by at least that rate or more. However, this is only a guess, and we no longer try to estimate A.A. membership.

**Q** When should a new group be registered at G.S.O.?

**A** This should be done when the group feels they wish to be listed with G.S.O. and is a matter for the group conscience to decide.

### **International Convention**

**Q** Please explain why the 1980 International Convention was budgeted for a loss.

**A** This was so because the General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous and the General Service Conference called for it to be budgeted at a loss.

### **Literature**

**Q** Has any consideration ever been given to adding the Twelve Concepts to the book "Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions"? As the Concepts are only in "The A.A. Service Manual," they would no doubt receive more attention if they were included in one of our other books (12 × 12 × 12).

**A** This matter could come before the Conference Literature Committee in 1985. The feeling was expressed, however, that since all three were written by Bill W. and he saw the Concepts as a separate publication, one might feel uneasy about combining them. It was further noted that the Literature Committee has recommended that a pamphlet on "The Twelve Concepts Illustrated" be published.

**Q** Please explain to those of us not familiar with the literature warehouses where they are located, how their location need is determined, and how they work, i.e., inventory owned by whom, costs borne by whom, etc.

**A** Our warehouses and the year in which they were established are as follows: Los Angeles, 1968; Chicago, 1980; Toronto, 1980; Atlanta, 1980; a pick-pack operation for small orders in Toronto, 1982; Minneapolis, 1983; and Calgary, 1984. The need for a warehouse is determined by the volume of growth of A.A. The warehouses are established to expedite the shipment

of literature to members of the Fellowship. A.A. World Services, Inc., owns the inventory and bears the costs of the handling, storage, and document charge for shipping all orders. We have no employees at these warehouse locations.

**Q** Could you please explain the royalties being paid on our literature? (1) On which pieces of literature do we pay royalties? (2) How much? (3) To whom? (4) For how long?

**A** (1) The royalties are paid on the books Bill Wilson wrote and are: Big Book; "A.A. Comes of Age"; "As Bill Sees It"; and "Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions." (2) — (4) The royalties are the result of an agreement between A.A.W.S. and Bill Wilson in 1963. Bill got 15% of the retail value of the books, and Lois was to receive 13 1/2% of the retail value of the books, which she still receives today. As of last year, under the terms of the agreement between Bill and A.A.W.S., Lois could, on a one-time basis, bequeath 80% of the royalties to individuals who were age 40 or more in 1963. The remaining 20% could be left to anyone at any age. This agreement has now been amended, and Lois can leave the royalties to other than an individual, such as a foundation to maintain Stepping Stones. However, any royalties Lois wills to a foundation will terminate ten years after her death. All other royalties will revert back to the board upon the demise of the recipient.

**Q** Why aren't the Guidelines Conference-approved?

**A** The Guidelines are just that—Guidelines prepared as the sharing of experience which has come in to G.S.O. regarding certain issues not of importance to every single A.A. member. They are developed to fill a need, so that the staff won't have to write four- to five-page letters over and over sharing the same information. In 1979, a task force was formed to look into all of our material, including the Guidelines, and, in 1980, a Conference Advisory Action was passed which reads: "Since A.A. Guidelines are a reflection of collective experience that is shared through G.S.O., relating to specialized topics not necessarily relevant to all groups or A.A. members generally (i.e., armed forces, clubs, answering services, occupational programs), the A.A. Guidelines may be produced or revised

when new information or any other contingencies arise, at the discretion of the G.S.O. staff without Conference approval." (A.A. Guidelines on Occupational Programs are no longer printed.) In response to the suggestion that A.A. members would put more faith in the Guidelines if they carried the Conference-approved seal, it was noted that there are no rules or laws or regulations in A.A., and a stamp or seal will not make the Guidelines any more enforceable than they now are.

**Q** There is a reference in the Big Book to the fact that a man may someday land on the moon (Chapter 4). Why not update this with an asterisk (\*), as we have done in other places?

**A** Requests such as this should be directed to the Conference Literature Committee for consideration at next year's Conference.

## Miscellaneous

**Q** Is there some way to stop sexist language?

**A** There was little sharing on this matter. Pamphlets have been degenderized as they are reprinted.

## Public Information

**Q** Please discuss the membership survey. The method lacked credibility in our area, and we are not enthusiastic about a pamphlet based on the results.

**A** The purpose of the survey is to give Conference-wide averages for the U.S. and Canada for use in P.I. material and to update our flyer "The A.A. Member." We believe it provides good statistical credibility for what it is designed to show.

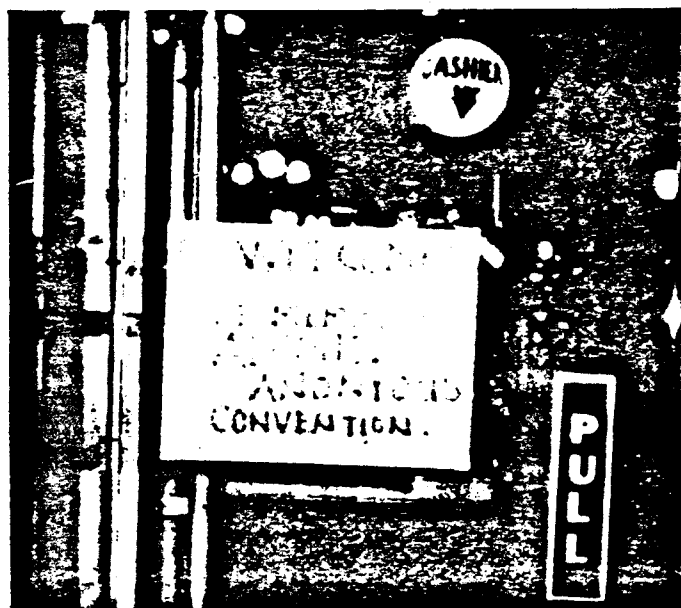
## Regional Forums

**Q** Please comment briefly on the suggestions for improvements which will be tried at the 1984 Regional Forums.

**A** At the Western Canada Regional Forum in Vancouver, British Columbia, the dais on Friday evening was eliminated. Board and staff members sat in the audience and were called up individually to give their presentations. The only people who were on the dais at all times were the regional trustee chairing the Forum, the Forum coordinator, and the assistant coordinator. At the Pacific Regional Forum in May, the Friday-evening dinner for past trustees from the region will be eliminated. Some future plans call for interspersing board and staff presentations throughout the weekend, instead of giving them all on Friday evening, and perhaps using Friday evening to break up into small discussion groups led by a board or staff member. Additionally, Bob Pearson's talk on the history and growth of the Fellowship will be changed from Friday evening to Saturday morning.

## Wrong gender!

On Conference opening day, Peggy Smith (Panel 33, Southeastern Michigan) had arranged to meet her "buddy" Faye Woodall (Panel 34, Montana). Peggy and Faye had corresponded but never met, and Peggy was looking forward to meeting this terrific gal! Imagine her amazement when she was introduced to Faye—a big, strapping man.



The management of a local coffee shop greeted their Conference customers with this sign on the front door (note the spelling of "Anonymous").

# Reports From the General Service Board, Trustees' Committees, and G.S.O.

G.S.B. and  
G.S.O. reports

*These annual reports are submitted to each Conference—via its committees in cases where there are counterparts to the board entities; directly, where there are no counterparts. Unless the Conference as a whole takes some action to the contrary, acceptance of the reports indicates Conference approval of the activities and recommendations included.*

## General Service Board

### Our board of trustees takes its inventory

**Trustees' report:** This has been a turbulent year for the General Service Board, but a watershed year as well. The trustees have spent an immense amount of time and effort in reexamining their functions and responsibilities. For the first time, the board has taken its own inventory, with salutary results. For example, the exercise has sharpened up the *servant* role of the trustees and has thrown new light on their *responsibility*. It has been a year of personal and spiritual growth.

The Ad Hoc Committee, consisting of John Bragg (chairperson), Michael Alexander, David Aronofsky, Bill Flynn, Al Hergott, and Joe Kraus, was appointed before the 1983 Conference to examine the rotation practices of the two subsidiary boards (A.A.W.S. and A.A. Grapevine) and the trustees' committees, and their consistency with the bylaws. Pertinent Advisory Actions of the 1983 Conference were included in the mission. The study led to several milestone recommendations.

The Ad Hoc Committee relied heavily on the Twelve Concepts, written by Bill Wilson in 1960-61. As A.A. has grown, innumerable changes have occurred in the structure, composition, and procedures of the General Service Board. As the Concepts have been reprinted, changes have been made to reflect current practice (usually with bracketed explanations). I have appointed a study committee to examine these changes.

The General Service Board has also spent a great deal of time and thought in a search for a successor to the general manager of G.S.O. Bob Pearson, who intends to retire on March 31, 1987 (at the latest), requested that a successor be found to serve in tandem with him for two or three years. The board concurred; so the Nominating Committee served as a search committee and presented two names to the board. John Bragg was selected. John will resign his positions as trustee and director of A.A. World Services effective May 1, when he will join G.S.O. After an orientation period, he will assume the duties of general manager about August 1, 1984. Bob Pearson will continue to have overall responsibility for the operation of G.S.O. as chairperson of General Services and president of A.A.W.S., and will concentrate on his duties in connection with the General Service Conference, the International Convention, Regional Forums, and the World Service Meeting, as well as General Service Board and A.A.W.S. Board matters.

Finally, the board—specifically, the regional trustees—re-examined Regional Forums, looking at the role they now play and will play in the future. The consensus of the trustees' special meeting was that the Forums are serving their original purpose well and are extremely worthwhile. However, a number of suggestions for improvement were made, which are being tried out in the 1984 Forums.

I now turn to my "State of the Fellowship" message. Despite

certain recurring, troublesome problems that are discussed at the Conference, A.A. has never been in better shape. Over 4,300 new groups listed themselves with G.S.O. (not counting the thousands that do *not* bother to list themselves). After deducting the groups that became inactive, there was a net increase of about 3,500 groups in 1983—a total of over 34,000 regular groups in the U.S./Canada. The groups that support G.S.O. (about 55% of the total) were very generous with contributions in 1983, exceeding 1982 by 9.6%.

A.A. literature sales continue to boom. Last year, more than 543,000 copies of the Big Book were published and distributed (about 18% more than 1982); and A.A.W.S. is budgeting for sales of 600,000 Big Books in 1984. That looks likely, as 60,000 copies were sold in January 1984 alone—3,000 copies every working day! The sales of other books and pamphlets increased 12.5%; 8,900,000 pieces of A.A. literature were distributed in 1983.

Our two operating corporations are both running in the black. I am particularly delighted to report this for the Grapevine because it is a remarkable turnaround. At the end of 1982, the Grapevine reported a loss from operations of \$70,000; just 12 months later, an income of \$13,700. Circulation is up; costs are down. Special projects, such as the overwhelmingly successful GV tape, have contributed to the turnaround.

At this season, exactly the same kind of A.A. General Service Conference is being held autonomously in many parts of the world. This beautiful Fellowship and way of life has leaped over oceans and across the national borders, cultural boundaries, and language differences into 114 countries.

*Gordon Patrick, chairperson*

## Conference recovery

Bob Pearson began Conference week on crutches, having just had a cast removed from a broken leg (a skiing mishap). As the week progressed, Bob's day-at-a-time recovery was evident to all as he became more adept at moving to and from the podium to conduct Conference proceedings.

## A.A. World Services, Inc.

### Multilingual literature; staff additions

**Director's report:** This board met 12 times during 1983. The following significant items are noted:

- We reviewed and recommended to the trustees' Finance Committee the 1983 budget.
- We authorized the transfer of \$655,900 to the General Service Board to cover 1982 G.S.O. operating deficits. We transferred \$200,000 surplus cash in excess of basic operating requirements to the Reserve Fund.
- We reviewed and approved the recommendation of budget additions at mid-year, totaling \$16,800, and recommended that this request be forwarded to the trustees' Finance Committee for approval.

- We approved the action of the General Service Board and trustees' Finance Committee that \$8,700 be added to the budget, representing the cost in 1983 of an ad hoc adjustment to the pensions of those retired prior to 1981 and an amendment to the Retirement Plan regarding preretirement death benefits.

- We approved lending Holland up to \$36,500 to publish 4,000 Big Books in Dutch.

- Phyllis Masback reported on the Second European Service Meeting, held in Frankfurt, West Germany, February 18-20, 1983, where she delivered the keynote address; Susan Daly reported on the Third Ibero-American General Service Encounter in Brazil, July 26-31, 1983.

- We signed an agreement with the Central American Literature Committee in Costa Rica, which now has assumed complete responsibility for publishing and distributing A.A. literature in Central America.

- We hired a new staff member, Eileen Gatz, to replace Beth Kuhlmann, who retired at the end of August. Eileen reported on July 25, 1983. We also hired a staff member, Cheryl Ann Burke, for the position vacant since June Russell's death. Cheryl Ann reported on February 13, 1984.

- We hired Vicente Mejía to serve the Spanish-speaking A.A. groups to bring them into the general service structure and open communications further with the Hispanic A.A. world.

- We opened a new warehouse in Minneapolis, Minnesota; we are also examining the feasibility of opening a warehouse in Western Canada, primarily for literature service to that region.

- We are computerizing mailing lists of D.C.M.'s, recipients of *About A.A.*, P.I. committees, correctional institutions groups, and treatment centers (this was a Conference action); we have also installed an Exxon word-processing system, which will pay for itself through increased productivity and avoiding increases in payroll.

- We forwarded to the appropriate committees the suggestion that Box 4-5-9 be increased by four pages, replacing the *P.I.-C.P.C.* and *Correctional Facilities Bulletins*.

- At the suggestion of some who noted that there were no Big Books in libraries, the trustees' P.I. Committee undertook a mailing of the Big Book to libraries around the country which have purchasing budgets of \$10,000 or more. We have received 500 orders, for a total of 750 Big Books; we also received orders for 55 Big Books in Spanish and 23 in French.

- We approved the following prices for the Spanish translations: "Problems Other Than Alcohol," 10¢; "A Brief Guide to A.A.," 10¢; "A.A. as a Resource for the Medical Profession," 15¢; "G.S.R.," 10¢; "Your A.A. G.S.O.," the first 100 gratis, each additional copy 5¢; and "Inside A.A.," 10¢. Also, we now have available new Guidelines on Carrying the A.A. Message to the Hearing-Impaired Alcoholic, the first ten gratis, each additional copy 10¢; and the new P.I. Display Container was priced at \$1.50.

- During 1983, the board granted 68 requests to reprint A.A. literature and one request to tape-record; four requests were denied.



- Alcoholics Anonymous was one of the 20 winners of the 1983 President's Volunteer Action Awards sponsored by the National Center for Citizen Involvement and ACTION. Dr. Bill Flynn accepted the award, accompanied by Vinnie McCarthy.

At the annual meeting of representatives from G.S.O. with four French-speaking delegates, the French Literature Committee, and the Eastern Canada trustee, a proposal by the Quebec French Literature Service to produce a French translation of "A.A.—An Inside View" was discussed. The committee made the decision to use the present film in its entirety with the English voices, but to tone down the sound track and have two narrators (male and female) do the voice-overs in French.

*Joe Kraus, chairperson*

## Archives

### **First Big Book's dust jackets are restored**

**Trustees' committee:** We met three times since the 1983 Conference. A policy of handling the early Latin American group files was formulated. With the aid of a Spanish-speaking A.A. member, important items will be separated and microfilmed; the balance will be sent directly to the G.S.O. in the particular country.

The Archives Department helped to research a record number of important books and TV shows including elements of A.A. history. Among them are: the P.B.S. program "Nova"; a new Vista program, "We've Been There" (TV Ontario); and a biography of Bill Wilson (A.A.W.S.).

We have repaired and restored 19 original dust jackets from various printings of the first edition of "Alcoholics Anony-

mous." These "circus" dust jackets, so called because of their yellow, red, and black coloring, are rarer than the book and are a favorite with our visitors.

Our new acquisitions include texts used by early A.A.'s and cassette recordings of early members throughout the U.S. and Canada.

We discussed the use of video-cassette recorders in obtaining oral histories, a plan proposed by a Midwestern archival center. Although the use of these VCRs is attractive, serious dangers to anonymity could be encountered. The consensus of the committee was that the advantages were heavily outweighed by the risks to our anonymity Traditions.

*Al Hergott, chairperson*

## Conference

### **New emphasis on Conference committee system**

**Trustees' committee:** Suggestions for the 1984 Conference theme were reviewed, and we recommended to the Conference Agenda Committee (which makes the final selection) that the theme be "Gratitude—The Language of the Heart." We reviewed suggestions received through the Conference Evaluation Questionnaire and the post-Conference sharing session and suggested the following:

- That the delegate chairperson be asked to outline the committee system in a pre-Conference mailing to all delegates and to point out how to make best use of Conference floor time via the committee system.
- That regional trustees discuss the committee system with new delegates at regional conferences of past and current delegates.
- That the selection of Conference committee members take place in mid-December (at the time of the A.A.W.S. Board meeting) in the presence of two trustees or members of this committee, thereby gaining one month in communication time with Conference committee members.
- That in 1984 we provide a history of past Conference deliberations and actions regarding the pamphlet for homosexual alcoholics.
- That we encourage presenters (in presentation/discussion sessions) to pose questions on the subjects they are covering in order to stimulate discussion.
- That we discontinue sending staff and board members to the Al-Anon Conference opening dinner on Monday night since it conflicts with our Conference agenda.

*Natalie Schwanke, chairperson*

**Staff report:** The Conference coordinator is a point of contact among all Conference members and all those serving on the 91 area committees in the U.S. and Canada. In many areas, committees now include alternates at all levels of service. The number of districts has increased, with innovative ways of dividing districts into smaller units.

We receive minutes of most area assemblies and committee meetings and many district meetings, which are circulated among the G.S.O. and Grapevine staffs. They are helpful in keeping up with U.S. and Canada activities.

All A.A.'s are encouraged to submit suggestions for the Conference agenda through the delegates. The suggestions are presented to the trustees' Conference Committee and the Conference Agenda Committee for approval; then they are shared with everyone via the *Quarterly Report*, Box 4-5-9, and the preliminary Conference agenda mailed to delegates in January.

The Conference coordinator assumes responsibility for:

- 1 Collecting ideas for the Conference theme and agenda.
- 2 Serving as secretary of the Conference Agenda committee and the trustees' Conference Committee.
- 3 Handling monthly letters and advance correspondence with all delegates in preparation for the Conference.
- 4 Working with the general manager, office manager, and staff in planning and coordinating the Conference.
- 5 Scheduling and routing all reports and other material for the Conference Manual, Early Bird Box 4-5-9, and the *Final Conference Report*.
- 6 Reviewing minutes, reports, and all communications received from area committees and D.C.M.'s.
- 7 Coordinating the annual Open House at G.S.O.

In November we held our Open House. More than 700 visitors from the U.S. and Canada toured the G.S.O. and Grapevine offices. Lunch was hosted by the Southeast New York Area Committee at the Norman Thomas High School cafeteria. Then, in the school auditorium, staff members described their assignments (written narration was provided in Spanish and French). A.A. films were also shown, with Spanish or English narration. Our next Open House at the General Service Office is scheduled for September 29, 1984.

*Lois Fisher*





## Cooperation With the Professional Community

### **Cooperation with N.A. grows**

**Trustees' committee:** During 1984, we completed discussions of work begun during 1982 and developed several new areas of interest. The subcommittee that evaluated literature for the legal profession reported that enough literature is available and suggested that a guide letter be included in the C.P.C. Workbook to be used by local C.P.C. committees to inform the legal profession about A.A. as a resource. The letter written by the subcommittee was accepted. Another subcommittee studied literature for educators and concluded that a guide letter by C.P.C. committees would be the most effective approach; the letter was composed and accepted.

We discussed the 1972 letter sent by G.S.O. to treatment facilities explaining A.A.'s purpose and function. The committee felt that the letter could be a useful tool for C.P.C. committees; after being updated and with the incorporation of information about N.A. (Narcotics Anonymous), the letter was accepted.

Representatives from N.A. attended two of our meetings and told us about the organizational and development problems they are having, as well their phenomenal growth in recent years. A G.S.O. staff member attended N.A.'s 13th World Convention. The importance of cooperation between N.A. and A.A. and the gratitude felt by N.A. members for the sharing of our A.A. experience led to a very beneficial exchange.

We are discussing the revision of the service piece, Memo on A.A. Cooperation in Research and Non-A.A. Survey Projects. A subcommittee is examining it for possible updating and removal of restrictive language, as a result of increasing pressure for research into A.A.'s effectiveness and the need for the Fellowship to clearly understand its position regarding cooperation with researchers.

A proposal was made to expand Box 4-5-9 to include the *P.I.-C.P.C. Bulletin* to gain a wider readership. We were somewhat hesitant about this step and cautioned that it be done on a trial basis, and that the identity of the C.P.C. material be maintained.

The *About A.A.* bulletin continues to be a satisfactory vehicle for information to professionals, and we were particularly pleased with the most recent edition, which was devoted entirely to Dr. Ken Williams's article concerning A.A. members and the use of drugs and medication.

We are aware of the rapidly increasing number of C.P.C. committees throughout the U.S. and Canada, the increasing demand for the C.P.C. Workbook, and the principal focus on C.P.C. activities at Regional Forums. All this activity underscores the fact that C.P.C. is one of the most important areas for service work at this time.

*William Flynn, M.D., chairperson*

**Staff report:** We have six Professional Exhibits, which are sent to conferences of national professional organizations. In 1983, our exhibit was shown at 25 meetings and resulted in over 2,000 requests for additional information. These exhibits, staffed by local C.P.C. or P.I. committee members, are a successful tool in carrying the message to professionals. They also help in-

crease the *About A.A.* mailing list, which is now over 13,500.

The C.P.C. staff member sometimes attends annual meetings of national organizations dealing with alcoholism, and serves as a representative of A.A. in a liaison capacity on the Advisory Council to the National Institute on Alcohol Abuse and Alcoholism. A.A. is also asked to conduct workshops at such annual meetings as the National Council on Alcoholism Forum; last year, our workshop was "For A.A. Members Employed in the Alcoholism Field: How to Keep Identities Separate."

Other meetings that staff or board members have attended or participated in are: Summer School of Alcohol Studies, Rutgers University; Eighth Southeastern Conference on Alcohol and Drug Abuse, Atlanta, Ga.; N.A. World Convention, New York, N.Y.; National Conference of Alcohol and Drug Problems Association, Washington, D.C.; Continuing Education Course for Physicians on Alcoholism and Drug Misuse, New York, N.Y.; Edgehill/Newport (a treatment center), Newport, R.I.

C.P.C. committees have increased significantly over the past year, with over 300 now listed at G.S.O. New committee chairpersons receive the C.P.C. Workbook free; additional copies cost \$7 each. A selection of complimentary C.P.C. literature and service material is sent to new C.P.C. committee members as well as the *P.I.-C.P.C. Bulletin* and *About A.A.*

Concerning dedicated workers in the alcoholism field and related professions, Bill wrote (in the Grapevine article "Let's Be Friendly With Our Friends"): "Every one of these pioneers in the total field will generously say that had it not been for the living proof of recovery in A.A., they could not have gone on. A.A. was the lodestar of hope and help that kept them at it. So let us work alongside all these projects of promise to hasten the recovery of those millions who have not yet found their way out. These varied labors do not need our special endorsement; they need only a helping hand when, as individuals, we can possibly give it."

*Curtis Monahan*

## Correctional Facilities

### **New workbook is prepared**

**Trustees' committee:** The 1983 Conference asked this committee to develop a Correctional Facilities Workbook. A draft of this workbook is being presented to the Conference committee for approval.

We sent a letter explaining the Institutions Correspondence Service to delegates and correctional facilities chairpersons, asking for A.A. volunteers to write to inmates on an individual basis; similar letters will be sent every six months.

"Carrying the Message Inside the Walls" is now available in Spanish; the pamphlet "It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell" has been translated into Spanish and will be available soon. We have prepared a draft of suggested minor editorial amendments to the pamphlet "A.A. in Prisons," which are being presented to the Conference committee.

The list of inmates wishing correspondence on the Institutions Correspondence Service has been updated and mailed to the 605 "outside" A.A. members who are presently corresponding with "inside" A.A. members.

A joint meeting of our committee and the trustees' Committee on Treatment Facilities explored the feasibility of combining a proposed Treatment Facilities Workbook with our workbook. It was a consensus that the Correctional Facilities Workbook stand alone.

*Jim Estelle Jr., chairperson*

**Staff report:** As of March 1, 1984, there were 1,344 A.A. groups (more than 42,000 members) in correctional facilities; they are served locally by 278 institutions committees.

Each A.A. group meeting in a correctional facility is sent a Group Handbook, which contains Conference-approved pamphlets directed to inmates and the *Directory of A.A. Groups in Correctional Facilities*. Each prison A.A. group also receives the Big Book, other complimentary literature, the *Correctional Facilities Bulletin* (three times a year), and Box 4-5-9 (bi-monthly).

Discount packages of A.A. literature (English, Spanish, and French) are available to "inside" groups and institutions committees. The Grapevine gives us back issues, which we pass along to groups that ask for more literature. Guidelines and pamphlets are available for A.A.'s interested in institutions work; complete kits are sent to new chairpersons. A.A. films and filmstrips are lent without charge to correctional facilities groups.

The staff member on this assignment answers all correspondence from inmates and institutions committees. She writes about 500 letters a month; reads newsletters and minutes from institutions committees and inside groups; and writes the *Correctional Facilities Bulletin*, utilizing inmate and area sharing. When an inmate is ready to be released, she works with the local institutions committee, intergroup or central office, A.A. group, and prison sponsors to obtain a prerelease contact. Frequently, inmates contact her for help in bringing "outside" A.A. members to share at prison meetings.

The Institutions Correspondence Service now has 605 A.A.'s who share their experience, strength, and hope with inmates. Suggested guidelines are sent to all who participate, both inmates and "outside" A.A.'s. Despite efforts to interest more female inmates in this service, 96% of the mail received from inmates is from male A.A. members.

G.S.O., correctional facilities committees, and "outside" and "inside" sponsors all work together to help carry the A.A. message of recovery to inmates who are looking for the A.A. Fellowship and who want to live sober, one day at a time.

*Eileen Gatza*

### **Sedentary philosophy**

During an afternoon coffee break, Joan Ullom Sheridan (West Central U.S. regional trustee) pondered the endless sitting required by Conference members: "The mind can comprehend only what the seat can endure!"

## **Finance**

### **Contributions rise, but group support lags**

**Trustees' committee:** The committee heard reports on G.S.O. and Grapevine operations, reviewed and approved budgets, supervised the administration of the Reserve Fund, and continued to monitor group contributions as to their sufficiency in relation to the cost of servicing our ever-expanding Fellowship.

We are happy to report that even though contributions had been running behind budget for the first nine months of 1983, they finished up pretty much on target. Contributions from groups and A.A. members exceeded the 1982 total by \$168,700. (Unhappily, this wonderful support is still coming from not much more than one-half of the groups.)

After reviewing the G.S.O. publishing operations, it was noted that sales finished up a strong 12.7% over 1982. After a 6% discount allowed to A.A. groups, sales showed an increase of \$567,100. Expense increases were as anticipated, reflecting growth and, to some extent, continuing inflation erosion. Total operating expenses were slightly under budget: \$49,300 or 1%.

The A.A. Grapevine reported that total income was \$59,500 over budget and expenses were \$3,900 less than anticipated. This resulted in an income of \$13,700 as compared with a budgeted deficit of \$49,800.

Budgets were reviewed in depth, and 1984 budgets were approved. For G.S.O., sales have been budgeted to show an increase of 10%; contributions, 11%; operating expenses, 9.5%. For the Grapevine, income is expected to be 5.7% higher than 1983; expenses, 4.9%. A net income of \$27,200 is budgeted for 1984.

We cannot seem to get more groups participating in the Third Legacy structure. Even though contributions have increased, the percentage of groups contributing continues to lag. The committee will continue to encourage broader support of general services, with the help of the new flyer stressing the Regular Contribution Plan.

*Dennis Manders, assistant treasurer*

## **General Sharing Session**

### **Leadership; committee system; central offices**

In July, our topic of discussion was "What's on Your Mind?" Two presentations were given: "Leadership" and "Principles Before Personalities." The ensuing discussion centered on leadership. Most felt that leadership is not promoted but evolves by example, that it emerges from the group conscience, and that our leaders do not drive by mandate—they lead by example.

"The Committee System" was the topic in October. Two excellent presentations were heard: "The History of the Committee System" and "The Committee System — Its Problems." In the lively discussion that followed, it was felt that, during the pre-Conference orientation session, regional trustees might communicate to delegates the purpose of the committee system,

its vital importance, and the necessity to trust these committees. It was felt that delegates should be encouraged to read the Concepts prior to the Conference, and it was suggested that staff, trustees, and delegates do their inventories regarding their implementation of the committee system. All concluded that there is no alternative to the committee system that would get the same amount of work done.

In January, the topic was "Should Central Offices Become a Part of the General Service Structure?" Most participants felt that some kind of communication system needs to be set up between central offices and the general service structure. Some felt that the two service entities serve different functions: General services respond to A.A. as a whole, and central offices respond to specific local issues. However, there are overlaps (in P.I., C.P.C., institutions, etc.), which cause divisiveness. It was noted that in some areas competition exists now between the two service entities. It was felt that the idea might be discussed at Regional Forums. One discussion group asked, "How could we help A.A. by integrating central offices into the structure?" Another group answered, "Cooperation carries the message better than territorialism."

*Joan Ullom Sheridan, chairperson*

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### **Group services coordinator**

#### **Demand for services increases as A.A. grows**

**Staff report:** The primary responsibility of the group services coordinator is to provide communication services to the Fellowship as a whole. The service coordinator supervises production of all service material, updating of Guidelines and listings, Group Handbooks, G.S.R. Kits, and other material. She works closely with the staff coordinator and other staff members on the literature and Conference assignments.

Periodically, this coordinator conducts a G.S.O. service meeting in which the service assignment of each staff member is discussed and suggestions for improvement and/or change are offered. Overall staff activities are also discussed, such as area trips, answering correspondence, and writing committee reports. The group services coordinator is a member of the Office Policy and Procedures Committee, which meets weekly.

The 1974 Conference recommended that delegates assume responsibility for all directory information in their areas. Preparation for the directories starts in August, when letters go out to all delegates asking when they would like to receive printouts, starting September 1. Beginning in 1983, all delegates received two sets of printouts. Also, delegates are asked if they prefer having the printouts mailed to someone other than themselves. Delegates are asked to return only printouts with changes. The deadline for information to be included in the directories is January 15. Contributions of Loners will no longer be listed in the directories by state and country, but will be totaled and listed on the statistics page.

In 1983, 4,343 new groups in the U.S. and Canada were listed and processed at G.S.O.; 847 groups were inactivated. New groups receive a Group Handbook, a G.S.R. Kit, and a complimentary supply of literature, *Box 4-5-9* bimonthly, and the

appropriate regional A.A. directory when issued. We list more than 1,000 French-speaking and 400 Spanish-speaking groups, and the Group Handbook, the G.S.R. Kit, and *Box 4-5-9* are available in these languages. (There are three Group Handbooks: regular, Correctional Facilities, and Treatment Facilities.)

There are now 13 Guidelines, the newest being Carrying the A.A. Message to the Hearing-Impaired Alcoholic. As the need arises, Guidelines are updated to keep up with current trends. Material pertaining to services provided by G.S.O. is available on request, for example, lists of A.A. members who wish to exchange tapes or correspond, Loners, Internationalists, and deaf groups.

"A Brief Guide to A.A.," "A Newcomer Asks," "Is A.A. for You?" and the Twelve Steps have been rewritten in easier language for hearing-impaired alcoholics who have difficulty in reading; anyone with a reading disability might find this material helpful.

Literature kits for special purposes are sent either on a complimentary basis or in response to orders. The service coordinator is responsible for keeping literature kits up-to-date and available.

Three 16mm films are available: "Bill's Own Story," "Bill Discusses the Twelve Traditions," and "Alcoholics Anonymous—An Inside View." The first two are restricted to A.A. and Al-Anon groups (1974 Conference action); the third is available for use outside A.A. as well. (The films rent for \$35 per week but are distributed free to A.A. groups in correctional facilities. They are also available on an open-ended, long-term lease basis.) Three filmstrips are listed on the order form: "P.O. Box 459" and "Circles of Love and Service" may be purchased at \$6.50 each for group meetings, assemblies, and conventions; "Markings on the Journey," the archives filmstrip, is available in English and Spanish for \$8.50 and may be viewed only within A.A.

*Helen Turnquest*

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### **International/World Service Meeting**

#### **Eighth W.S.M. scheduled for October 1984**

##### **Trustees' report:**

**International**—This committee serves as a link between the World Service Meeting and the General Service Board; as host to the World Service Meeting when it convenes in New York; as a focal point for information about A.A. around the world; and as overseer of the overseas assignment at G.S.O. We discuss how to help A.A. growth in countries where it is just getting started. But now, with the proliferation of growth and structure of A.A., countries overseas are sponsoring other countries, and G.S.O.'s around the world are sharing their experience with the A.A. worldwide Fellowship. By means of the World Service Meetings, as well as the European and Latin American interim meetings and the ongoing exchange of news and ideas, we are learning from each other and doing together what we could not do alone.

We discussed our concern about countries that cannot afford to

come to the W.S.M. and recommended that the W.S.M. discuss the possibility of setting up a special fund, under its own administration and control, and that the General Service Board U.S./Canada support this fund, pending approval by the Eighth World Service Meeting in October 1984.

Our committee recommended to our board that we invite W.S.M. delegates to be our guests at the New York Intergroup dinner, October 27, 1984. On the preceding day, they will meet our trustees at an information reception and a planned sharing session. One or two informal panels will be set up on "Challenges Throughout A.A." This recommendation was approved by the board in November 1983.

*David Aronofsky, chairperson*

### Staff report:

**Overseas**—The staff member on this assignment corresponds with 31 G.S.O.'s and literature distribution centers outside the U.S. and Canada: in Argentina, Australia, Belgium (French-speaking), Belgium (Flemish-speaking), Brazil, Colombia, Costa Rica, Dominican Republic, El Salvador, Finland, France, Great Britain, Guatemala, Honduras, Iceland, Ireland, Italy, Japan, Mexico, Netherlands, New Zealand, Nicaragua, Norway, Paraguay, South Africa, Spain, Sweden, Switzerland, Uruguay, Venezuela, and West Germany.

When letters are received from groups and individuals in those countries, they are encouraged to correspond with their own G.S.O.'s. If an overseas G.S.O. then needs a more detailed sharing of experience, it contacts G.S.O. U.S./Canada. For such countries, we list only English-speaking groups and contacts, intergroups/central offices, and Loners. Travelers are encouraged to contact those offices for up-to-date meeting information. G.S.O. U.S./Canada is grateful for up-to-date information from traveling A.A.'s about A.A. in other countries. In 1983 we distributed 10,000 copies of the *International A.A. Directory* to overseas travelers and groups.

Correspondence from countries where there is no service center or office is answered by the staff member on this assignment. We work closely with such countries to help them establish A.A. structures. Guidelines for this purpose are available from G.S.O. Correspondence that comes to us in a foreign language is translated, and a response is sent in the same language. We have translators (A.A. members) for 27 different languages; translators (A.A. members) are needed for Persian, Russian, and Polish.

To protect A.A.'s copyright, careful consideration is given to granting overseas boards and centers permission to print A.A. Conference-approved literature. A request should come from the board; and before any printing begins, G.S.O. first explores the way the material will be financed and distributed. The request for permission to print or reprint is then presented to A.A.W.S.

Here are some brief and most recent highlights about A.A. overseas:

- **Poland**—Thirteen A.A. groups have begun. They are working on forming an intergroup in Warsaw; they are also forming a translations committee to carry the A.A. message in Polish.

- **Italy**—Permission to print all A.A. books and pamphlets in Italian was granted by A.A. World Services, Inc.

- **Holland**—Permission to print the Big Book in Dutch was granted by A.A. World Services, Inc.

- **India**—Information was requested to start a G.S.O. in Bombay.

- **Interim Zonal Meetings**—Phyllis Masback, G.S.O. staff, attended the Second European Service Meeting in West Germany, February 18–20, 1983; Susan Daly, G.S.O. staff, attended the Third Ibero-American Service Meeting in Brazil, July 26–31, 1983. A.A. growth is phenomenal in Europe and Latin America. Interim zonal meetings are extremely effective—where there is structure, there is growth.

**World Service Meeting**—The World Service Meeting meets biennially at locations alternating between the U.S. and overseas. Delegates to this meeting serve for four years and attend two Meetings. Delegates should be legal residents and preferably citizens of the countries they serve. It is recommended that a country be represented either by two A.A.'s or by one A.A. and one non-A.A., with one delegate being a member of the country's general service board or national service committee, the other a salaried or volunteer staff member. For maximum participation, delegates need a working knowledge of English.

The Eighth World Service Meeting will be held October 21–25, 1984, in New York City at the Roosevelt Hotel. The theme is: "The World Service Meeting Takes Its Inventory." The W.S.M. will be attended by over 37 delegates from 27 countries. Simultaneous translations in Spanish and English will again be provided for the general sessions. A *Final Report* of the Eighth World Service Meeting will be available in early 1985.

*Susan Daly*

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### International Convention/A.A. Regional Forums

#### Convention plans; changes in Forum format

#### Trustees' committee:

*International Convention*—This report was given as a presentation (see p. 12).

**Regional Forums**—To date, 33 Forums have been held, each region now having hosted four. There have been additional Forums for a few areas where, because of special circumstances (e.g., climate or location), members were unable to attend the Forum in their regions. Last year, one was held in Newfoundland. In 1983, Forum registrants continue to indicate that at any given Forum, well over one-half are attending their first one. It is clear that Forums can help stimulate service in areas where it has been somewhat lacking. For example, P.I. and C.P.C. committees were formed in one area after a Forum.

We discussed the trend of increasing costs of hotel meeting-room space and felt that if no other way to solve this problem is found, then we would have to go with higher rates. We discussed changing the format of Regional Forums to make

them more informal. Suggestions will be tried out at upcoming Forums. We also discussed the importance of rotation of sites in a region to be as fair as possible to as many members as possible and to reduce requests for "special" Forums.

The *Box 4-5-9* calendar keeps the Fellowship informed of Regional Forums. The following is a schedule of future Forums:

|               |                |                        |
|---------------|----------------|------------------------|
| 1984          |                |                        |
| March 2-4     | Western Canada | Vancouver, B.C.        |
| May 18-20     | Pacific        | Seattle, Wash.         |
| July 13-15    | Hawaii         | Honolulu, Haw.         |
| September 7-9 | Eastern Canada | Sault Ste. Marie, Ont. |
| December 7-9  | Southeast      | Charleston, S.C.       |
| 1985          |                |                        |
| March         | West Central   | (tentative)            |
| May 3-5       | East Central   | Green Bay, Wis.        |
| September     | Wyoming        | Sheridan, Wyo.         |
| December      | Southwest      | (tentative)            |

*Kenneth Dunphy, chairperson*

#### Staff reports:

**International Convention**—Our 50th Anniversary International Convention will be celebrated in Montreal on Thursday, July 4, through Sunday, July 7 1985. Four A.A. committees are working on the Convention: trustees', Conference, Host, and G.S.O. Planning. The staff secretary coordinates and serves as secretary to these four committees. She is also the liaison to the Al-Anon planning committee.

The major events—the flag ceremony and the Big Meeting (Friday night), the professional entertainment (Saturday night), and the Spiritual Meeting (Sunday morning)—will be held at the Olympic Park Stadium, which is a Metro ride from the Convention Center. The brand-new, modern, three-floor Convention Center, completed less than a year ago, is convenient to all major hotels. The bottom floor, the Exhibition Floor, is where we will hold registration; the middle floor, the Convention Floor, which seats over 9,000, is where we will hold our panels and workshops on Friday and Saturday; the top floor houses a cafeteria and bar-restaurant. The opening dances (Thursday night) will be held at the Convention Center. Alka-thons and some special meetings will be held at the hotels.

Registration forms for the Convention will be mailed to all groups around the world in September 1984, and will contain a list of the hotels and motels, prices, and a map of the locations. The rooms will be made available on a first-come, first-served basis.

No matter where our members will be coming from, they will find that getting to Montreal is a breeze. The city has two international airports, with connections throughout the world. It also has easy rail and bus connections.

Frank Gay (Panel 33, Eastern Massachusetts) spotted Eileen Gatz (G.S.O. staff) on the hotel elevator. Eileen (who is diminutive in stature) was heavily laden down with briefcases, boxes, manuscripts, and various other paraphernalia. "Wow, you must be Vinnie!" exclaimed Frank, mistaking Eileen for Vinnie McCarthy, the G.S.O. staff member on the "weighty" literature assignment.

We are looking forward to celebrating A.A.'s Golden International Convention with A.A. members from more than 30 countries.

*Sarah Price*

**Regional Forums**—This assignment involves coordinating plans for Forums with the regional trustee, delegates, host-city contact person, and general manager of G.S.O. The coordinator makes arrangements with the host-city contact (local liaison) and the hotel; makes travel and hotel arrangements for trustees and G.S.O. staff; handles mailings to the region's delegates (asking for agenda suggestions) and to G.S.R.'s, D.C.M.'s, area committee officers, central offices, past delegates, and past trustees; puts together agendas, formats, etc., at the request of the regional delegates and trustee; and is responsible for display boards of literature and service material. Reports of Forums are sent to all participants, trustees, and current delegates. (Any A.A. member who wishes to attend a Forum may request a registration/reservation form from the Regional Forum coordinator at G.S.O.)

Forums are held on the invitation of the region, and plans are made with the regional trustee, the delegates from areas within the region, and the G.S.O. staff. Board personnel who have attended include: trustees, G.S.O. and Grapevine staff members, and A.A.W.S. and Grapevine directors. The board pays hotel, meal, and travel expenses for all its personnel; expenses for the region's service people are the responsibility of either the individuals or area committees. Most regions have had the opportunity to host four Regional Forums; this year a special Forum will be held for Hawaii.

*Helen Turnquest*

#### Internationalists, Loners, LIMs

#### Meeting-by-mail links 2,500 A.A.'s

**Staff report:** "... I want the hand of A.A. always to be there." A Loner from Israel writes: "When I first started writing contacts through the Loners program, I got one reply. After you printed my request for letters in the *L.I.M.*, I got 52 replies!" As the name implies, Loners are A.A.'s who are unable to attend meetings because there are no groups nearby. There are now over 500 Loners in 87 countries.

LIMs are A.A.'s who are housebound because of a long-term illness or physical disability. We now have 65 LIMs in the Loners/Internationalists Group. Seagoing A.A.'s are known as Internationalists, and their numbers continue to grow. There are now about 600 Internationalists and Port Contacts; 42 Internationalist groups meet aboard ships or in ports. Loners, LIMs, and Internationalists stay sober reading A.A. literature and sharing A.A. experience, strength, and hope with other A.A.'s around the world through letters and tapes.

A literature package is sent to each new loner, LIM, or Internationalist. They also receive lists of Loners, LIMs, and Internationalists and the bimonthly bulletins *Box 4-5-9* and *Loners-Internationalists Meeting (L.I.M.)*, a discussion meeting in print, sharing excerpts of letters received at G.S.O.

A growing number of A.A.'s serve as Loner Sponsors, sharing group activities and personal experience with Loners, LIMs, and Internationalists. With approximately 2,500 A.A.'s participating in the Loners-Internationalists meeting-by-mail, we might call it the largest A.A. group in the world. A.A.'s phenomenal worldwide growth can be attributed largely to Loners in distant lands and Internationalists sailing the seven seas who carry the A.A. message wherever they are.

Phyllis Masback

### Enough is enough!

On Friday morning, Conrad Cooley (Panel 33, Northeastern Ontario), chairman of the Conference Literature Committee, paused halfway through reading a lengthy report, looked at the light on the podium, and wearily asked, "Why isn't the yellow light coming on?"

## Literature

### A busy year for carrying the message in print

**Trustees' report:** Since the 1983 Conference, we have reviewed the following projects:

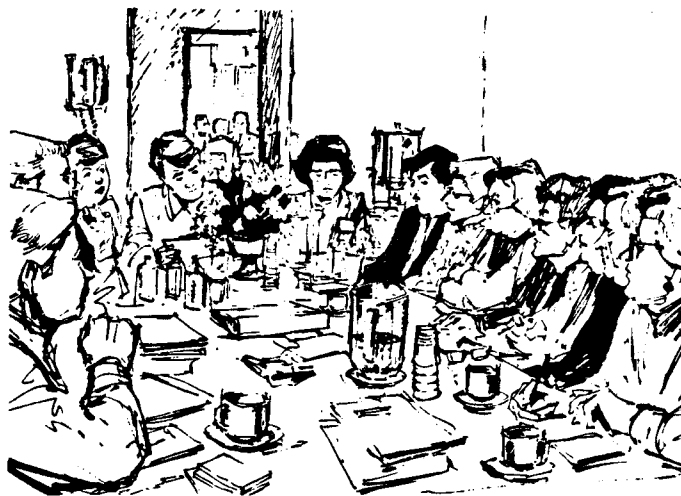
**Projects Completed**—We forwarded to the Conference Committee the following items for consideration: "Pass It On" (draft of Bill Wilson's biography); "A.A.—The First 50 Years" (draft of an illustrated history, to be distributed initially at the 1985 International Convention); an updated G.S.O. filmstrip to replace "P.O. Box 459"; and a revision of "The A.A. Member and Drug Abuse." In accordance with a 1983 Conference recommendation, a draft of a pamphlet for the homosexual alcoholic went to all 1984 Conference members.

We determined that we should not develop a pamphlet or manual for intergroup/central offices; but at the request of the A.A. member who submitted this suggestion, we asked the Conference committee to review the suggestion also. Following up on a suggestion to develop guidelines for literature chairpersons, we surveyed the literature chairpersons listed at G.S.O.; since we heard from very few of them, we agreed that guidelines are not needed at this time.

**Projects in Progress**—Following up on a 1983 Conference recommendation to revise "The A.A. Group," we find that "streamlining" or abridging it may not be helpful after all; we asked the Conference committee to review this further, with particular attention to the text regarding "What's the difference between a 'meeting' and a 'group'?" We appointed a subcommittee to review a possible revision of "A.A. for the Woman" and obtaining additional stories. For the proposed pamphlet "The Twelve Concepts Illustrated," we reviewed an artist's sample drawings and will ask the Conference committee to approve this project for consideration by the 1985 Conference.

Joan Ullom Sheridan, chairperson

**Staff report:** This assignment involves preparation, production, editorial supervision, and distribution of publications and



audiovisual material, always in coordination with other staff members. The staff member on this assignment works closely with the group services coordinator on all service material.

We have nine periodical bulletins, with a combined circulation of 104,914, as follows:

|                                            | Mailing list | Issues per year |
|--------------------------------------------|--------------|-----------------|
| Box 4-5-9 (English)                        | 55,481       | 6               |
| Box 4-5-9 (French)                         | 3,341        | 6               |
| Box 4-5-9 (Spanish)                        | 10,306       | 6               |
| Loners-Internationalists Meeting           | 3,303        | 6               |
| P.I.-C.P.C. Bulletin                       | 3,991        | 3               |
| Correctional Facilities Bulletin           | 6,453        | 3               |
| Quarterly Report <sup>1</sup>              | 4,965        | 3               |
| About A.A.                                 | 13,474       | 3               |
| Treatment Facilities Bulletin <sup>2</sup> | 3,600        | 2               |
|                                            | 104,914      | 38              |

All bulletins, except *L.I.M.*, are translated into French and printed by the French Literature Service in Montreal, Que., in cooperation with G.S.O.

This has been a particularly busy year at the literature desk, with several major projects in various stages of preparation and production. The literature coordinator works with editors on updating and revising all pamphlets and with writers, artists, editors, and printers in preparing new pamphlets, books, displays, leaflets, service materials, films, and filmstrips. She also serves as editor of *Box 4-5-9*.

Correspondence from A.A. groups and individuals requesting specific information about our literature comes to this desk. Letters are sent semiannually to all central offices, intergroups, and literature distribution centers to keep them informed of new developments.

Vinnie McCarthy

<sup>1</sup> The Final Conference Report takes the place of the fourth issue.

<sup>2</sup> Circulation has doubled in 1983. We believe that this increase is due to delegates' obtaining names of institutions that wish to receive this bulletin.

## **Nominating**

### **Election changes are contemplated**

**Trustees' committee:** We reviewed and approved the August letter, procedure, and résumé form for election of candidates for Western Canada and West Central regional trustees.

We reviewed the process used to fill the most recent vacancy for Class A trustee. It was the sense of the meeting that the procedure be recommended for future election of Class A trustees, at the discretion of the existing Nominating Committee.

We reviewed a possible inequity in the schedule of same-year elections for trustees-at-large and the Southeast and East Central regional trustees. The matter was referred to the Conference Committee on Trustees.

We recommended that the Conference Committee on Trustees consider changing the form in which the trustee résumé sheet requests information on the procedure for election, from: (1) two-thirds majority, (2) out of the hat, (3) other; to: (1) Third Legacy procedure, (2) other.

We recommended the nomination of Ralph Rosenberg Jr., to serve as a general service trustee, Class B, on the Grapevine Corporate Board; and of Thomas Jasper Jr., to serve as general service trustee, Class B, on the A.A.W.S. board.

The committee reviewed and recommended the following slate of trustees for election at the annual meeting of the members of the General Service Board in April, following presentation at the 1984 General Service Conference for their disapproval, if any?

#### **Class A**

|                         |                           |
|-------------------------|---------------------------|
| Michael Alexander       | Robert P. Morse           |
| W. J. (Jim) Estelle Jr. | Gordon M. Patrick         |
| William E. Flynn, M.D.  | Kenneth P. Williams, M.D. |
| Joan K. Jackson, Ph.D.  |                           |

#### **Class B**

|                     |                     |
|---------------------|---------------------|
| David H. Aronofsky  | Wayne Parks         |
| O. S. (Buck) Bruner | Mary Phelps         |
| Kenneth Dunphy      | Ralph Rosenberg Jr. |
| Helen Harmon        | Natalie Schwanke    |
| Joe Kraus           | Jacquelyn Solomon   |
| Thomas Jasper Jr.   | Garrett Taylor      |

(To be selected 4/21/84)  
One regional trustee—West Central U.S.  
One regional trustee—Western Canada

The committee recommended the following slate of officers of the General Service Board:

|                               |                         |
|-------------------------------|-------------------------|
| <i>Chairperson</i>            | Gordon M. Patrick       |
| <i>First vice-chairperson</i> | Michael Alexander       |
| <i>Second vice-president</i>  | W. J. (Jim) Estelle Jr. |
| <i>Secretary</i>              | Joe Kraus               |
| <i>Treasurer</i>              | Robert P. Morse         |
| <i>Assistant treasurer</i>    | Dennis Manders          |
| <i>Assistant secretary</i>    | Betty Liddle            |



*Robert P. Morse, our new Class A (nonalcoholic) trustee.*

The committee reviewed and recommended that the following directors of A.A. World Services, Inc., be presented to the 1984 Conference:

|                   |                   |
|-------------------|-------------------|
| William Croke     | Robert Pearson    |
| Harold Greene     | Shepherd Raimi    |
| Thomas Jasper Jr. | Natalie Schwanke  |
| Betty Liddle      | Jacquelyn Solomon |
| Wayne Parks       |                   |

The committee reviewed and recommended the following directors of The A.A. Grapevine, Inc., be presented to the 1984 Conference:

|                        |                     |
|------------------------|---------------------|
| David Aronofsky        | Ralph Rosenberg Jr. |
| Kenneth Dunphy         | James Shannon       |
| William E. Flynn, M.D. | Stanley Silverman   |
| Retha Gresham          | Desmond Towey       |
| Mary Phelps            | Ann Warner          |

The committee recommended that when a regional trustee vacancy occurs on either the A.A.W.S. or Grapevine Board, this committee assume responsibility for nominating a successor, namely, a regional trustee who can serve for two years and who has not previously served on either board. The committee recommended that Wayne Parks replace Joe Kraus on the A.A.W.S. Board, beginning in May 1984.

We favor the election of all Class B trustees for four-year terms regardless of when vacancies occur. The committee recommended that the Conference Committee on Trustees consider a revision of current procedures prepared by this committee.

The committee reviewed and approved as eligible for election all candidates for Western Canada and West Central regional trustees.

We recommended that the General Service Board consider George Dorsey or John Bragg as a replacement for Bob Pearson when he retires.

*John Bragg, chairperson*



## **Public Information**

### **New projects—membership survey and W.S.M.**

**Trustees' committee:** The following projects have been completed:

- The annual anonymity memo to the press was mailed to dailies (circulation over 50,000). Copies were also sent to over 1,100 treatment centers, hospitals, and P.I., C.P.C., and treatment facilities committees for smaller local newspapers.
- Three press feature stories have been completed and sent to local P.I. committees: on the four-millionth copy of the Big Book; on A.A.'s help for the Lone Member; and on A.A.'s primary purpose. All 12 press feature stories and all our TV public service announcements are available in Spanish.
- The returns of the 1983 membership survey have been tabulated, and rough results will be discussed at the Conference. The detailed analysis will be completed by summer 1984.

The following project is in progress:

- The committee discussed new ways to distribute the film "A.A.—An Inside View" and suggested investigating the possibility of making the film available to national TV networks. We recommended that suggestions for wider usage of the film be explored by the Conference committee.

The following are projects for the future:

- A press release announcing the World Service Meeting will be sent October 1 to wire services, major media outlets in the top ten markets, and large-circulation dailies in the Northeast U.S. It will also be sent to all countries participating in the World Service Meeting.
- A press release on the fully analyzed results of the 1983 membership survey will be sent to dailies (circulation over 50,000), as well as P.I., C.P.C., and treatment facilities committees for local newspapers.

*Jacquelyn Solomon, chairperson*

**Staff report:** Three individuals cover public information correspondence at G.S.O.: the staff member and two devoted nonalcoholics. During 1983, we answered more than 9,000 requests for information about A.A. from students, doctors, nurses, family members, clergy, and the public media. We processed approximately 6,000 newspaper and magazine stories about A.A. and wrote letters of gratitude to over 50 publications a month for good articles about our Fellowship. Each month, we followed up on approximately 20 anonymity breaks and sent about 20 letters of thanks for good P.I. committee work done by local A.A.'s.

There are 678 P.I. committees listed at G.S.O., as well as 539 P.I. contacts. Committee members receive the *P.I.-C.P.C. Bulletin* three times a year plus service material. Chairpersons receive the P.I. Workbook (713 were sent this year); additional Workbooks cost \$7. A Literature Display Container designed to be placed in professional offices is now available for \$1.50. This container is filled with 100 copies of "A.A. at a Glance."

In 1983, we distributed 266 radio public service announcements and 252 TV P.S.A.'s through local committees. G.S.O. has placed the P.S.A.'s with major U.S. television networks. The film "Alcoholics Anonymous—An Inside View" has continued to serve as an excellent research vehicle in assisting media people in preparing their background material about A.A. In January, a film entitled, "Alcoholism: Life Under the Influence," was aired on the "Nova" series, using clips from "A.A.—An Inside View." A video cassette was presented to our Archives Department by the show's producer.

We worked with David and Sidney Carroll (Academy Award writers), hired by Garner/Duschow Productions to write the script for a two-hour, NBC prime-time TV movie about Bill W. and the first five years of A.A. (produced jointly with Warner Brothers). The writer and co-producer visited G.S.O. for information and materials. David Carroll shared with us that he has been commissioned to write an article about A.A. for a future issue of *Reader's Digest*.

Serving on the P.I. assignment has been a wonderful experience. The cooperation and respect given to us by the press continue to amaze us. We know that many newcomers have found their way to A.A. as a direct result of the power of attraction in the many messages of recovery carried by the communications media. We shall be ever grateful to all those who have helped to make this possible.

*Lyla Bonney*

## **Staff coordinator**

### **Contact with local A.A. is helpful**

**Staff report:** One of the important responsibilities of the 11 G.S.O. staff members is to answer correspondence. In 1983, more than 20,000 letters were answered. Most staff members have specific assignments, some of which involve the preparation of special service bulletins; and most staff members also correspond with the A.A. groups in a given region of the U.S., Canada, or the rest of the world. The work is divided as follows:

|                                             |                                                                                                                                                                            |
|---------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Conference                                  | Secretary, trustees' Committee on the General Service Conference and Conference Agenda Committee; Early Bird Box 4-5-9; <i>Final Conference Report</i>                     |
| Cooperation with the professional community | Secretary, trustees' and Conference Committees on Cooperation With the Professional Community; <i>About A.A.; P.I.-C.P.C. Bulletin</i>                                     |
| Correctional facilities                     | Secretary, trustees' and Conference Committees on Correctional Facilities; <i>Correctional Facilities Bulletin</i>                                                         |
| Group services coordinator, Regional Forums | Supervision of service materials and Guidelines; A.A. directories; co-secretary, trustees' committee on International Convention/A.A. Regional Forums                      |
| International Convention                    | Co-secretary, trustees' Committee on International Convention/A.A. Regional Forums; coordinator for all activities concerning 50th A.A. Anniversary Convention in Montreal |

#### Literature Coordinator

Secretary, trustees, and Conference Literature Committees; production and distribution of nine G.S.O. bulletins, including Spanish *Box 4-5-9*; coordination of French *Box 4-5-9*; preparation of filmstrips; updating of old pamphlets and books; preparation of new pamphlets and books; film preparation and distribution; editor, *Box 4-5-9*

#### Loners, Internationalists, LIMs

*Loners-Internationalists Meeting*; secretary, trustees' Nominating Committee and Conference Committee on Trustees

#### Overseas, World Service Meeting

Secretary, trustees' International Committee; secretary, World Service Meeting; *World Service Meeting Report*

#### Public information

Secretary, trustees' and Conference Public Information Committees; *P.I.-C.P.C. Bulletin*

#### Staff coordinator

Assistant secretary, General Service Board; secretary, trustees' General Sharing Session; secretary, Committee on Conference Policy/Admission; director, A.A.W.S.

#### Treatment facilities

Secretary, trustees' and Conference Committees on Treatment Facilities; *Treatment Facilities Bulletin*

Staff meetings are held weekly to keep the staff informed and provide a forum for discussion of problems that need some attention from the group conscience. Another aspect of our work is the invitations received from the areas for A.A. get-togethers. On these trips, we are able to learn of local activities, which helps us to be a better service office. Additionally, over the past year, we have greeted about 1,500 visitors from around the world who have toured G.S.O.

The staff coordinator oversees all staff activities, chairs the weekly staff meeting, makes sure mail is answered without interruption during vacations, sickness, or absences, and also serves as the liaison between the staff and other departments.

*Betty Liddle*

### Treatment Facilities

#### Plans for a workbook are under way

**Trustees' report:** The draft of the pamphlet "The A.A. Member and Drug Abuse" was approved and then referred to the trustees' Literature Committee.

As a result of the 1983 Conference action recommending that delegates ask treatment facilities committees to compile a list of treatment centers in their areas for the *Treatment Facilities Bulletin* mailing list, we have received approximately 1,500 new names. We hope that sending our bulletin to the treatment facilities will enhance our relationship with them, serve as a forum for exchange of information, and communicate a better understanding of A.A. Traditions.

In October, the committee considered a suggestion that a treatment facilities workbook be developed, which would include

the "Working With Treatment Centers" section in the C.P.C. Workbook, as well as the general information in the P.I., C.P.C., and proposed Correctional Facilities Workbooks. At that time, the G.S.O. mailing list reflected 248 institutions committees and 69 treatment facilities committees. To get a more accurate picture, a letter was sent to area committee chairpersons, institutions (correctional and treatment) committee chairpersons, and intergroup offices to determine whether institutions committees met as one or as two separate committees. We also asked whether the material received from G.S.O. was adequate; if not, we asked for suggestions for improvement. By the January meeting, nearly one-half of the replies indicated that the institutions committees had separated into correctional and treatment. Most indicated the G.S.O. material was adequate, with several suggestions for improvement.

The committee explored the possibility of combining the material for treatment facilities with the Correctional Facilities Workbook that is now in preparation. We met with the Committee on Correctional Facilities to discuss its ideas. The consensus of both committees was that a separate workbook be prepared for treatment facilities committees; and this recommendation was referred to the Conference Committee on Treatment Facilities.

*Kenneth Williams, M.D., chairperson*

**Staff report:** The correspondence over the past year has reflected continuing changes in the way we are carrying the message to the prospective members in treatment centers. We still receive many listings for groups meeting at these facilities, but more and more of them are self-supporting regular groups open to A.A. members in the community, as well as to patients. In January 1984, 1,052 treatment center groups were listed at G.S.O. for the U.S. and Canada, a decline of about 300 over the past two years. Therefore, more newcomers in treatment facilities are experiencing regular A.A. meetings firsthand, reducing misunderstandings and increasing our ability to bridge the gap between treatment centers and our Fellowship.

Another slow but steady change has been the separation of a great many hospital and institution (H.&I.) committees into treatment facilities committees and correctional facilities committees. Therefore, all G.S.O. services to H.&I. committees will be reviewed by the Conference committee to consider the possibility of separating more of the service material.

The mail on this assignment indicates that there is still some confusion regarding the role of A.A.'s working in the alcoholism field and their relationship to the groups that meet at their facilities. Since a facility hires an individual for his or her professional expertise and A.A. Twelfth Step work is done by A.A.'s on a voluntary basis, it is confusing when an A.A. member working at a treatment facility also "runs" the group.

G.S.O. provides the following services to those in treatment facilities: correspondence with the staff member on this assignment; a correspondence service to put outside A.A.'s in touch with confined members; complimentary literature (for new groups); *Box 4-5-9* (bimonthly), the *Treatment Facilities Bulletin* (twice a year), the *Correctional Facilities Bulletin* (three times a year); films and filmstrips on loan (free); a discount package of A.A. literature (H.&I. committees); and sharing of experiences with local committees and groups.

*Sarah Price*

## At 40 years—a bright outlook

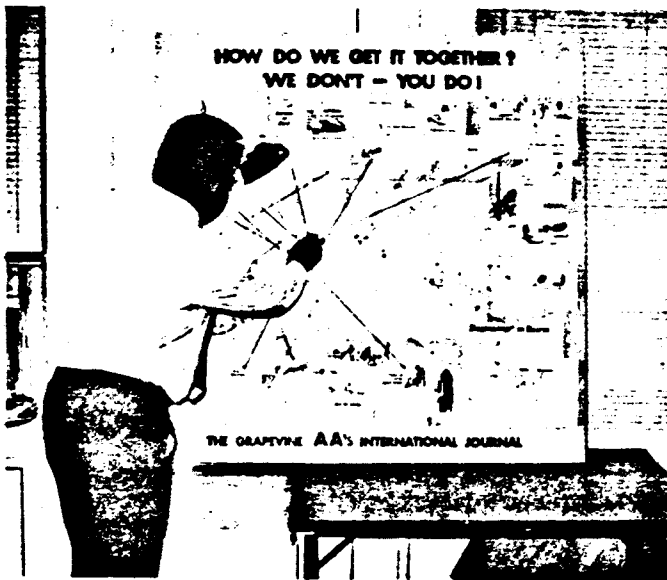
**Directors' report:** In 1983, for the first time in the Grapevine's 40-year history, revenues exceeded \$1,000,000. Of equal importance, the Grapevine had an operating profit of almost \$14,000, a sharp contrast to the deficits of the previous few years. This appropriately modest profit was the result of an increase in subscriptions, proper pricing for the magazine and special items, and a sharp eye on production costs. The year saw the first use of photographs on the cover and, for December, a four-color cover. The editorial staff succeeded again in presenting a broad array of vital issues to the Fellowship.

However, the first quarter of 1984 ended on a note of sadness, with the sudden loss of art editor Tom Neary, who died on March 16. Tom was at work until three days before his death—just as he would have wanted to be. His creativity and love for the Grapevine have added immeasurably to the magazine since he joined the staff in November 1978. We mourn his passing, but, more important, we have been enriched by his life.

The Grapevine made significant progress on its project of switching from outside fulfillment-service contractors to its own in-house computer service for recording subscriptions and delivering the magazine. At the end of 1983, the Grapevine had become more self-supporting in every sense.

The cassette tape of stories produced at the suggestion of the 1983 Conference has been greeted with enthusiasm (over 8,000 have been sold); the staff has suggestions for additional tapes, hoping the 1984 Conference will recommend that more tapes be produced.

The staff and the board of the Grapevine feel certain that your magazine is on the right track. The late 1970's were years



Gene Austin recently joined the Grapevine staff as art editor (Gene is an A.A. member).



Nonalcoholic employees of the Grapevine mailroom (left to right): José Natal, Harold Bennett, and Lamar Edwards.

filled with financial challenges that were solved in the spirit of A.A. cooperation. Never once was there any doubt that we were producing the best possible magazine for the Fellowship. The Fellowship's continuing favorable reception of the magazine, shown by a recent surge in subscriptions, is rewarding. We look forward to the future with confidence and the belief that the next 40 years will be even more rewarding than the first 40.

*Donald F. Daly, chairperson*

**Staff report:** Circulation has been steadily on the rise since March 1983; with the April 1984 issue, it reached 126,000. A survey taken early in 1983, with results reported in the July 1983 issue, asked whether the Grapevine was needed or wanted by the Fellowship, and the answer was unanimously positive. In that same issue, we carried an order form for "Sponsor a Newcomer With a Grapevine Subscription"; more than 1,200 subscriptions resulted.

A brochure developed in 1983 has been effectively carrying the Grapevine message. It consists of a presentation given at the 1981 General Service Conference and is offered free of charge to all A.A. events listed in the Grapevine calendar. Staff members, too, have brought the Grapevine message to 11 areas in the U.S. and Canada through attendance at Forums, conferences, and conventions.

Another special project, the "Best of the Grapevine" (a book laid aside in 1981 when a moratorium was placed on production of additional special items), has been resumed with enthusiasm. Final selection of articles is under way, and we plan to have the book ready for the International Convention in 1985.

The GvR (Grapevine representative) network carries the message at grass-roots level, never faltering in enthusiasm and support for "the best little magazine in the world for alcoholics."

*Retha Gresham, managing editor*

*The group conscience of the Fellowship in the U.S. and Canada was expressed in the following Advisory (to the Board) Actions, which the General Service Board approved in its legally required annual meeting just after the Conference. All 1984*

*Advisory Actions were based upon the reports of the Conference committees, as indicated in the headings. (Members and officers of the 1984 Conference committees are listed on page 56.)*

## Agenda

It was recommended that:

1 At the dinner of the 1985 General Service Conference, there be a light system on the podium and the chairperson of the Conference Agenda Committee be designated chairperson of the A.A. meeting and that his or her duties be limited to introducing the leader and monitoring the time of the meeting.

In addition to the meeting chairperson, the format of the A.A. meeting following the opening dinner at the 1985 Conference remain the same as 1984, consisting of a delegate leader to introduce five speakers—one trustee, two delegates, two staff members (one G.S.O. and one GV).

2 The following suggestions be made for a possible theme for the 1985 Conference with grateful recognition that we will celebrate A.A.'s 50th Anniversary in 1985: (a) "Service—The Golden Key"; (b) "Love and Service"; (c) "Golden Moments of Reflection."

The following presentation/discussion and/or workshop topics be considered for the 1985 Conference: (a) "Will the Hand of A.A. Always Be There?"—(1) "The Middle Years of Sobriety—A Dangerous Time," (2) "Are We Diluting Ourselves?" (3) "Communication Within the Fellowship"; (b) "The Warranties"; (c) "Beyond the Seventh Tradition—Group Responsibility"—(1) "In the Meeting Place," (2) "To the Newcomer"; (d) "Fifty Years of Caring and Sharing"—(1) "In Treatment Centers," (2) "In Correctional Facilities," (3) "With Young People," (4) "In the Group"; (e) "The G.S.R.—The Key Role"—(1) "Obtaining the Most Qualified Member," (2) "The Service Sponsor."

## Cooperation With the Professional Community

It was recommended that:

3 A statement be included in the pamphlet "A.A. as a Resource for the Medical Profession" stating that when physicians recommend A.A. to their patients, the physicians not base their opinion of the effectiveness of A.A. on one or two meetings attended by the patients, but give A.A. a fair trial.

4 Cooperation with the professional community news be regularly included in *Box 4-5-9*, eliminating the *P.I.-C.P.C. Bulletin*.

## Correctional Facilities

It was recommended that:

5 The Correctional Facilities Workbook, which has now been prepared, be approved for production and distribution.

6 The following nine lines from "The A.A. Group" pamphlet be added to page 12 of the "A.A. in Prisons" pamphlet: "In A.A. groups, the people who get the jobs done are called 'officers,' but our Second Tradition reminds us, 'Our leaders are but trusted servants; they do not govern.' Officers are usually chosen by the group for limited terms of service. The jobs they do may have titles. But titles in A.A. do not bring authority or honor; they describe services and responsibilities. They are ways of carrying the message. They are forms of Twelfth Step work A.A. members do, primarily to help themselves recover."

7 That a specific reference to the year 1974 be deleted from page 17 of "A.A. in Prisons" to keep from dating the pamphlet.

8 Correctional facilities news be included in *Box 4-5-9*, eliminating the need for a separate *Correctional Facilities Bulletin*, with concern that costs be held to a reasonable level, and that a larger *Box 4-5-9* be indexed and categorized.

## Finance

It was recommended that:

9 Area contributions toward Conference expenses be increased from \$300 to \$400 effective with the 1985 Conference.

10 Copies of contribution statements sent to the groups be continued to be sent to all delegates on a twice-a-year basis as of June 30 and December 31, with only a list to be sent on the off quarters.

11 A change be made in the pamphlet titled "Supporting the A.A. Support System" as follows. Where it now reads, "Bequests in wills: acceptable only from A.A.'s and only in the year of the A.A.'s death. The limit is \$500." To read, "Bequests in wills: acceptable only from A.A.'s and only on a one-time basis and not in perpetuity. The limit is \$500." This change to be made in the next printing.

12 The past Advisory Action relating to the need for greater participation and increased contributions from groups, to reduce dependence on publishing income, be supplemented with an explanation aimed at the individual A.A. members regarding what happens to their individual contribution, at the group level, and how it helps carry the message worldwide.

## Grapevine

It was recommended that:

13 Because of the positive response to the trial cassette, the Grapevine produce at least one tape a year as a special item.

14 The Grapevine continue to publish the "About Alcoholism" section, along with the disclaimer.

15 The "Portable A.A. Meeting" brochure be included in mailings of G.S.O. bulletins, and that a supply of this brochure be made available to all area Grapevine chairpersons.

16 The Conference reaffirm the 1977 Conference recommendation that "delegates be responsible for establishing area Grapevine committees, using the area and district service structure to achieve the goal of a Grapevine representative in every group." Also that delegates explore the possibility of utilizing alternates throughout the service structure as Grapevine representatives.

### International Convention

It was recommended that:

17 The principal speakers at the major A.A. meetings all be A.A. members, as it has been at our A.A. International Conventions in the past.

18 Due to the 1985 International Convention, state, local, and provincial convention committees be alerted to the possible effect on attendance at local conventions held between May 10 and August 23.

### Literature

It was recommended that:

19 The Bill Wilson biography be approved with the title "Pass It On."

20 "A.A.—The First Fifty Years" not be approved.<sup>1</sup>

21 The word "queers" (p. 140)<sup>2</sup> in "Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions" not be changed to "homosexuals and lesbians," recognizing Fellowship feeling that Bill Wilson's textbook writings be retained as originally published.

22 "The A.A. Member—Medications and Other Drugs" be approved with some revision, to replace "The A.A. Member and Drug Abuse."

23 The General Service Conference not develop a pamphlet for the homosexual alcoholic, as the need is currently addressed in "Do You Think You're Different?"

24 The draft of a pamphlet for the homosexual alcoholic be dropped.

25 "The A.A. Group" pamphlet not be illustrated, as artwork is not necessary.

26 Adding an index to "The A.A. Group" pamphlet is not necessary.

27 "The A.A. Group" pamphlet continue to be distributed with its current content generally intact, as a major revision is not necessary.

28 The trustees' Literature Committee review "The A.A. Group" pamphlet with an eye toward underscoring the importance of an informed group conscience.

29 The text of the pamphlet "The A.A. Group" referring to "What's the difference between a 'meeting' and a 'group'?" (pp. 32-33) be retained, as the text reflects the spirit of local autonomy.

30 A "Twelve Concepts Illustrated" pamphlet suggested by the trustees' Literature Committee be developed for consideration by the 1985 General Service Conference.

31 A pamphlet or manual for A.A. central offices/intergroups not be developed.

32 The updated illustrations for "What Happened to Joe" and "It Happened to Alice" be approved.

33 The updated version of "P.O. Box 459" filmstrip be approved.

1 Following lengthy discussion, it was the sense of the meeting that a souvenir booklet for the 1985 International Convention be prepared under the auspices of the General Service Board. In keeping with the precedent set at past International Conventions, a souvenir booklet does not require Conference approval.

2 Page 144 in printings prior to July 1979.

### Policy/Admissions

It was recommended that:

34 The area treasurer from Central and Southeast Ohio be seated as a Conference member, since neither the delegate nor the alternate delegate from that area was able to attend.

35 After reviewing the 1983 Conference Questionnaire, no change be made on the form at this time.

36 Tapes of Conference presentations not be made available, affirming the 1979 General Service Board recommendation which prohibits making tapes of any Conference session for distribution outside of the A.A. archives, except for the opening dinner and the closing brunch.

37 To encourage Spanish-speaking groups and committees to participate in the general service structure: (a) areas be encouraged to provide room within their structure for Hispanic districts with a bilingual liaison or D.C.M.; (b) assemblies be encour-



aged to provide G.S.R. schools, seminars, or workshops in Spanish; (c) successful experience with area structure participation by Hispanic groups be shared in Spanish *Box 4-5-9*; (d) Spanish-speaking A.A.'s active in service be encouraged to sponsor new members into service; (e) G.S.O. increase its efforts to provide Spanish service literature; (f) the trustees' Committee on International Convention/A.A. Regional Forums consider holding a Forum in Puerto Rico.

**38** The functions of the Conference Committee on Policy/Admissions and Conference Report and Charter Committee should not be combined at this time.

**39** We reaffirm the 1980 Policy/Admissions Committee recommendation which reads: "The Conference reaffirm the importance of the committee system for accomplishing business charged to the Annual Meeting of the General Service Conference, as defined in Chapter VII of our 'A.A. Service Manual.' The importance of clearly stated committee reports and recommendations was also stressed."—With particular emphasis on clarity and background information when writing committee recommendations.

**40** The 1985 Conference be held April 14–20, 1985, and that the Conference Committee on Policy/Admissions routinely review the dates for the succeeding year's Conference.

### Public Information

It was recommended that:

**41** The flyer, one-way display, and poster on "The A.A. Member" be updated to include information from the 1983 membership survey.

**42** The Spanish translations of "Picking Up the Phone" (30 seconds), "Calling A.A." (60 seconds), "First Meeting" (30 seconds), and "B.G.'s Advice" (30 seconds) be made available to the Fellowship.

**43** Public information news be regularly included in *Box 4-5-9*, eliminating the *P.I.-C.P.C. Bulletin*.

**44** All P.I. committees be contacted on the availability of "A.A.—An Inside View" in conjunction with the 50th anniversary P.I. efforts. They, in turn, would contact local independent TV stations. The committee further recommended that there be an article published in *Box 4-5-9* about this P.I. effort.

**45** A 60-second video draft of footage taken from "A.A.—An Inside View," describing what A.A. is and is not and to possibly include the Preamble, be completed for use in conjunction with P.I. efforts for the International Convention, pending approval as a P.I. expenditure by A.A.W.S., Inc.

### **Regional bias?**

A rumor spread through the 1984 Conference that perhaps 90 percent of all the women delegates live in Garrett Taylor's region. When confronted with this "hearsay statistic," Garrett (Northeast regional trustee) looked amused and offered "no comment."

**46** The Spanish version of the 30-second public service announcement "B.G.'s Advice" be prepared with subtitles in Spanish for the hearing-impaired for approval at the 1985 General Service Conference.

**47** A new radio tape about young people in A.A. be prepared for approval at the 1985 Conference.

### Report and Charter

It was recommended that:

**48** The functions of the Conference Policy/Admissions and Report and Charter Committees not be combined at this time.

**49** Examples of personal experiences of G.S.R.'s and D.C.M.'s, including some examples in the area of financial support, be added to "The A.A. Service Manual" at the ends of the appropriate chapters, in an effort to help stimulate involvement for these service positions.

**50** All Conference members collect personal service experiences from some G.S.R.'s and D.C.M.'s in their areas and submit them to the Conference Report and Charter Committee for its consideration in 1985.

**51** The portion of the Third Legacy procedure (pp. 31–32, 50–51, 98)\* of "The A.A. Service Manual" pertaining to the fourth ballot and after be clarified by carrying over a statement from the third ballot which reads, "In case there are ties for second place, the top candidate and tied second-place candidates remain."

This portion of the Third Legacy procedure would be revised to read, "After the fourth ballot, if no candidate has two-thirds of the total vote, the chairperson asks for a motion, second, and majority of hands on conducting a fifth and final ballot. (If the motion is defeated, balloting is over and we go to the 'hat' immediately. In case there are ties for second place, the top candidate and tied second-place candidates remain. If not, the candidate with the smallest total is dropped. If the motion carries, a fifth and final ballot will be conducted.)"

**52** The definition of a quorum at the General Service Conference described in the Conference Charter on page 23\* of "The A.A. Service Manual" is adequately defined and should not be changed.

**53** The following sentence "The past delegates in many regions annually share their experience, strength, and hope at an informal unofficial meeting (described in Chapter VIII) and invite all newly elected delegates and alternates to attend" be included in answer to Question 4, Chapter V, page 56\* of "The A.A. Service Manual."

**54** The following sentence "Some regions have an informal get-together put on by past delegates, and one region's meeting is described in Chapter VIII and has been of value to new delegates in that region" be added to item 4, Chapter V, page 55\* of "The A.A. Service Manual."

**55** The following sentence "This first-year experience can be

shared with their successors at the past delegates' annual get-together in their region" be added to item 14, page 56,\* Chapter V of "The A.A. Service Manual."

**56** The following sentence "Newly elected delegates and alternate delegates are invited to attend" be included at the end of the "Past Delegates Can Be Helpful" section, Chapter VIII, page 87\* of "The A.A. Service Manual."

**57** The recommendation from the General Service Board "That there be a four-year limitation on service of an individual on a trustee committee except for time served as director or trustee" be added to the section on "Trustees' Service Committees," page 103,\* first paragraph, of "The A.A. Service Manual."

**58** Meeting addresses and times not be included in the A.A. directories, since not only would this add greatly to the printing and mailing costs of the directories, but also, some groups do not have addresses, and the directories were not intended to be used as a local meeting list.

**59** Publication of the A.A. directories not be suspended.

**60** The A.A.W.S., Inc., Board of Directors appoint a sub-committee to review the content and format of the directories and report to the Conference Report and Charter Committee its findings and suggestions for their consideration.

\*Page numbers refer to the 1983-84 edition of "The A.A. Service Manual."

## Treatment Facilities

It was recommended that:

**61** We affirm the 1978 Conference action which is as follows: "A.A. members who meet with the administration of a treatment facility concerning the formation of an A.A. group on its premises should explain group autonomy as well as what A.A. can and cannot do (Traditions), and also should have a good understanding of the facility's rules and regulations. After mutual agreements are reached, it is important that this information be shared with the A.A.'s who will be attending the group's meetings. It was suggested that groups meeting in treatment facilities try to abide by the self-support Tradition. If money for rent is not accepted by a facility, groups should contribute in some other way. It was also felt that A.A.'s employed by the facility should not run the groups at the facility."

**62** A draft of a treatment facilities workbook be prepared by the trustees' Committee on Treatment Facilities in time for the 1985 General Service Conference.

**63** The Guidelines on Correctional and Treatment Facilities Committees be separated.

## Trustees

It was recommended that:

**64** The following slate of officers and trustees be elected at the annual meeting of the General Service Board in April 1984 [see page 42; Conference and board approved the slate approved by the trustees' Nominating Committee]; that the following be elected as officers of the General Service Board at its annual meeting [see page 42; slate of officers approved]; that the following be elected as directors of A.A. World Services, Inc. [see page 42; slate of directors approved]; that the following be elected as directors of The A.A. Grapevine, Inc. [see page 42; slate of directors approved].

**65** Information about bilingual ability not be included on the regional trustee résumé forms.

**66** A change be made on the form in which the regional trustee résumé sheet requests information on the procedure for election from (1) two-thirds majority, (2) out of hat, (3) other; to (1) Third Legacy procedure, (2) other.

**67** Because the proposal from the trustees' Nominating Committee which favors the election of all Class B trustees for a four-year term regardless of when vacancies occur represents a substantive change in policy, the trustees' Nominating Committee conduct a survey of delegates and trustees during the coming year and provide the results to next year's Conference committee for final action. When this survey is sent to delegates and trustees, background material on all aspects should be sent, advising the delegates and trustees of the reasoning involved in arriving at the existing procedures for filling trustees vacancies when a death or resignation occurs.

**68** No change in the current schedule or procedure of electing a trustee-at-large be made at the present time.

## New Regional Trustees

On Wednesday afternoon, Conference members voted to recommend the election of the following to the General Service Board: as Western Canada regional trustee, Jack Ford; as West Central U.S. regional trustee, Dan Byrne. The two were elected at the April 21 meeting of the board, after the close of the Conference.



# The General Service Office

## INCOME STATEMENT

YEAR ENDED DECEMBER 31, 1983

|                                                       | 1983             | 1982             |
|-------------------------------------------------------|------------------|------------------|
| <b>INCOME</b>                                         |                  |                  |
| Sales of literature                                   | \$5,278,576      | \$4,682,213      |
| Less: Discount to A.A. groups                         | (229,210)        | (199,918)        |
| <u>Net Sales</u>                                      | 5,049,366        | 4,482,295        |
| Less: Cost of printing                                | (1,757,042)      | (1,666,915)      |
| Royalties                                             | (645,342)        | (561,832)        |
| <u>Gross Profit From Literature</u>                   | 2,646,982        | 2,253,548        |
| Contributions — A.A. groups and members               | 1,928,824        | 1,760,171        |
| Interest income                                       | 18,796           | 9,835            |
| <u>Total Income</u>                                   | 4,594,602        | 4,023,554        |
| <b>EXPENSES</b>                                       |                  |                  |
| Salaries                                              | 1,769,446        | 1,652,512        |
| Pension expense                                       | 224,493          | 198,442          |
| Rent                                                  | 260,486          | 230,393          |
| Box 4-5-9                                             | 94,810           | 93,911           |
| A.A. directories                                      | 72,746           | 64,465           |
| Other Service Office printing                         | 182,712          | 167,131          |
| Shipping and mailing                                  | 572,739          | 545,261          |
| Other office expenses                                 | 344,519          | 309,224          |
| Insurance and payroll taxes                           | 238,208          | 222,227          |
| Professional services                                 | 30,078           | 36,544           |
| Board, committee, and staff meetings                  | 104,619          | 88,487           |
| 1982 World Service Meeting                            | —                | 35,914           |
| Writers' fees                                         | 50,036           | 53,252           |
| P.I.C., C.P.C.C., travel                              | 63,096           | 60,511           |
| General Service Conference                            | 144,970          | 138,868          |
| E.D.P. system development, equipment, and maintenance | 54,035           | 45,567           |
| Regional Forums and other expenses                    | 57,453           | 48,514           |
| Leasehold improvements                                | 36,099           | 226,405          |
| Filmstrip                                             | 5,242            | —                |
| Foreign literature assistance (net)                   | 36,392           | —                |
| <u>Total Expense</u>                                  | 4,342,179        | 4,217,628        |
| <b>NET INCOME (EXPENSE) FOR YEAR (Exhibit C)</b>      | <u>252,423</u>   | <u>(194,074)</u> |
| <b>NET INCOME (EXPENSE) BY FUNCTION</b>               |                  |                  |
| Publishing — A.A. World Services, Inc.                | \$ 776,447       | \$ 561,837       |
| General Fund — General Service Board                  | (524,024)        | (755,911)        |
| <b>CHANGES IN RESERVE FUND</b>                        |                  |                  |
| Balance, January 1                                    | \$2,575,504      | \$2,414,916      |
| Transfers: to General Fund                            | —                | (100,000)        |
| from A.A. World Services, Inc.                        | 220,780          | —                |
| Investment income                                     | 351,647          | 260,588          |
| <u>Balance, December 31</u>                           | <u>3,147,931</u> | <u>2,575,504</u> |
| ( ) denotes red figures                               |                  |                  |

The General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc.—Notes to Financial Statements, December 31, 1983

### Note A — Purposes and Restrictions of Different Funds

The RESERVE FUND was established in 1954 for the purpose of accumulating a prudent operating reserve, which, during 1977, was redefined as one year's combined operating expenses of A.A. World Services, Inc., The A.A. Grapevine, Inc., and the General Fund of the A.A. General Service Board. The 1977 General Service Conference also recommended that all investment activities of the operating entities be consolidated

(continued)

# The Alcoholics Anonymous Grapevine, Inc.

Financial statements

## INCOME STATEMENT

YEAR ENDED DECEMBER 31, 1983

|                                                    | 1983                    | 1982                    |
|----------------------------------------------------|-------------------------|-------------------------|
| <b>INCOME</b> — from subscriptions and other sales | <u>\$1,121,043</u>      | <u>\$ 951,638</u>       |
| <b>EDITORIAL AND PRINTING</b>                      |                         |                         |
| Salaries, including temporary help                 | \$143,695               | \$142,603               |
| Printing                                           | 164,576                 | 168,190                 |
| Mailing — service                                  | 89,904                  | 91,750                  |
| — postage                                          | 103,881                 | 96,860                  |
| Other production costs                             | 23,048                  | 19,798                  |
| Calendar costs                                     | 22,815                  | 21,954                  |
| Occupancy costs                                    | 27,307                  | 24,643                  |
| Telephone                                          | 1,478                   | 1,560                   |
| Office supplies and expenses                       | 3,922                   | 4,450                   |
| Other editorial expenses                           | <u>2,109</u>            | <u>5,141</u>            |
| <b>Total</b>                                       | <b>582,735</b>          | <b>576,949</b>          |
| <b>CIRCULATION AND BUSINESS</b>                    |                         |                         |
| Salaries, including temporary help                 | 202,230                 | 186,165                 |
| Data processing costs                              | 51,113                  | 59,711                  |
| Stationery and supplies                            | 6,295                   | 3,947                   |
| Occupancy costs                                    | 27,307                  | 24,643                  |
| Telephone                                          | 1,501                   | 1,559                   |
| Office expense, including agency fees              | 7,125                   | 10,891                  |
| Selling expense — regular                          | 39,840                  | 22,813                  |
| — GvR program                                      | 8,660                   | 15,427                  |
| Postage                                            | <u>40,784</u>           | <u>40,280</u>           |
| <b>Total</b>                                       | <b>384,855</b>          | <b>365,436</b>          |
| <b>GENERAL AND ADMINISTRATIVE</b>                  |                         |                         |
| Consultant fees                                    | 5,496                   | 5,496                   |
| Insurance                                          | 17,973                  | 17,442                  |
| Professional fees                                  | 11,565                  | 11,565                  |
| Payroll taxes                                      | 25,729                  | 22,381                  |
| Meetings and conferences                           | 7,214                   | 6,624                   |
| E.D.P. equipment, to date                          | 43,419                  | —                       |
| Furniture and equipment                            | 1,249                   | 150                     |
| Contribution to Retirement Plan                    | 26,253                  | 15,156                  |
| Canadian exchange                                  | <u>876</u>              | <u>557</u>              |
| <b>Total</b>                                       | <b>139,774</b>          | <b>79,371</b>           |
| <b>TOTAL COSTS AND EXPENSES</b>                    | <u><b>1,107,364</b></u> | <u><b>1,021,756</b></u> |
| <b>INCOME (LOSS) FROM OPERATIONS</b>               | <b>13,679</b>           | <b>(70,118)</b>         |
| Interest earned                                    | <u>5,360</u>            | <u>42,157</u>           |
| <b>NET INCOME (LOSS) FOR YEAR (Exhibit C)</b>      | <u><b>19,039</b></u>    | <u><b>(27,961)</b></u>  |

( ) denotes red figures

into the Reserve Fund. That Advisory Action was approved by the board of trustees, and since that time, all funds of the operating entities, in excess of those required for working capital, have been transferred to the Reserve Fund. Included in such transfers from The A.A. Grapevine, Inc., were amounts held as a deferred liability to subscribers and, therefore, reflected as a liability of the Reserve Fund.

The GENERAL FUND comprises those assets not included in any of the other funds and may be used for any purposes for which the corporation was formed.

(continued)

# The General Service Office and The A.A. Grapevine, Inc.

## COMBINED BALANCE SHEET

DECEMBER 31, 1983

|                                                    | December 31, 1983 |                  | December 31, 1982 |                  |
|----------------------------------------------------|-------------------|------------------|-------------------|------------------|
|                                                    | Service Office    | A.A. Grapevine   | Service Office    | A.A. Grapevine   |
| <b>OPERATING FUNDS</b>                             |                   |                  |                   |                  |
| <b>ASSETS</b>                                      |                   |                  |                   |                  |
| Cash — checking accounts                           | \$ 179,497        | \$ 69,753        | \$ 190,571        | \$ 73,968        |
| Savings accounts                                   | —                 | 22,513           | —                 | 21,361           |
| Short-term cash investment                         | 416,695           | 102,300          | 330,210           | 43,092           |
| Investment (Note C)                                | —                 | 394,138          | —                 | 380,720          |
| Accounts receivable                                | 73,673            | 2,534            | 65,343            | 10,990           |
| Due from Grapevine                                 | 7,113             | —                | 6,418             | —                |
| Inventories                                        | 971,397           | 69,979           | 991,731           | 83,566           |
| Prepaid expenses                                   | 105,602           | 79,614           | 100,903           | 73,703           |
| <b>Total Assets</b>                                | <b>1,753,977</b>  | <b>740,831</b>   | <b>1,685,176</b>  | <b>687,400</b>   |
| <b>DEDUCT LIABILITIES</b>                          |                   |                  |                   |                  |
| Accounts and accruals payable                      | 375,624           | 57,897           | 338,466           | 98,898           |
| Deferred income                                    | —                 | 786,437          | —                 | 720,544          |
| Due Reserve Fund                                   | —                 | 9,500            | —                 | —                |
| <b>Total Liabilities</b>                           | <b>375,624</b>    | <b>853,834</b>   | <b>338,466</b>    | <b>819,442</b>   |
| <b>NET WORTH</b>                                   |                   |                  |                   |                  |
| Balance, January 1                                 | 1,346,710         | (132,042)        | 1,440,784         | (104,081)        |
| Net income (loss) (Exhibits A and B)               | 252,423           | 19,039           | (194,074)         | (27,961)         |
| Transfer from (to) Reserve Fund                    | (220,780)         | —                | 100,000           | —                |
| <b>Total Net Worth</b>                             | <b>1,378,353</b>  | <b>(113,003)</b> | <b>1,346,710</b>  | <b>(132,042)</b> |
| <b>NET WORTH BY FUNCTION OR FUND</b>               |                   |                  |                   |                  |
| Publishing — A.A. World Services, Inc. (Note A)    | \$1,321,340       |                  | \$1,289,697       |                  |
| General Fund — G.S.B. (Note B)                     | 57,013            |                  | 57,013            |                  |
| <b>Total Operating Funds — as above</b>            | <b>1,378,353</b>  |                  | <b>1,346,710</b>  |                  |
| Reserve Fund                                       | 3,147,931         |                  | 2,575,504         |                  |
| <b>Total Net Worth</b>                             | <b>4,526,284</b>  |                  | <b>3,922,214</b>  |                  |
| <b>RESERVE FUND</b>                                |                   |                  |                   |                  |
| Cash                                               | \$ (297)          |                  | \$ 17,487         |                  |
| Money market and certificates of deposit           | 218,094           |                  | 105               |                  |
| Due from (to) A.A. Grapevine                       | 9,500             |                  | (9,900)           |                  |
| U.S. Treasury obligations                          | 3,199,199         |                  | 2,394,885         |                  |
| Government agency bonds                            | —                 |                  | 470,000           |                  |
| Accrued interest                                   | 115,573           |                  | 83,647            |                  |
| Less: Liability for Grapevine subscribers (Note C) | (394,138)         |                  | (380,720)         |                  |
| <b>Balance, December 31</b>                        | <b>3,147,931</b>  |                  | <b>2,575,504</b>  |                  |

( ) denotes red figures

(continued)

Note B — After transfers of \$524,025 in 1983 and \$655,911 in 1982 from Publishing to General Fund.

Note C — Grapevine investment with Reserve Fund — \$394,138 — represents the deferred subscription income of the Grapevine at December 31, 1979, less \$100,000 withdrawn by the Grapevine during 1981 to restore its then-depleted working capital, of which \$13,418 was reinvested during 1983.

These financial statements and the foregoing notes have been prepared from the reports on the three separate corporations submitted by our independent certified public accountant.

# 1984 G.S.O. Budget

## A.A. WORLD SERVICES, INC. — PUBLISHING

**Income:** Sales income has been budgeted at \$5,565,000. Net sales income is projected to show an increase of 10% over 1983. During 1984, it is anticipated that A.A.W.S., Inc., will distribute 598,000 copies of "Alcoholics Anonymous," 295,000 "Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions"—regular edition, 57,000 "Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions"—pocket edition, 24,000 "A.A. Comes of Age," 65,000 "As Bill Sees It," 27,000 "Dr. Bob and the Good Oldtimers," and more than 7,000,000 booklets, pamphlets, and miscellaneous items. After deducting \$2,754,600—the amount representing the cost of printing and producing items sold and the royalties paid on book sales—the gross profit from sales is estimated to be \$2,810,400. Adding interest earned on daily cash flow, the total income from the publishing activity is expected to be \$2,827,400.

**Expenses:** Expenses charged against the publishing operation are budgeted at \$1,993,200, representing an increase of 6% over 1983. Considered in this increase are higher costs related to increased publishing activity and, to some extent, continuing inflationary pressures. Net publishing income, after operating expenses, is expected to be \$834,200.

## GENERAL FUND — GROUP SERVICES

**Income:** Contributions from groups and A.A. members have been budgeted at \$2,141,000, an increase of 11% over 1983 actual, and interest on cash flow has been budgeted at \$4,000.

**Expenses:** Total expenses, representing the cost of group services that are paid out of contributions, are expected to be \$2,444,500. Included in this portion of the General Service Office budget is the cost of the General Service Conference, totaling \$153,500. The cost of all service expenses is budgeted to be \$299,500 greater than contribution income. This shortfall will be funded from the net income of the publishing operation.

## GENERAL FUND — OTHER EXPENSES

Other expenses of the General Service Board are budgeted at \$318,300. Included in this category of expense are such items as the cost of quarterly trustee meetings, the expenses of the Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community, the cost of Regional Forums, legal and auditing fees, the expense of the archives, the cost of the World Service Meeting, and the costs of filmstrips and displays. These expenses will be offset by net income from the publishing operation.

Net income for the General Service Office has been budgeted at \$216,400.

# 1984 Grapevine Budget

**Total income:** Income from magazine and other sales is budgeted at \$1,185,000. This represents an increase of \$64,000 over 1983, on the basis of higher subscription rates and prices and a projected rise in circulation.

**Total expenses:** Expenses are budgeted at \$1,161,800. A net operating income in the amount of \$23,200 has been budgeted for 1984.

Including \$4,000 in interest earned on cash flow, total net income is budgeted to be \$27,000.

# 1984 G.S.O. Budget

The budget for 1984 operations of G.S.O. activities is as follows:

## BUDGET

## A.A. WORLD SERVICES, INC. — PUBLISHING

### INCOME

|                                      |              |
|--------------------------------------|--------------|
| Net sales                            | \$5,565,000* |
| Less: Cost of products and royalties | 2,754,000    |
| Gross profit from sales              | 2,810,400    |
| Interest income                      | 17,000       |
| Total income                         | 2,827,400    |

### TOTAL EXPENSES

|            |         |
|------------|---------|
| Net income | 834,200 |
|------------|---------|

### \*Based on the sale of:

|               |   |                                               |
|---------------|---|-----------------------------------------------|
| 598,000 books | — | "Alcoholics Anonymous"                        |
| 295,000 books | — | "Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions" (reg.)   |
| 57,000 books  | — | "Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions" (pocket) |
| 24,000 books  | — | "A.A. Comes of Age"                           |
| 65,000 books  | — | "As Bill Sees It"                             |
| 27,000 books  | — | "Dr. Bob and the Good Oldtimers"              |

and

Pamphlets, booklets, and miscellaneous items

## GENERAL FUND — GROUP SERVICES

### INCOME

|                 |             |
|-----------------|-------------|
| Contributions   | \$2,141,000 |
| Interest income | 4,000       |
| Total income    | 2,145,000   |

### TOTAL EXPENSES

|             |           |
|-------------|-----------|
| Net expense | (299,500) |
|-------------|-----------|

\*\*Includes cost of General Service Conference—\$153,500

## GENERAL FUND — OTHER EXPENSES

### TOTAL EXPENSES

\$318,300\*\*\*

\*\*\*Board meetings, P.I.C. expense, C.P.C. expense, legal and auditing fees, Regional Forums, archives, filmstrips, World Service Meeting, etc.

The publishing activity will contribute \$617,800 toward the budgeted deficits, leaving a net G.S.O. income in the amount of \$216,400.

# 1984 Grapevine Budget

|                                                    |             |
|----------------------------------------------------|-------------|
| Estimated income from subscription and other sales | \$1,185,000 |
| Total costs and expenses                           | 1,161,800   |
| Net income from operations                         | 23,200      |
| Interest                                           | 4,000       |
| Total net income                                   | 27,200      |

## 1983 Contributions From Groups—by Delegate Area

(in U.S. dollars)

| General Service<br>Area #    | Conference Area | # Gps.<br>Re-<br>ported | # Gps.<br>Contrib. | %<br>of Gps.<br>Contrib. | Total<br>Group<br>Contrib. | Member-<br>ship | Contrib.<br>per<br>Capita | General Service<br>Area #                                 | Conference Area | # Gps.<br>Re-<br>ported | # Gps.<br>Contrib. | %<br>of Gps.<br>Contrib. | Total<br>Group<br>Contrib.  | Member-<br>ship | Contrib.<br>per<br>Capita |
|------------------------------|-----------------|-------------------------|--------------------|--------------------------|----------------------------|-----------------|---------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|-----------------|-------------------------|--------------------|--------------------------|-----------------------------|-----------------|---------------------------|
| 1. Ala./N.W. Fla.            |                 | 261                     | 155                | 59.3%                    | \$ 11,899.99               | 3,047           | \$3.91                    | 63. S.Dak.                                                |                 | 119                     | 75                 | 63.0%                    | \$ 6,134.19                 | 2,374           | \$2.58                    |
| 2. Alsk.                     |                 | 125                     | 53                 | 42.4                     | 5,797.01                   | 1,406           | 4.12                      | 64. Tenn.                                                 |                 | 279                     | 175                | 62.7                     | 11,869.97                   | 4,098           | 2.90                      |
| 3. Ariz.                     |                 | 452                     | 226                | 50.0                     | 21,118.04                  | 7,448           | 2.84                      | Tex.                                                      |                 |                         |                    |                          |                             |                 |                           |
| 4. Ark.                      |                 | 165                     | 95                 | 57.5                     | 5,608.87                   | 2,376           | 2.36                      | 65. N.E.                                                  |                 | 282                     | 161                | 57.0                     | 17,526.88                   | 7,912           | 2.22                      |
| Calif.                       |                 |                         |                    |                          |                            |                 |                           | 66. N.W.                                                  |                 | 177                     | 87                 | 49.1                     | 7,862.65                    | 3,805           | 2.07                      |
| 5. S.                        |                 | 1,072                   | 484                | 45.1                     | 61,038.45                  | 32,545          | 1.88                      | 67. S.E.                                                  |                 | 318                     | 164                | 51.5                     | 16,427.94                   | 9,505           | 1.73                      |
| 6. N. Coastal                |                 | 1,275                   | 843                | 66.1                     | 96,559.80                  | 30,505          | 3.17                      | 68. S.W.                                                  |                 | 319                     | 166                | 52.0                     | 16,374.67                   | 5,882           | 2.78                      |
| 7. N. Int.                   |                 | 449                     | 228                | 50.7                     | 19,392.36                  | 9,065           | 2.14                      | 69. Utah                                                  |                 | 134                     | 67                 | 50.0                     | 5,566.11                    | 2,127           | 2.62                      |
| 8. San Diego                 |                 | 394                     | 212                | 53.8                     | 18,133.16                  | 10,054          | 1.80                      | 70. Vi.                                                   |                 | 116                     | 58                 | 50.0                     | 5,006.63                    | 1,849           | 2.71                      |
| 9. Mid-S.                    |                 | 981                     | 538                | 54.8                     | 52,473.91                  | 28,446          | 1.84                      | 71. Va.                                                   |                 | 692                     | 443                | 64.                      | 38,710.38                   | 12,878          | 3.01                      |
| 10. Colo.                    |                 | 453                     | 243                | 53.6                     | 23,097.60                  | 8,806           | 2.62                      | 72. Wash.                                                 |                 | 797                     | 450                | 56.4                     | 44,197.97                   | 13,612          | 3.25                      |
| 11. Conn.                    |                 | 753                     | 422                | 56.0                     | 35,753.82                  | 15,572          | 2.30                      | 73. W. Va.                                                |                 | 162                     | 105                | 64.8                     | 5,658.37                    | 1,702           | 3.32                      |
| 12. Del.                     |                 | 95                      | 66                 | 69.4                     | 7,156.65                   | 1,576           | 4.54                      | Wis.                                                      |                 |                         |                    |                          |                             |                 |                           |
| 13. D.C.                     |                 | 283                     | 160                | 56.5                     | 24,055.62                  | 8,835           | 2.72                      | 74. N. Wis./Upper<br>Pen. Mich.                           |                 | 461                     | 243                | 52.7                     | 18,664.26                   | 6,712           | 2.78                      |
| Fla.                         |                 |                         |                    |                          |                            |                 |                           | 75. S.                                                    |                 | 490                     | 253                | 51.6                     | 19,170.61                   | 7,867           | 2.44                      |
| 14. N.                       |                 | 295                     | 185                | 62.7                     | 20,897.87                  | 4,519           | 4.62                      | 76. Wyo.                                                  |                 | 94                      | 55                 | 58.5                     | 2,614.29                    | 1,298           | 2.01                      |
| 15. S.                       |                 | 806                     | 509                | 63.1                     | 60,253.44                  | 12,976          | 4.64                      | 77. P.R.                                                  |                 | 108                     | 68                 | 62.9                     | 3,482.10                    | 1,392           | 2.50                      |
| 16. Ga.                      |                 | 453                     | 305                | 67.3                     | 25,792.30                  | 7,904           | 3.26                      | 78. Alta./N.W.T.                                          |                 | 439                     | 217                | 49.4                     | 21,304.50                   | 5,478           | 3.89                      |
| 17. Haw.                     |                 | 140                     | 105                | 75.0                     | 8,735.44                   | 2,367           | 3.69                      | 79. B.C./Yukon                                            |                 | 507                     | 271                | 53.4                     | 23,542.10                   | 7,153           | 3.29                      |
| 18. Idaho                    |                 | 141                     | 64                 | 45.3                     | 4,738.28                   | 1,604           | 2.95                      | 80. Man.                                                  |                 | 143                     | 66                 | 46.1                     | 6,172.29                    | 3,296           | 1.87                      |
| Ill.                         |                 |                         |                    |                          |                            |                 |                           | 81. N.B./P.E.I.                                           |                 | 201                     | 111                | 55.2                     | 7,820.89                    | 2,872           | 2.72                      |
| 19. Chicago                  |                 | 642                     | 320                | 49.8                     | 39,048.05                  | 13,834          | 2.82                      | 82. N.S./Nfld./Lab.                                       |                 | 219                     | 116                | 52.9                     | 7,613.60                    | 2,551           | 2.98                      |
| 20. N.                       |                 | 665                     | 321                | 48.2                     | 23,877.27                  | 12,448          | 1.92                      | Ont.                                                      |                 |                         |                    |                          |                             |                 |                           |
| 21. S.                       |                 | 271                     | 128                | 47.2                     | 9,266.50                   | 4,254           | 2.18                      | 83. E.                                                    |                 | 448                     | 187                | 41.7                     | 19,402.20                   | 10,120          | 1.92                      |
| Ind.                         |                 |                         |                    |                          |                            |                 |                           | 84. N.E.                                                  |                 | 161                     | 66                 | 40.9                     | 5,112.48                    | 1,893           | 2.70                      |
| 22. N.                       |                 | 373                     | 194                | 52.0                     | 16,776.81                  | 5,449           | 3.08                      | 85. N.W.                                                  |                 | 76                      | 37                 | 48.6                     | 3,507.46                    | 1,210           | 2.90                      |
| 23. S.                       |                 | 228                     | 139                | 60.9                     | 13,013.97                  | 4,181           | 3.11                      | 86. W.                                                    |                 | 408                     | 157                | 38.4                     | 19,904.60                   | 6,230           | 3.19                      |
| 24. Iowa                     |                 | 494                     | 267                | 54.0                     | 17,431.12                  | 9,386           | 1.86                      | Que.                                                      |                 |                         |                    |                          |                             |                 |                           |
| 25. Kans.                    |                 | 283                     | 172                | 60.7                     | 12,068.69                  | 5,784           | 2.09                      | 87. S.W.                                                  |                 | 499                     | 336                | 67.3                     | 11,306.05                   | 13,318          | .85                       |
| 26. Ky.                      |                 | 332                     | 170                | 51.2                     | 22,450.65                  | 5,016           | 4.48                      | 88. S.E.                                                  |                 | 228                     | 204                | 89.4                     | 8,976.03                    | 3,089           | 2.91                      |
| 27. La.                      |                 | 346                     | 205                | 59.2                     | 16,257.26                  | 5,518           | 2.95                      | 89. N.E.                                                  |                 | 298                     | 298                | 100.0                    | 3,515.02                    | 5,468           | .64                       |
| 28. Me.                      |                 | 242                     | 122                | 50.4                     | 8,406.05                   | 3,564           | 2.36                      | 90. N.W.                                                  |                 | 277                     | 277                | 100.0                    | 16,709.99                   | 4,817           | 3.47                      |
| 29. Md.                      |                 | 505                     | 279                | 55.2                     | 25,238.54                  | 6,585           | 3.83                      | 91. Sask.                                                 |                 | 310                     | 177                | 57.0                     | 12,254.36                   | 3,661           | 3.35                      |
| Mass.                        |                 |                         |                    |                          |                            |                 |                           | Total U.S./<br>Canada                                     |                 | 34,010                  | 18,673             | 54.9%                    | \$1,683,983.24              | 655,480         | \$2.57                    |
| 30. E.                       |                 | 766                     | 381                | 49.7                     | 43,371.65                  | 21,440          | 2.02                      | Bahamas                                                   |                 | 7                       | 1                  | 14.3                     | 50.00                       | 124             | .40                       |
| 31. W.                       |                 | 133                     | 79                 | 59.3                     | 6,342.50                   | 2,681           | 2.37                      | V.I. of U.S.                                              |                 | 7                       | 2                  | 28.5                     | 1,600.00                    | 150             | 10.67                     |
| Mich.                        |                 |                         |                    |                          |                            |                 |                           | (U.S. dollars)                                            |                 | 34,024                  | 18,676             | 54.9% <sup>①</sup>       | \$1,685,633.24 <sup>②</sup> | 655,754         | \$2.57 <sup>②</sup>       |
| 32. Cent.                    |                 | 310                     | 168                | 54.1                     | 21,686.52                  | 6,035           | 3.59                      | Individual, in-memoriam, & special meetings               |                 |                         |                    |                          | 87,397.65                   |                 |                           |
| 33. S.E.                     |                 | 335                     | 175                | 52.2                     | 18,402.70                  | 7,993           | 2.30                      | Specials                                                  |                 |                         |                    |                          | 134,735.77                  |                 |                           |
| 34. W.                       |                 | 254                     | 142                | 55.9                     | 13,482.48                  | 5,133           | 2.63                      | Total for U.S. & Canada (U.S. dollars)                    |                 |                         |                    |                          | \$1,907,766.66              |                 |                           |
| Minn.                        |                 |                         |                    |                          |                            |                 |                           | FOREIGN AND OTHER                                         |                 |                         |                    |                          |                             |                 |                           |
| 35. N.                       |                 | 446                     | 210                | 47.0                     | 13,473.38                  | 7,091           | 1.90                      | Birds of a Feather                                        |                 |                         |                    |                          | 220.00                      |                 |                           |
| 36. S.                       |                 | 754                     | 365                | 48.4                     | 31,150.27                  | 22,959          | 1.36                      | Correctional facility groups                              |                 |                         |                    |                          | 165.00                      |                 |                           |
| 37. Miss.                    |                 | 177                     | 90                 | 50.8                     | 5,271.91                   | 2,070           | 2.55                      | Foreign                                                   |                 |                         |                    |                          | 13,100.70                   |                 |                           |
| Mo.                          |                 |                         |                    |                          |                            |                 |                           | International Advisory Council of Young<br>People in A.A. |                 |                         |                    |                          | 1,076.00                    |                 |                           |
| 38. E.                       |                 | 350                     | 220                | 62.8                     | 20,633.50                  | 4,588           | 4.50                      | International Doctors in A.A.                             |                 |                         |                    |                          | 959.25                      |                 |                           |
| 39. W.                       |                 | 159                     | 97                 | 61.0                     | 8,418.06                   | 2,862           | 2.94                      | International Lawyers in A.A.                             |                 |                         |                    |                          | 523.03                      |                 |                           |
| 40. Mont.                    |                 | 231                     | 102                | 44.1                     | 7,716.20                   | 2,806           | 2.75                      | Internationalists                                         |                 |                         |                    |                          | 224.00                      |                 |                           |
| 41. Nebr.                    |                 | 508                     | 293                | 57.6                     | 30,169.15                  | 9,083           | 3.32                      | Loners                                                    |                 |                         |                    |                          | 878.98                      |                 |                           |
| 42. Nev.                     |                 | 155                     | 64                 | 41.2                     | 4,148.06                   | 1,861           | 2.23                      | Treatment facility groups                                 |                 |                         |                    |                          | 4,732.13                    |                 |                           |
| 43. N.H.                     |                 | 220                     | 117                | 53.1                     | 9,758.94                   | 2,987           | 3.27                      | World Hello                                               |                 |                         |                    |                          | 27.12                       |                 |                           |
| N.J.                         |                 |                         |                    |                          |                            |                 |                           | Grand Total                                               |                 |                         |                    |                          | \$1,929,673.45              |                 |                           |
| 44. N.                       |                 | 774                     | 391                | 50.5                     | 38,374.69                  | 16,726          | 2.29                      |                                                           |                 |                         |                    |                          |                             |                 |                           |
| 45. S.                       |                 | 210                     | 113                | 53.8                     | 13,148.17                  | 3,160           | 4.16                      |                                                           |                 |                         |                    |                          |                             |                 |                           |
| 46. N.M.                     |                 | 169                     | 95                 | 56.2                     | 7,886.35                   | 2,617           | 3.01                      |                                                           |                 |                         |                    |                          |                             |                 |                           |
| N.Y.                         |                 |                         |                    |                          |                            |                 |                           |                                                           |                 |                         |                    |                          |                             |                 |                           |
| 47. Cent.                    |                 | 398                     | 207                | 52.0                     | 19,353.91                  | 5,357           | 3.61                      |                                                           |                 |                         |                    |                          |                             |                 |                           |
| 48. H.M./B.                  |                 | 342                     | 172                | 50.2                     | 11,167.39                  | 4,240           | 2.63                      |                                                           |                 |                         |                    |                          |                             |                 |                           |
| 49. S.E.                     |                 | 1,089                   | 595                | 54.6                     | 74,222.25                  | 27,796          | 2.67                      |                                                           |                 |                         |                    |                          |                             |                 |                           |
| 50. W.                       |                 | 177                     | 90                 | 50.8                     | 7,687.10                   | 2,348           | 3.27                      |                                                           |                 |                         |                    |                          |                             |                 |                           |
| 51. N.C./Ber.                |                 | 498                     | 314                | 63.0                     | 22,291.12                  | 7,521           | 2.96                      |                                                           |                 |                         |                    |                          |                             |                 |                           |
| 52. N.Dak.                   |                 | 136                     | 87                 | 63.9                     | 6,502.80                   | 2,136           | 3.04                      |                                                           |                 |                         |                    |                          |                             |                 |                           |
| Ohio                         |                 |                         |                    |                          |                            |                 |                           |                                                           |                 |                         |                    |                          |                             |                 |                           |
| 53. Cent. & S.E.             |                 | 331                     | 134                | 40.4                     | 9,768.34                   | 4,759           | 2.05                      |                                                           |                 |                         |                    |                          |                             |                 |                           |
| 54. N.E.                     |                 | 753                     | 176                | 23.3                     | 12,781.53                  | 18,609          | .69                       |                                                           |                 |                         |                    |                          |                             |                 |                           |
| 55. N.W. Ohio/<br>S.E. Mich. |                 | 185                     | 70                 | 37.8                     | 6,226.40                   | 2,479           | 2.51                      |                                                           |                 |                         |                    |                          |                             |                 |                           |
| 56. S.W. Ohio/<br>N. Ky.     |                 | 254                     | 143                | 56.2                     | 9,307.32                   | 4,150           | 2.24                      |                                                           |                 |                         |                    |                          |                             |                 |                           |
| 57. Okla.                    |                 | 299                     | 226                | 75.5                     | 19,961.10                  | 3,725           | 5.36                      |                                                           |                 |                         |                    |                          |                             |                 |                           |
| 58. Oreg.                    |                 | 435                     | 223                | 51.2                     | 18,614.78                  | 5,694           | 3.27                      |                                                           |                 |                         |                    |                          |                             |                 |                           |
| Pa.                          |                 |                         |                    |                          |                            |                 |                           |                                                           |                 |                         |                    |                          |                             |                 |                           |
| 59. E.                       |                 | 648                     | 386                | 59.5                     | 40,049.06                  | 13,919          | 2.88                      |                                                           |                 |                         |                    |                          |                             |                 |                           |
| 60. W.                       |                 | 432                     | 230                | 53.2                     | 18,657.59                  | 6,060           | 3.08                      |                                                           |                 |                         |                    |                          |                             |                 |                           |
| 61. R.I.                     |                 | 159                     | 91                 | 57.2                     | 8,946.10                   | 2,675           | 3.34                      |                                                           |                 |                         |                    |                          |                             |                 |                           |
| 62. S.C.                     |                 | 187                     | 127                | 67.9                     | 12,265.81                  | 2,681           | 4.58                      |                                                           |                 |                         |                    |                          |                             |                 |                           |

CONTRIBUTION COMPARISON — 1983-1982  
(in U.S. dollars)

|                        | # Gps.<br>Re-<br>ported | # Gps.<br>Contrib.  | %<br>of Gps.<br>Contrib. | Amount of<br>Contrib.       | Member-<br>ship | Contrib.<br>per<br>Capita |
|------------------------|-------------------------|---------------------|--------------------------|-----------------------------|-----------------|---------------------------|
| U.S. & Canada<br>1983  | 34,024                  | 18,676 <sup>①</sup> | 54.9% <sup>①</sup>       | \$1,685,633.24 <sup>②</sup> | 655,754         | \$2.57 <sup>②</sup>       |
| U.S. & Canada<br>1982  | 30,556                  | 17,633 <sup>①</sup> | 57.7 <sup>①</sup>        | \$1,521,542.30 <sup>②</sup> | 585,134         | 2.60 <sup>②</sup>         |
| Increase<br>(Decrease) | 3,468                   | 1,043               | (2.8%)*                  | \$ 164,090.94               | 70,620          | (\$ .03)                  |

① Reflects not only those groups that contributed directly to G.S.O., but also those groups that contributed to G.S.O. through their Conference areas (per lists submitted by areas).

② Group contributions reported on this schedule do not include contributions received as specials, individual, in-memoriam, and special meetings.

# 1983 Total Contributions—by State/Province

| U.S.                   | #Gps. Reported | % of Gps. Contrib. | Amount of Contrib. | Member-ship | Contrib. per Capita |
|------------------------|----------------|--------------------|--------------------|-------------|---------------------|
| Alabama                | 204            | 58.8%              | \$ 8,766.12        | 2,841       | \$3.09              |
| Alaska                 | 125            | 53                 | 6,863.21           | 1,406       | 4.88                |
| Arizona                | 444            | 42.4               | 31,401.32          | 7,432       | 4.23                |
| Arkansas               | 165            | 58.1               | 5,996.74           | 2,374       | 2.53                |
| California             | 4,182          | 2,307              | 284,632.44         | 111,492     | 2.55                |
| Colorado               | 452            | 243                | 35,403.98          | 8,800       | 4.02                |
| Connecticut            | 766            | 427                | 41,761.20          | 15,844      | 2.64                |
| Delaware               | 94             | 65                 | 8,052.65           | 1,571       | 5.13                |
| District of Columbia   | 127            | 59                 | 4,212              | 4,212       | 2.50                |
| Florida                | 1,156          | 729                | 115,053.67         | 18,056      | 6.37                |
| Georgia                | 453            | 305                | 26,365.30          | 7,904       | 3.34                |
| Hawaii                 | 140            | 105                | 10,353.84          | 2,367       | 4.37                |
| Idaho                  | 179            | 85                 | 6,013.39           | 2,022       | 2.97                |
| Illinois               | 1,574          | 769                | 75,353.82          | 30,677      | 2.46                |
| Indiana                | 628            | 348                | 32,616.30          | 10,016      | 3.26                |
| Iowa                   | 494            | 267                | 19,605.04          | 9,386       | 2.09                |
| Kansas                 | 283            | 172                | 18,673.36          | 5,784       | 3.23                |
| Kentucky               | 312            | 158                | 23,501.23          | 4,782       | 4.91                |
| Louisiana              | 346            | 205                | 18,005.71          | 5,518       | 3.26                |
| Maine                  | 235            | 118                | 8,995.05           | 3,470       | 2.59                |
| Maryland               | 655            | 378                | 46,253.35          | 11,004      | 4.20                |
| Massachusetts          | 913            | 465                | 53,113.74          | 24,349      | 2.18                |
| Michigan               | 1,053          | 553                | 62,504.53          | 21,133      | 2.96                |
| Minnesota              | 1,198          | 575                | 51,501.20          | 29,973      | 1.72                |
| Mississippi            | 177            | 90                 | 5,427.66           | 2,070       | 2.62                |
| Missouri               | 510            | 317                | 30,661.85          | 7,451       | 4.12                |
| Montana                | 231            | 102                | 9,206.08           | 2,806       | 3.28                |
| Nebraska               | 509            | 293                | 37,832.15          | 9,090       | 4.16                |
| Nevada                 | 145            | 59                 | 4,927.56           | 1,754       | 2.81                |
| New Hampshire          | 224            | 122                | 10,865.44          | 3,055       | 3.56                |
| New Jersey             | 986            | 504                | 60,360.86          | 19,946      | 3.03                |
| New Mexico             | 168            | 94                 | 8,291.15           | 2,501       | 3.32                |
| New York               | 2,007          | 1,063              | 118,961.74         | 39,618      | 3.00                |
| North Carolina         | 481            | 314                | 22,718.12          | 7,359       | 3.09                |
| North Dakota           | 137            | 87                 | 6,502.80           | 2,141       | 3.04                |
| Ohio                   | 1,495          | 516                | 40,053.02          | 29,257      | 1.37                |
| Oklahoma               | 302            | 228                | 21,771.60          | 3,762       | 5.79                |
| Oregon                 | 435            | 224                | 20,621.45          | 5,698       | 3.62                |
| Pennsylvania           | 1,099          | 624                | 64,588.88          | 20,276      | 3.19                |
| Rhode Island           | 153            | 88                 | 8,425.70           | 2,518       | 3.35                |
| South Carolina         | 187            | 127                | 13,472.81          | 2,681       | 5.03                |
| South Dakota           | 119            | 75                 | 7,506.69           | 2,374       | 3.16                |
| Tennessee              | 278            | 175                | 14,174.78          | 4,092       | 3.46                |
| Texas                  | 1,097          | 579                | 68,256.42          | 26,755      | 2.55                |
| Utah                   | 135            | 67                 | 5,666.11           | 2,135       | 2.65                |
| Vermont                | 114            | 54                 | 4,640.93           | 1,809       | 2.57                |
| Virginia               | 701            | 446                | 40,650.95          | 13,108      | 3.10                |
| Washington             | 738            | 417                | 45,255.79          | 12,937      | 3.50                |
| West Virginia          | 159            | 106                | 6,873.94           | 1,680       | 4.09                |
| Wisconsin              | 827            | 431                | 36,121.75          | 13,397      | 2.70                |
| Wyoming                | 96             | 56                 | 2,709.29           | 1,312       | 2.07                |
| Commonwealth of P.R.   | 108            | 68                 | 3,558.80           | 1,392       | 2.56                |
| Bahama Islands         | 7              | 1                  | 50.00              | 124         | .40                 |
| Virgin Islands of U.S. | 7              | 2                  | 1,600.00           | 150         | 10.67               |
| Bermuda                | 17             | 0                  | 0.00               | 162         | 0.00                |
| TOTAL for U.S.         | 29,827         | 16,155             | \$1,723,066.61     | 585,823     | \$2.94              |

| U.S.                   | #Gps. Reported | % of Gps. Contrib. | Amount of Contrib. | Member-ship | Contrib. per Capita |
|------------------------|----------------|--------------------|--------------------|-------------|---------------------|
| Alabama                | 204            | 58.8%              | \$ 8,766.12        | 2,841       | \$3.09              |
| Alaska                 | 125            | 53                 | 6,863.21           | 1,406       | 4.88                |
| Arizona                | 444            | 42.4               | 31,401.32          | 7,432       | 4.23                |
| Arkansas               | 165            | 58.1               | 5,996.74           | 2,374       | 2.53                |
| California             | 4,182          | 2,307              | 284,632.44         | 111,492     | 2.55                |
| Colorado               | 452            | 243                | 35,403.98          | 8,800       | 4.02                |
| Connecticut            | 766            | 427                | 41,761.20          | 15,844      | 2.64                |
| Delaware               | 94             | 65                 | 8,052.65           | 1,571       | 5.13                |
| District of Columbia   | 127            | 59                 | 4,212              | 4,212       | 2.50                |
| Florida                | 1,156          | 729                | 115,053.67         | 18,056      | 6.37                |
| Georgia                | 453            | 305                | 26,365.30          | 7,904       | 3.34                |
| Hawaii                 | 140            | 105                | 10,353.84          | 2,367       | 4.37                |
| Idaho                  | 179            | 85                 | 6,013.39           | 2,022       | 2.97                |
| Illinois               | 1,574          | 769                | 75,353.82          | 30,677      | 2.46                |
| Indiana                | 628            | 348                | 32,616.30          | 10,016      | 3.26                |
| Iowa                   | 494            | 267                | 19,605.04          | 9,386       | 2.09                |
| Kansas                 | 283            | 172                | 18,673.36          | 5,784       | 3.23                |
| Kentucky               | 312            | 158                | 23,501.23          | 4,782       | 4.91                |
| Louisiana              | 346            | 205                | 18,005.71          | 5,518       | 3.26                |
| Maine                  | 235            | 118                | 8,995.05           | 3,470       | 2.59                |
| Maryland               | 655            | 378                | 46,253.35          | 11,004      | 4.20                |
| Massachusetts          | 913            | 465                | 53,113.74          | 24,349      | 2.18                |
| Michigan               | 1,053          | 553                | 62,504.53          | 21,133      | 2.96                |
| Minnesota              | 1,198          | 575                | 51,501.20          | 29,973      | 1.72                |
| Mississippi            | 177            | 90                 | 5,427.66           | 2,070       | 2.62                |
| Missouri               | 510            | 317                | 30,661.85          | 7,451       | 4.12                |
| Montana                | 231            | 102                | 9,206.08           | 2,806       | 3.28                |
| Nebraska               | 509            | 293                | 37,832.15          | 9,090       | 4.16                |
| Nevada                 | 145            | 59                 | 4,927.56           | 1,754       | 2.81                |
| New Hampshire          | 224            | 122                | 10,865.44          | 3,055       | 3.56                |
| New Jersey             | 986            | 504                | 60,360.86          | 19,946      | 3.03                |
| New Mexico             | 168            | 94                 | 8,291.15           | 2,501       | 3.32                |
| New York               | 2,007          | 1,063              | 118,961.74         | 39,618      | 3.00                |
| North Carolina         | 481            | 314                | 22,718.12          | 7,359       | 3.09                |
| North Dakota           | 137            | 87                 | 6,502.80           | 2,141       | 3.04                |
| Ohio                   | 1,495          | 516                | 40,053.02          | 29,257      | 1.37                |
| Oklahoma               | 302            | 228                | 21,771.60          | 3,762       | 5.79                |
| Oregon                 | 435            | 224                | 20,621.45          | 5,698       | 3.62                |
| Pennsylvania           | 1,099          | 624                | 64,588.88          | 20,276      | 3.19                |
| Rhode Island           | 153            | 88                 | 8,425.70           | 2,518       | 3.35                |
| South Carolina         | 187            | 127                | 13,472.81          | 2,681       | 5.03                |
| South Dakota           | 119            | 75                 | 7,506.69           | 2,374       | 3.16                |
| Tennessee              | 278            | 175                | 14,174.78          | 4,092       | 3.46                |
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| TOTAL for U.S.         | 29,827         | 16,155             | \$1,723,066.61     | 585,823     | \$2.94              |

① Reflects not only those groups that contributed directly to G.S.O., but also those groups that contributed to G.S.O. through their Conference areas (per lists submitted by areas).

## Conference Agenda

Mel Ditty, W. Mo.  
<sup>2</sup>Ralph Goers, S. Calif.  
<sup>1</sup>Tommy Hills, E. Ont.  
 Lloyd Hosner, Cent. Mich.

Ken Beckerich, Ore.  
 Georges Filion, S. Que.  
 Tillie McNulty, N.H.  
 Drexel Williams, Ky.

*Secretary:* Lois Fisher

## Cooperation With the Professional Community

<sup>1</sup>Manny Banks, Nev.  
<sup>2</sup>Brian Camp, N.E. Tex.  
 Myron Gowans, Va.  
 Gabriel LaPointe, N.E. Que.

Chuck Asher, S. Ind.  
 Paul Black, N.W. Ohio/S.E. Mich.  
 Richard Roughton, R.I.  
 Max Wilson, Neb.

*Secretary:* Curtis Monahan

## Correctional Facilities

<sup>1</sup>Dorothy Garvin, E. Pa.  
 Jack McKenna, Iowa  
<sup>4</sup>George Mudrich, Cent. & S.E. Ohio  
<sup>2</sup>Ralph Van Keuren, Cent. N.Y.

Jean-Marie Alain, N.W. Que.  
 M. Lee Forsythe, N.B./P.E.I.  
 Bobby Melton, Tenn.  
 Jack Ostrem, N. Ill.

*Secretary:* Eileen Gatz

## Finance

<sup>1</sup>Jack Hoffman, Haw.  
 Cathie Jeltsch, S.E. N.Y.  
<sup>2</sup>Kim Patrick, B.C./Yukon  
 Rosaire Vanesse, S.E. Que.

Ruth Nichol, S. N.J.  
 Jim McKnight, Sask.  
 Bob O'Rourke, Kans.  
 James Sarvak, Vermont

*Secretary:* Dennis Manders

## Grapevine

Robie Chipman, N.S./Nfld./Lab.  
 Ted Hayes, N.E. Ohio  
<sup>1</sup>Bill Moore, N. Coastal Calif.  
 Elsie Murphy, Ark.  
<sup>2</sup>Jan Polek, Wash.

Jeff Hampton, Idaho  
 James Parker, Miss.  
 Frank Rice, Ga.  
 John F. Schutt Jr., W. Mass.

*Secretary:* Ann Warner

## Literature

Jack Byars, N.C.  
<sup>1</sup>Conrad Cooley, N.E. Ont.  
 Frank Gay, E. Mass.  
<sup>2</sup>Bryce Peacock, Utah

Mary Ann Bagi, N.M.  
 Elke Forbes, Del.  
 Tom McKay, San Diego  
 Bob Picard, N. Minn.  
 Kathleen Tartre, Alta.

*Secretary:* Vinnie McCarthy

## Conference Policy/Admissions

Carol King, W. Pa.  
<sup>2</sup>Joe Rhoads, Conn.  
 Sally Roy, Ala./N.W. Fla.  
<sup>1</sup>Michael Shelly, Chicago

Kathleen Carr, Alsk.  
 Mel Hanna, W. Ont.  
 Jaime Rocafort, P.R.  
 Dave Hill, Ariz.

*Secretary:* Betty Liddle

## Public Information

Herb Brautzsch, N. Ind.  
 Phil Dennis, E. Mo.  
<sup>1</sup>Chad Leyshon, D.C.  
<sup>2</sup>Robert Schneck, N. Fla.

Chris Heindel, N. Wis./Upper Pen. Mich.  
 Jim Rogers, S.W. Tex.  
 Frank Sauer, Mid-S. Calif.  
 Murray White, Man.

*Secretary:* Lyla Bonney

## Conference Report and Charter

Mike Cushman, S. Fla./Bahamas  
<sup>2</sup>Bill Factor, Colo.  
 John Paul Jones, S. Ill.  
<sup>1</sup>John Sharkey, N. N.J.

Lawrence Shuler, S.C.  
 Dale Skelton, S.W. Ohio/N. Ky.  
 Leslie Watson, N. Int. Calif.  
 Faye Woodall, Mont.

*Secretary:* Helen Turnquest

## Treatment Facilities

<sup>1</sup>Robert Baetz, S. Wis.  
<sup>2</sup>Donald Bruner, S. Minn.  
 Ben Headrick, La.  
 Peggy Smith, S.E. Mich.

Tom Eser, Md.  
 Elizabeth Garnett, W. N.Y.  
 John Landon, S. Dak.  
 Willard Machen, N.W. Tex.

*Secretary:* Sarah Price

## Committee on Trustees

<sup>2</sup>Pete Ellis, W. Va.  
<sup>1</sup>C. B. Key, Okla.  
 Ray Lavergne, N.W. Ont.  
 Bud Smith, S.E. Tex.

Agnes Krueger, N. Dak.  
 Don Weaver, W. Mich.  
 Sue Wieland, Hudson/Mohawk/Berkshire  
 Homer Wilkinson, Me.  
 Bob Woods, Wy.

*Secretary:* Phyllis Masback

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## 1985 International Convention Committee

Georges Filion, S.W. Que.  
 Agnes Krueger, N. Dak.  
 John F. Schutt Jr., W. Mass.

Dale Skelton, S.W. Ohio/N. Ky.  
 Murray White, Man.

*Secretary:* Sarah Price

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## New chairpersons and alternate chairpersons

### Committee

Conference Agenda  
 Cooperation With the Professional Community  
 Correctional Facilities  
 Finance  
 Grapevine  
 Literature  
 Conference Policy/Admissions  
 Public Information  
 Conference Report and Charter  
 Treatment Facilities  
 Committee on Trustees

### Chairperson

Tillie McNulty, N.H.  
 Richard Roughton, R.I.  
 Jack L. Ostrem, N. Ill.  
 Jim McKnight, Sask.  
 Jeff Hampton, Idaho  
 Bob Picard, N. Minn.  
 David Hill, Ariz.  
 Jim Rogers, S.W. Tex.  
 Leslie Watson, N. Int. Calif.  
 Willard Machen, N.W. Tex.  
 Donald Weaver, Mich.

### Alternate

Ken Beckerich, Ore.  
 Charles Asher, S. Ind.  
 M. Lee Forsythe, N.B./P.E.I.  
 James Sarvak, Vt.  
 Frank Rice, Ga.  
 Tom McKay, San Diego  
 Kathleen Carr, Alsk.  
 Christina Heindel, N. Wis./Upper Pen. Mich.  
 Lawrence Shuler, S.C.  
 John Landon, S. Dak.  
 Agnes Krueger, N. Dak.

- 1 Chairperson
- 2 Alternate chairperson
- 3 Served at the Conference in place of Julius Wilson (see footnote, p. 61).



## Archives

Albert Hergott, *chairperson*  
Joe Kraus  
Milton Maxwell  
Shepherd Raimi  
James Shannon  
Joan Ullom Sheridan  
George Gordon, Ph.D., *consultant*  
Nell Wing, *consultant*  
Frank Mauser, *secretary*

## Conference

Natalie Schwanke, *chairperson*  
David Aronofsky  
Bill Croke  
Wayne Parks  
Ralph Rosenberg Jr.  
Jim Shannon  
Jacquelyn Solomon  
Garrett Taylor  
Lois Fisher, *secretary*

## Cooperation With the Professional Community

William Flynn, M.D., *chairperson*  
O. S. Bruner  
Jack Hennessy  
Joan Jackson, Ph.D.  
Herbert McBride  
Corrine Pettey  
Shepherd Raimi  
James Shannon  
Curtis Monahan, *secretary*

## Correctional Facilities

W. J. Estelle Jr., *chairperson*  
Jack Anderson  
Daniel Fitzgibbon  
Robert Gregush  
Helen Harmon  
Albert Hergott  
Sonny Johnson  
Stanley Silverman  
Eileen Gatz, *secretary*

## Employee Retirement

John Bragg  
Donald Daly  
Thomas Jasper  
Joe Kraus  
Robert Morse  
Michael Alexander, *consultant*  
George Dorsey, *consultant*  
Owen Flanagan, C.P.A., *consultant*  
Robert Pearson, *secretary*  
Dennis Manders, *assistant secretary*

## Finance

Robert Morse, *chairperson*  
Michael Alexander  
John Bragg  
O. S. Bruner  
W. J. Estelle Jr.  
Wayne Parks  
Mary Phelps  
Owen Flanagan, C.P.A., *consultant*  
Dennis Manders, *secretary*

## International

Kenneth Dunphy, *chairperson*  
William Flynn, M.D.  
Helen Harmon  
John Norris, M.D.  
Mary Phelps  
Shepherd Raimi  
Stanley Silverman  
Isa Stanfiel, *consultant*  
Susan Daly, *secretary*

## International Convention/ A.A. Regional Forums

Kenneth Dunphy, *chairperson*  
Helen Harmon  
Thomas Jasper  
Wayne Parks  
Natalie Schwanke  
Joan Ullom Sheridan  
Garrett Taylor  
Kenneth Williams, M.D.  
Sarah Price, *co-secretary*  
Helen Turnquest, *co-secretary*

## Literature

Joan Ullom Sheridan, *chairperson*  
Michael Alexander  
Joan Jackson, Ph.D.  
Stanley Silverman  
Garrett Taylor  
Kenneth Williams, M.D.  
Janet Graves, *consultant*  
Eleanor Widdoes, *consultant*  
Vinnie McCarthy, *secretary*

## Nominating

John Bragg, *chairperson*  
O. S. Bruner  
Donald Daly  
W. J. Estelle Jr.  
Albert Hergott  
Joe Kraus  
Jacquelyn Solomon  
Phyllis Masback, *secretary*

## Public Information

Jacquelyn Solomon, *chairperson*  
William Croke  
William Dowling  
Robert Durling  
Sam Elfert  
Phil Parker  
Eduardo Ramos  
Ralph Rosenberg Jr.  
Desmond Towey  
John Bragg, *consultant*  
Sean Callery, *consultant*  
Lyla Bonney, *secretary*

## Treatment Facilities

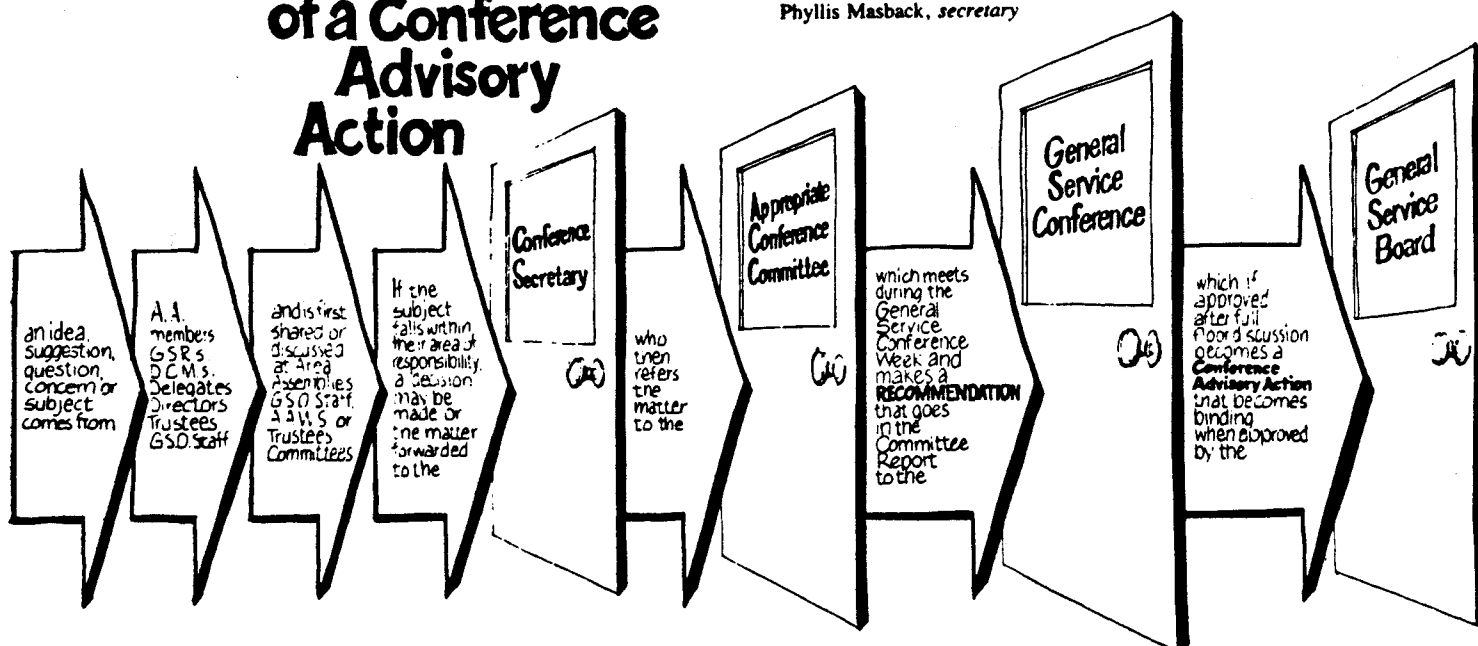
Kenneth Williams, M.D.,  
*chairperson*  
James Barry  
O. S. Bruner  
Kenneth Dunphy  
William Flynn, M.D.  
Bill Jason  
Thomas Jasper  
Earl Mullen

## General Sharing Session

Joan Ullom Sheridan, *chairperson*  
Betty Liddle, *secretary*  
All members of the General Service Board, A.A.W.S., and GV Boards, G.S.O. and GV staffs, and trustees' committees participate in this "town meeting."

Gordon Patrick and Robert Pearson are ex officio members of all committees. Committee secretaries and consultants do not vote.

## Flow Chart of a Conference Advisory Action



"Were it not for Committees, it is doubtful that any Conference could get over a fraction of the ground it now covers. As the Conference has grown in size and influence the Committees' importance has grown even more."

# 1984 Conference Members

## Nonalcoholic (Class A) trustees

**Gordon M. Patrick** (Box 100, Lyndhurst, Ont. K0E 1N0, Canada), elected to the board in 1975, became its chairperson in 1982. Recently retired, he was a management consultant specializing in helping organizations develop programs for employees disabled by alcoholism. Formerly associated with the Addiction Research Foundation of Ontario and the Donwood Institute, he has a continuing interest in employee assistance programs and professional education. A longtime friend of A.A., he considers it "the most useful resource for recovery from alcoholism."

**Michael Alexander** (150 E. 69th St., New York, NY 10021) was elected a trustee in 1976 after 20 years as legal advisor to the board. A partner in the law firm of Smith, Steibel, Alexander, and Saskor, P.C., he was an associate of the late Bernard Smith—so significant in A.A. history. Mike is a director and past president of the British American Chamber of Commerce, a trustee and past president of the Consular Law Society, and a director and secretary of the Ireland-U.S. Council for Commerce and Industry. He serves on the Literature and Finance Committees and is a nonvoting consultant on the Employee Retirement Committee.

**W. J. Estelle Jr.** (114 Sunset Lake Dr., Huntsville, TX 77340), former director, Texas Department of Corrections, was named a trustee in April 1977. Born in Indiana, he was educated in California, where he began his career in corrections in 1952. He then spent two years as warden of Montana State Prison. Jim has taught courses in corrections in two California colleges and is a member of seven professional societies concerned with criminal justice, corrections, and services to children and youth. He is chairperson of the Committee on Correctional Facilities and also serves on the Finance and Nominating Committees.

**William E. Flynn, M.D.** (1164 Old Gate Ct., McLean, VA 22101), joined the board in April 1980. A graduate of the Georgetown University School of Medicine, he was certified in psychiatry by the American Board of Psychiatry and Neurology. Currently assistant professor of psychiatry at Georgetown and director of studies in alcohol and drug abuse, he also serves as a consultant to the National Center for Alcohol Education and to the alcohol treatment unit at Arlington Hospital in Virginia. Bill is chairperson of the Cooperation With the Professional Community Committee and also serves on the International and Treatment Facilities Committees.

**Joan K. Jackson, Ph.D.** (72 Downs Rd., Bethany, CT 06525), was elected to the board in April 1983. A graduate of McGill University, Montreal, and the University of Washington, Seattle, Joan taught sociology at both universities for many years. She has served as consultant and editorial adviser for many local and national boards and committees on alcoholism and on health and human behavior. At the University of Washington Medical School in Seattle, Joan was involved in research and teaching about alcoholism, A.A., and Al-Anon. She is a member of the Archives, Literature, and Cooperation With the Professional Community Committees.

**Robert P. Morse** (19 East 88th St., New York, NY 10128) was elected to the board in April 1984. A graduate of the University of Pennsylvania, he has over 15 years experience in the investment business, with an in-depth background in the

fixed-income sector and management of equity portfolios. Robert now has his own investment firm.

**Kenneth H. Williams, M.D.** (Northwestern Institute, 450 Bethlehem Pike, Ft. Washington, PA 19034), joined our board in 1979. He has been on the faculties of the Yale and University of Pittsburgh Schools of Medicine and a medical consultant to the Governor's Council on Drug and Alcohol Abuse (Pennsylvania) and to a residential detoxification program for alcoholics in Pittsburgh. Ken is chairperson of the Treatment Facilities Committee and a member of the International Convention/A.A. Regional Forums and Literature Committees.

## Alcoholic (Class B) trustees

**David H. Aronofsky** (2503 W. Jefferson, Dallas, TX 75211) was elected trustee-at-large/U.S. in May 1981. Dave was chairperson of Dallas Metroplex Intergroup and of the Conference Finance Committee (as a Panel 27 delegate). He has remained active in area service. A doctor of dental surgery, Dave belongs to five professional organizations. He is chairperson of the International Committee, serves on the Conference and Finance Committees, and is a member of the Grapevine Corporate Board.

**John K. Bragg** (2295 Pinehaven Dr., Schenectady, NY 12309), elected general service trustee in May 1981, is chairperson of the Nominating Committee, a member of the Finance and Employee Retirement Committees, and a consultant on the Public Information Committee. John has his own management consultant firm in the technology and research fields.

**O. S. (Buck) Bruner** (5161 Windridge Dr., Indianapolis, IN 46226) joined the board as East Central U.S. regional trustee in May 1981. With a background of intergroup, area, and state service, Buck was a Panel 28 Conference delegate. He was a World War II bomber pilot, has a law degree, and is currently head of his own insurance agency. Buck serves on the Finance, Treatment Facilities, Nominating, and Cooperation With the Professional Community Committees.

**Dan M. Byrne** (2900 19th Avenue, Marion, Iowa 52302), elected West Central regional trustee in April 1984, has a background of group and area service and served as a Panel 29 delegate. Dan is part owner of a 200-acre farm and has been manager-operator of a large farm operation for 18 years. He is now employed by the Quaker Oats Cereal Co., Cedar Rapids.

**Donald F. Daly** (c/o Brundage Story & Rose, 1 Broadway, New York, NY 10004) was elected general service trustee in April 1980, to join the board in August. Don has served groups in Northport (Long Island), N.Y., and in Manhattan in most capacities. On the Grapevine Corporate Board since 1976, he is now its chairperson. Don is an investment counselor and former secretary of the Investment Counsel Association of America. He is a member of the Finance, Employee Retirement, and Nominating Committees.

**Kenneth L. Dunphy** (115 Humphrey St., Moncton, N.B. E1C 6P2, Canada), elected Eastern Canada regional trustee in 1982, has been active in district and area service and was a Conference delegate in 1976-77. Ken's background is in the

electromechanical field. He was a draftsman in the mining industry, and now works for the Canadian Federal Government as a drafting supervisor, where he is an A.A. contact for the employee assistance program. Ken serves on the International and Treatment Facilities Committees and chairs the International Convention/A.A. Regional Forums Committee.

**John R. (Jack) Ford** (3092 West King Edward, Vancouver, B.C., Canada V6L 1V5) was elected Western Canada regional trustee in April 1984. Jack has been active in group, intergroup, and area service; as a Panel 29 Conference delegate, he chaired the Finance Committee. Jack owns an auto dealership and service station and is director of a coal firm.

**Helen A. Harmon** (Box 391, Melita, Man., Canada R0M 1L0) was elected trustee-at-large/Canada in April 1983. Helen served her area as G.S.R. and D.C.M. and was a Panel 28 Conference delegate. She is owner and operator of a franchise for income tax preparation and a salesperson for mutual funds and investments. Helen served on the board of directors of the Alcoholism Foundation of Manitoba. She is a member of the Correctional Facilities, International, and International Convention/A.A. Regional Forums Committees.

**Albert J. Hergott** (Box 220, St. Louis, Sask. S0J 2C0, Canada) became Western Canada regional trustee in May 1981, to serve three years (filling out the term of his late predecessor, elected in 1980). As a Panel 28 delegate, he chaired the Conference Literature Committee. Al is consultant to an investment company and chief executive officer of a correctional institution. He is chairperson of the Archives Committee and serves on the Literature and Correctional Facilities Committees.

**Thomas K. Jasper Jr.** (133 South Oxford St., Brooklyn, NY 11217), elected general service trustee in April 1984, has been active in group and area service and has served on the Treatment Facilities Committee. A practicing attorney, Tom has acted as general counsel to many nonprofit organizations.

**Joe F. Kraus** (P.O. Drawer G, Lawrenceburg, TN 38464) joined the board as Southeast U.S. regional trustee in May 1981. After a term as a delegate (Panel 26), Joe returned to area activities. He has been in insurance, real estate, and finance, has his own company specializing in the last two fields, and has also taken part in many aspects of community service. Joe is a member of the Archives, Employee Retirement, and Nominating Committees and is chairperson of the A.A.W.S. Board.

**Wayne Parks** (1120 West Cypress, Rogers, AR 72756) was elected Southwest U.S. regional trustee in April 1983. Wayne has a background in area service, and after a term as Conference delegate (Panel 29), he returned to other area activities. He has worked in the oil sales, freight, and furniture fields. Wayne serves on his state's Alcohol and Drug Abuse Authority and on its Alcohol and Drug Abuse Advisory Council. He is a member of the Conference, Finance, and International Convention/Regional Forums Committees.

**Mary Phelps** (177 Waverly Pl., 5R, New York, NY 10014) became a general service trustee in April 1983. A member of the Grapevine Corporate Board and Editorial Board. Mary has also been active in group and area service. She has worked as an editor in the general publishing, economics research, and

weekly magazine fields. Mary currently serves on the Finance, International, and Public Information Committees.

**Ralph Rosenberg Jr.** (410 West 24th St., New York, N.Y. 10011), elected general service trustee in April 1984, has been active in group and intergroup service. Ralph has been a radio and TV writer and has a background in advertising. He has served on the Grapevine Editorial Board, and is now a Grapevine director and a member of the Conference and Public Information Committees.

**Natalie Schwanke** (14601 N.E. 35th, Bellevue, WA 98007) was elected Pacific U.S. regional trustee in 1982. She has served both the Seattle Intergroup and her area, which sent her to the Conference as delegate in 1975-76. Natalie has been active in community affairs and is a manufacturers' representative in women's clothing and accessories. She is chairperson of the Conference Committee and a member of the International Convention/A.A. Regional Forums and Literature Committees.

**Joan Ullom Sheridan** (Box 42, Rte. 1, Aurora SD 57002) was elected West Central regional trustee in 1982 (to fill the vacancy left by the late Bud Grondahl). A delegate in 1976-77, Joan has been active in area service. In 1971 she started a county center for alcohol and drug information and referral. Joan chairs the Literature Committee and is a member of the Archives and International Convention/Regional Forums Committees.

**Jacquelyn (Jackie) Solomon** (303 E. 37th St., New York NY 10016) became a general service trustee in May 1981. Jackie has been involved in group, intergroup, and area service and served as A.A.W.S. director. Her background is in the fashion sales field, but she is now a distributor/supervisor in the field of nutrition. Jackie is chairperson of the Public Information Committee and a member of the Conference and Nominating Committees.

**Garrett Taylor** (50 55th St. S.E., Washington, DC 20019) was elected Northeast U.S. regional trustee in April 1983. He was chairperson of Washington Intergroup and of the area committee. After serving as a Panel 27 delegate, Garrett returned to area activities. A retired postal manager, Garrett continues to be active in civic affairs. He is a member of the Conference, International Convention/Regional Forums, and Literature Committees.

### Officers of the General Service Board

|                         |                           |
|-------------------------|---------------------------|
| Chairperson             | Gordon Patrick            |
| First vice-chairperson  | Michael Alexander         |
| Second vice-chairperson | W. J. (Jim) Estelle Jr.   |
| Secretary               | Joe Kraus                 |
| Treasurer               | Robert Morse <sup>3</sup> |
| Assistant treasurer     | Dennis Manders            |
| Assistant secretary     | Betty Liddle              |

The new slate of officers (post-Conference) is given on page 42.

- 1 New trustee, becoming a Conference member immediately after election by the General Service Board, April 21, 1984
- 2 Retiring at the close of the 1984 Conference meeting
- 3 New officer, elected April 21, 1984

## A.A. World Services directors

Joe Kraus, *chairperson*  
John Bragg  
William Croke  
Thomas Jasper  
Betty Liddle

Robert Pearson  
Shepherd Raimi  
Natalie Schwanke  
Jacquelyn Solomon

## A.A. Grapevine directors

Donald Daly, *chairperson, president*  
David Aronofsky  
Kenneth Dunphy  
William Flynn, M.D.  
Retha Gresham, *secretary, vice-president*

Mary Phelps, *treasurer*  
Ralph Rosenberg Jr.  
Jim Shannon  
Stanley Silverman

## General Service Office staff

Robert Pearson, *general manager*  
Lyla Bonney  
Cheryl Ann Burke  
Susan Daly  
Lois Fisher  
Eileen Gatz  
Betty Liddle

Phyllis Masback  
Vincina McCarthy  
Curtis Monahan  
Sarah Price  
Helen Turnquest  
Frank Mauser, *archivist*  
Vicente Mejia, *Spanish services*

## Grapevine staff

Retha Gresham, *managing editor*

Ann Warner, *editor*

## Others Assisting at the Conference (*nonvoting*)

### G.S.O./Grapevine Personnel

Gene Austin, *art editor, Grapevine*  
Ed Brady, *Steno/Clerical Department*  
Lynda Ernst, *Steno/Clerical Department*  
Owen J. Flanagan, *independent C.P.A.*  
Elizabeth Garcia, *supervisor, Steno/Clerical Department*  
Edward Gordon, *assistant controller/manager, supporting departments*  
Evelyn Gould, *Steno/Clerical Department*  
Dorothy Graham, *editor, Conference Report*  
Janet Graves, *production, Early Bird Box 4-5-9*  
Carrie Himmel, *Steno/Clerical Department*  
Margie Janicek, *Steno/Clerical Department*  
John Kirwin Jr., *supervisor, Accounting Department*  
Ceile Lerner, *Steno/Clerical Department*  
Dennis Manders, *controller/business administrator*  
Dorothy McGinity, *Conference Manual coordinator*  
Don Meurer, *Grapevine controller*  
Tony Osnato, *office manager*  
Virginia Poole, *Steno/Clerical Department*  
Paula Sasson, *Steno/Clerical Department*  
Frank Segui, *Steno/Clerical Department*  
Joan Smith, *Steno/Clerical Department*  
Naomi Strassberg, *Grapevine executive secretary*  
Cynthia White, *Steno/Clerical Department*  
Madeline Whitlock, *secretary, A.A. World Services*  
Eleanor Widdoes, *assistant to the office manager*  
Adeline Wilmot, *assistant to the Conference coordinator*

### Trustees emeriti

Milton L. Maxwell, Ph.D.  
John L. Norris, M.D.

All nontrustee, nondirector members of the trustees' committees are encouraged to attend and participate at the joint meetings. They are also encouraged to attend, as observers, the Monday sessions of the Conference and one presentation session related to the committee on which they serve.

## Area delegates

What do panel numbers mean? Delegates to each Conference are made up of two "panels." One is even-numbered and includes those elected to start serving in an even year. The other is odd-numbered and includes those elected to start serving in an odd year. This 34th Conference includes Panel 33 (delegates now serving for their second year) and Panel 34 (new delegates).

| State                | Area no. | Panel |                                                                                      |
|----------------------|----------|-------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Alabama/N.W. Florida | 1        | 33    | Sally F. Roy, 2340 Lakeside Dr., Birmingham, AL 35244                                |
| Alaska               | 2        | 34    | Kathleen J. Carr, P.O. Box 87-1666, Wasilla, AK 99687                                |
| Arizona              | 3        | 34    | David H. Hill, 373 N. Wilmot #814, Tucson, AZ 85711                                  |
| Arkansas             | 4        | 33    | Elsie Murphy, 3302 Ridge Rd., N. Little Rock, AR 72116                               |
| California           | 5        | 33    | Southern—Ralph W. Goers, 972 Calle Brusca, Thousand Oaks, CA 91360                   |
|                      | 6        | 33    | Northern Coastal—Wallace B. (Bill) Moore, P.O. Box 4305, Vallejo, CA 94590           |
|                      | 7        | 34    | Northern Interior—Leslie S. Watson, 204 Touchstone Pl., West Sacramento, CA 95691    |
|                      | 8        | 34    | San Diego—Tom McKay, 309 S. Nevada, Oceanside, CA 92054                              |
|                      | 9        | 34    | Mid-Southern—Frank Sauer, 1356 Summerland, San Pedro, CA 90732                       |
| Colorado             | 10       | 33    | William (Bill) Factor, 7317 Colonial Dr., Fountain, CO 80817                         |
| Connecticut          | 11       | 33    | Joseph E. Rhoads, 569 Carriage Dr., Orange, CT 06477                                 |
| Delaware             | 12       | 34    | Elke B. Forbes, 1314 Quincy Dr., Wilmington, DE 19803                                |
| District of Columbia | 13       | 33    | Chad Leyshon, 10414 Huntley Ave., Silver Spring, MD 20902                            |
| Florida              | 14       | 33    | Northern—Robert J. Schneck, P.O. Box 1269, 1282 The Grove Rd., Orange Park, FL 32073 |
|                      | 15       | 33    | Southern/Bahamas—Michael D. Cushman, 1002 Paseo Morella, West Palm Beach, FL 33405   |
| Georgia              | 16       | 34    | Frank Rice, 660 Highway 314, Fayetteville, GA 30214                                  |
| Hawaii               | 17       | 33    | Jack Hoffman, 1015 Aolua Pl. #439, Kailua, HI 96734                                  |

| State         | Area no. | Panel |                                                                       |
|---------------|----------|-------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Idaho         | 18       | 34    | Jeff Hampton, 228 Dubois, Twin Falls, ID 83301                        |
| Illinois      | 19       | 33    | Chicago—Michael Shelly, 502 Ridge Rd., Wilmette, IL 60091             |
|               | 20       | 34    | Northern—Jack L. Ostrem, 913 Grand Blvd., Joliet, IL 60436            |
|               | 21       | 33    | Southern—John Paul Jones, 344 W. Imboden Dr., Decatur, IL 62521       |
| Indiana       | 22       | 33    | Northern—Herbert Brautzsch, P.O. Box 10566, Fort Wayne, IN 46853      |
|               | 23       | 34    | Southern—Charles Asher, 414 S. Garvin, Evansville, IN 47713           |
| Iowa          | 24       | 33    | John P. (Jack) McKenna, 102 California St., Waterloo, IA 50703        |
| Kansas        | 25       | 34    | Robert O'Rourke, 112 East Third, Smith Center, KS 66967               |
| Kentucky      | 26       | 34    | Drexel Williams, 206 Princess Dr., Ashland, KY 41101                  |
| Louisiana     | 27       | 33    | Ben G. Headrick, 307 Dalzell St., Shreveport, LA 71104                |
| Maine         | 28       | 34    | Homer R. Wilkinson, P.O. Box 146, Otter Creek, ME 04665               |
| Maryland      | 29       | 34    | Thomas Eser, 1014 Emmerick Dr., Joppatowne, MD 21085                  |
| Massachusetts | 30       | 33    | Eastern—Francis J. (Frank) Gay, 279 Chandler St., Tewksbury, MA 01876 |
|               | 31       | 34    | Western—John F. Schutt Jr., 66 Mill St., Springfield, MA 01108        |
|               | 32       | 33    | Central—Lloyd Hosner, 5152 Morrish Rd. #13, Swartz Creek, MI 48473    |
| Michigan      | 33       | 33    | Southeastern—Peggy Smith, P.O. Box 36786, Grosse Pointe, MI 48236     |
|               | 34       | 34    | Western—Donald Weaver, 5096 Savannah, Kalamazoo, MI 49001             |
|               | 35       | 34    | Northern—Bob Picard, 3801 East Third St., Superior, WI 54880          |
| Minnesota     | 36       | 33    | Southern—Donald J. Bruner, 6420 Bluff Dr., Bloomington, MN 55438      |
|               | 37       | 34    | James R. Parker, R.R. 4, Box 437-B, Batesville, MS 38606              |

| State         | Area no. | Panel |                                                                                        |
|---------------|----------|-------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Missouri      | 38       | 33    | Eastern—Phil Dennis, Knox City, MO 63446                                               |
|               | 39       | 33    | Western—Mel Ditty, 1612 Orleans Cir., N. Kansas City, MO 64116                         |
| Montana       | 40       | 34    | Faye Woodall, 397 Bonner Rd. (P.O. Box 5925), Helena, MT 59601                         |
| Nebraska      | 41       | 34    | Max Wilson, 3026 S. 32nd St., Omaha, NE 68105                                          |
| Nevada        | 42       | 33    | M. Manning (Manny) Banks, 2800 Eastern Ave. #1003, Las Vegas, NV 89109                 |
| New Hampshire | 43       | 34    | Tillie McNulty, 338 Laydon St., Manchester, NH 03103                                   |
| New Jersey    | 44       | 33    | Northern—John Sharkey, 9 Valley Way, W. Orange, NJ 07052                               |
|               | 45       | 34    | Southern—Ruth Nichol, 70 N. Girard St., Woodbury, NJ 08096                             |
| New Mexico    | 46       | 34    | Mary Ann Bagi, 1309 Guaymus, N.E., Albuquerque, NM 87110                               |
| New York      | 47       | 33    | Central—Ralph H. Van Keuren, 3 Perkins Ave., Binghamton, NY 13901                      |
|               | 48       | 34    | Hudson/Mohawk/Berkshire—Suzanne (Sue) Wieland, 56 Red Fox Dr., Albany, NY 12205        |
|               | 49       | 33    | Southeastern—Cathie Jeltsch, 73 Grove St., Glenwood Landing, NY 11547                  |
|               | 50       | 34    | Western—Elizabeth Garnett, 320 Perry St. #3C, Buffalo, NY 14204                        |
|               | 51       | 33    | Jack E. Byars, 5304 Wayne Rd., Greensboro, NC 27407                                    |
|               | 52       | 34    | Agnes L. Krueger, Rt. #2, Pick City, Hazen, ND 58545                                   |
| Ohio          | 53       | 33    | *Central & Southeastern—Julius E. Wilson Jr., 256 South Chase Ave., Columbus, OH 43204 |
|               | 54       | 33    | Northeastern—Ted Hayes, 15607 Harvard Ave., Cleveland, OH 44128                        |
|               | 55       | 34    | N.W. Ohio/S.E. Mich—Paul Black, P.O. Box 1354, Toledo, OH 43603                        |

\*Unable to attend the Conference; the area treasurer, George Mudrich, was seated. Following the Conference, Julius Wilson resigned. Alternate delegate, Walter Hill (636 Uhler Rd., Marion, OH 43302) is now serving as delegate for Area 53.

| State          | Area no. | Panel |                                                                                                  |
|----------------|----------|-------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|                | 56       | 34    | S. W. Ohio/N. Ky—Dale Skelton, P.O. Box 1943, Cincinnati, OH 45201                               |
| Oklahoma       | 57       | 33    | C. B. Key, 4241 East 25th Pl., Tulsa, OK 74114                                                   |
| Oregon         | 58       | 34    | Kenneth E. Beckerich, 20150 S. Leland Rd., Oregon City, OR 97045                                 |
| Pennsylvania   | 59       | 33    | Eastern—Dorothy Garvin, 5030 Parrish St., Philadelphia, PA 19139                                 |
|                | 60       | 33    | Western—Carol King, 7 Ferncliff Beach, Erie, PA 16505                                            |
| Rhode Island   | 61       | 34    | Richard A. Roughton, 20 Phillips St., Providence, RI 02906                                       |
| South Carolina | 62       | 34    | Lawrence Shuler, Route 5, Box 160, Chester, SC 29706                                             |
| South Dakota   | 63       | 34    | John M. Landon, 200 E. Short St., Box 386, Beresford, SD 57004                                   |
| Tennessee      | 64       | 34    | Bobby Melton, 1615 Eagle Dr., Hixson, TN 37343                                                   |
| Texas          | 65       | 33    | Northeastern—Brian L. Camp, 1329 W. Redbud Dr., Hurst, TX 76053                                  |
|                | 66       | 34    | Northwestern—Willard Machen, 1931 S. Harrison, Amarillo, TX 79109                                |
|                | 67       | 33    | Southeastern—Bud Smith, 3219 Missouri, Baytown, TX 77520                                         |
|                | 68       | 34    | Southwestern—Jim Rogers, 2001 North 25th St., Harlingen, TX 78550                                |
| Utah           | 69       | 33    | Bryce W. Peacock, P.O. Box 1372, Salt Lake City, UT 84110                                        |
| Vermont        | 70       | 34    | James J. Sarvak, 290 Hinesburg Rd., S. Burlington, VT 05401                                      |
| Virginia       | 71       | 33    | Myron Gowans, Route 2, Box 171A, Heathsville, VA 22473                                           |
| Washington     | 72       | 33    | Jan Polek, 2301 East 61st Ave., Spokane, WA 99203                                                |
| West Virginia  | 73       | 33    | Harold (Pete) Ellis, 121 River Dr., Logan, WV 25601                                              |
| Wisconsin      | 74       | 34    | N. Wisconsin/Upper Peninsula Michigan—Christina J. Heindel, 225 Brothers St., Kaukauna, WI 54130 |
|                | 75       | 33    | Southern—Robert Baetz, 8205 48th Ave., Kenosha, WI 53142                                         |

| State                                 | Area no. | Panel |                                                                                       |
|---------------------------------------|----------|-------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Wyoming                               | 76       | 34    | Robert (Bob) F. Woods, P.O. Box 164, Sheridan, WY 82801                               |
| Puerto Rico                           | 77       | 34    | Jaime L. Rocafort, #1691 Juan Kepler St., Tupilan Dev., Cupey, Rio Piedras, PR 00926  |
| <b>Canada</b>                         |          |       |                                                                                       |
| <b>Province</b>                       |          |       |                                                                                       |
| Alberta/<br>Northwest Territories     | 78       | 34    | Kathleen Tartre, 9835 113 St., #1506, Edmonton, Alta. T5K 1N4                         |
| British Columbia/Yukon                | 79       | 33    | Susanna Kim Patrick, c/o Sunshine Cabs, 260 Riverside Dr., N. Vancouver, B.C. V7H 2M2 |
| Manitoba                              | 80       | 34    | Murray White, 131 Barron Dr., Winnipeg, Man. R3K 0G3                                  |
| New Brunswick/Prince<br>Edward Island | 81       | 34    | M. Lee Forsythe, 4 Messer Dr., Sherwood, P.E.I. C1A 7S7                               |
| Nova Scotia/<br>Newfoundland/Labrador | 82       | 33    | Robie W. Chipman, Bridgewater R.R. 5, Lunenburg Co., N.S. B4V 2W4                     |
| Ontario                               | 83       | 33    | Eastern—Thomas G. (Tommy) Hills, 48 McGregor Rd., Scarborough, Ont. M1P 1C8           |
|                                       | 84       | 33    | Northeastern—Conrad E. Cooley, 34 Farley Ave., North Bay, Ont. P1A 2S5                |
|                                       | 85       | 33    | Northwestern—Ray Lavergne, 400 Rabbit Lake Rd., Kenora, Ont. P9N 3W8                  |
|                                       | 86       | 34    | Western—Mel Hanna, Box 651, Owen Sound, Ont. N4K 5R4                                  |
| Quebec                                | 87       | 34    | Southwestern—Georges Filion, 114 Gernie Ave., Verdun, Que. H4G 2Z9                    |
|                                       | 88       | 33    | Southeastern—Rosaire Vanasse, 585 Fortin, Sherbrooke, Que. J1E 2Z1                    |
|                                       | 89       | 33    | Northeastern—Gabriel Lapointe, 1311 Adam, Chicoutimi Nord, Que. G7G 4H8               |
|                                       | 90       | 34    | Northwestern—Jean-Marie Alain, C.P. 254, Succ. Ahuntic, Montreal, Que. H3L 3N8        |
| Saskatchewan                          | 91       | 34    | Jim McKnight, 2846 Wyllie Cres., Prince Albert, Sask. S6V 6M2                         |

# Literature Distributed—1983

## Books

|                                                   |                |
|---------------------------------------------------|----------------|
| Alcoholics Anonymous                              | 543,300        |
| Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (reg. edition) | 267,400        |
| Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (gift edition) | 52,100         |
| A.A. Comes of Age                                 | 21,800         |
| As Bill Sees It                                   | 58,800         |
| Dr. Bob and the Good Oldtimers                    | 24,300         |
| Alcoholics Anonymous—Spanish edition              | 7,700          |
| As Bill Sees It—Spanish edition                   | 1,600          |
| A.A. Comes of Age—Spanish edition                 | 2,000          |
| <b>Total</b>                                      | <b>979,000</b> |

## Booklets

|                              |                |
|------------------------------|----------------|
| Living Sober                 | 140,800        |
| Came to Believe              | 60,500         |
| Living Sober—Spanish edition | 3,200          |
| <b>Total</b>                 | <b>204,500</b> |

## Pamphlets

|                                                           |         |
|-----------------------------------------------------------|---------|
| A.A. and Occupational Programs                            | 38,000  |
| A.A. and the Armed Services                               | 26,100  |
| A.A. and the Medical Profession (discontinued)            | 20,700  |
| A.A. as a Resource for the Medical Profession             | 87,500  |
| A.A. for the Woman                                        | 214,400 |
| The A.A. Group                                            | 123,400 |
| A.A. in Your Community                                    | 159,400 |
| A.A. in Prisons                                           | 33,700  |
| A.A. in Treatment Centers                                 | 64,100  |
| The A.A. Member                                           | 134,200 |
| The A.A. Member and Drug Abuse                            | 196,200 |
| The A.A. Service Manual/Twelve Concepts for World Service | 25,800  |
| A.A. Tradition—How It Developed                           | 79,000  |
| A.A.'s Legacy of Service                                  | 21,900  |
| A Brief Guide to Alcoholics Anonymous                     | 248,800 |
| A Clergyman Asks About A.A.                               | 59,700  |
| The Co-Founders of Alcoholics Anonymous                   | 53,100  |
| Do You Think You're Different?                            | 239,000 |
| 44 Questions                                              | 466,900 |
| G.S.R.                                                    | 51,000  |
| How A.A. Members Cooperate                                | 41,600  |
| How It Works                                              | 147,700 |

|                                             |         |
|---------------------------------------------|---------|
| If You Are a Professional                   | 96,400  |
| Inside A.A.                                 | 104,500 |
| Is A.A. for You?                            | 541,100 |
| Is There an Alcoholic in Your Life?         | 192,800 |
| It Happened to Alice                        | 92,500  |
| It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell             | 80,200  |
| The Jack Alexander Article                  | 81,900  |
| Let's Be Friendly With Our Friends          | 36,900  |
| Letter to a Woman Alcoholic                 | 157,400 |
| A Member's-Eye View of A.A.                 | 154,000 |
| Memo to an Inmate Who May Be an Alcoholic   | 65,000  |
| A Newcomer Asks                             | 331,400 |
| Problems Other Than Alcohol                 | 147,600 |
| Questions and Answers on Sponsorship        | 260,700 |
| Speaking at Non-A.A. Meetings               | 34,500  |
| This Is A.A.                                | 503,600 |
| Three Talks to Medical Societies by Bill W. | 49,300  |
| Time to Start Living                        | 125,800 |
| Time to Start Living (large print)          | 11,500  |
| Too Young?                                  | 205,200 |
| The Twelve Traditions Illustrated           | 75,800  |
| Understanding Anonymity                     | 118,500 |
| What Happened to Joe                        | 95,600  |
| Young People and A.A.                       | 272,800 |
| Foreign translations                        | 179,200 |

**Total** 6,546,400

## Miscellaneous

|                                                          |         |
|----------------------------------------------------------|---------|
| Wallet cards—two-fold                                    | 849,400 |
| Wallet cards—I Am Responsible                            | 140,200 |
| Wallet cards—Anonymity                                   | 72,200  |
| Parchment—scrolls                                        | 7,000   |
| Placards                                                 | 1,100   |
| C.P.C. Workbook                                          | 800     |
| A.A. Guidelines                                          | 116,000 |
| Group Handbook                                           | 6,000   |
| Wire Racks                                               | 2,200   |
| Cassettes                                                | 3,600   |
| Alcoholics Anonymous (cassette album)                    | 2,700   |
| Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (cassette album)      | 1,600   |
| Public Service Announcements (cassettes, tapes, records) | 500     |
| A.A. Public Information Workbooks                        | 1,000   |
| Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions window-shade displays | 2,400   |
| Fact Files                                               | 5,500   |

**Total** 1,212,200

## Grapevine circulation — geographical breakdown

|  |  |  |  |  |  |  | Circulation 4/1/83—119,586; 4/1/84—125,338 |  |  |  |  |  |  | Increase/decrease: 4/1/82—4/1/83, -2,884; 4/1/83—4/1/84, +5,752 |  |  |  |  |  |  |
|--|--|--|--|--|--|--|--------------------------------------------|--|--|--|--|--|--|-----------------------------------------------------------------|--|--|--|--|--|--|
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